ANAKDAGAT: A 2D ANIMATED SHORT FILM ON THE LIFE OF THE FILIPINO FISHERFOLK COMMUNITY

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DEDICATION

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G.C.B

T.A.Z.D

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ABSTRACT

Filipino fisherfolk communities play a vital role in ensuring national food security and sustaining coastal economies, yet they continue to face persistent socio-economic challenges that are often overlooked. Despite their contributions to local livelihoods and the agricultural sector, issues such as poverty, environmental threats, and social marginalization receive limited attention in public awareness initiatives. Inadequate representation in mainstream media further reduces visibility, weakening public understanding of their working conditions, struggles, and cultural identity. This project addresses these gaps through AnakDagat, a 2D animated short film that portrays the lived experiences of small-scale Filipino fisherfolk in a culturally sensitive and accessible manner. The film seeks to foster awareness, empathy, and appreciation for their role in coastal livelihoods by presenting social realities through engaging visual storytelling. Its production followed a structured animation pipeline informed by field immersion, community interviews, and documentary review to ensure narrative accuracy and authenticity. The effectiveness of the film as an educational and awareness-oriented medium was evaluated using the Technology Acceptance Model, with feedback gathered from experts and general viewers. Results indicated high perceived usefulness, ease of understanding, and satisfaction, with an acceptance rating of 4.5. These findings highlight the potential of animated storytelling for communicating social issues and disseminating community-focused research.

Keywords: *Fisherfolk, 2D animation, Technology Acceptance Model, Community awareness, Coastal livelihoods*

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DEFINITION OF TERMS

2D Animation	A form of animation that creates movement in a two-dimensional space using sequential images, drawings, or digital illustrations. It is the primary medium used to produce the animated short film featured in this research.
Climate Vulnerability	A condition in which communities are at increased risk of harm due to climate-related hazards, including typhoons, rising sea levels, and unstable weather patterns. Fisherfolk are considered one of the most climate-vulnerable sectors.
F/B Pagbabago Program	A livelihood assistance program of the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR) that provides modernized fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) boats and capacity-building support to small-scale fisherfolk to enhance safety, productivity, and sustainability.
Fiberglass-Reinforced Plastic (FRP) Boat	A durable, lightweight, and weather-resistant boat made from fiberglass materials. In this study, FRP boats are highlighted as BFAR's modern alternative to traditional wooden boats for improved fishing efficiency and safety.
Fisherfolk	Refers to individuals or groups engaged in small-scale or municipal fishing activities, including fish catchers, gleaners, fish processors, and fish vendors. In this study, the term specifically pertains to coastal fishers who rely on traditional fishing methods for livelihood.
Livelihood Program	A government-initiated or institution-led intervention that provides resources, tools, skills training, or financial assistance to help improve income and livelihood stability among marginalized groups such as fisherfolk.
Narrative Storytelling	A method of conveying information through a structured sequence of events or experiences. In the study, narrative storytelling is used as a technique in the

	animated film to present the lived realities of fisherfolk.
Small-scale Fisheries	A sector of fisheries characterized by low-capital, labor-intensive fishing practices often carried out on small boats or nearshore waters. This includes subsistence and artisanal fishing activities common in Philippine coastal communities.
Sustainable Development Goals (SDG)	A set of seventeen (17) global goals established by the United Nations in 2015 to address major social, economic, and environmental challenges. These goals aim to end poverty, protect the environment, promote inclusive and sustainable development, and improve the quality of life for all people worldwide by the year 2030.
Technology Acceptance Model (TAM)	A theoretical framework used to assess users' acceptance of a system or media. In this research, TAM evaluates the animated film through factors such as perceived usefulness, perceived ease of use, aesthetic quality, perceived enjoyment, and behavioral intention to use.

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Background of the Study

In an archipelagic country like the Philippines, where over 7,000 islands form the backbone of communities and commerce, the role of small-scale fisherfolk is crucial. Fishing is not only a source of livelihood but also an integral part of the nation's food security and local economies. According to Statista (2023), there were approximately 2.3 million municipal fisherfolk in the Philippines, with about 1.1 million engaged in capture fishing, the most common form of livelihood among them. Other major activities include aquaculture (260,960), gleaning (255,690), fish vending (161,960), and fish processing (45,260), while the rest are involved in miscellaneous or unspecified fisheries-related work. A significant portion, around 85%, are small-scale coastal fishers, who heavily rely on coastal waters for income and food (Statista, 2023; RARE Conservation, 2020).

Despite their vital contributions to the economy and food supply, many of these fisherfolk remain among the country's most vulnerable sectors. Fisherfolk in the Philippines often struggle with low incomes and unstable livelihoods. Studies indicate that many fishing households live below the poverty line, with daily wages insufficient to cover basic needs. For instance, in the Municipality of Binalbagan, most fishermen earn just enough for subsistence, and their income is highly vulnerable to weather fluctuations (Enema & Quezon, 2024). Similarly, in Lake Sebu, fishing-dependent

households earn an average annual income of PHP 132,800 (US$2,619), which is 15% lower than the average for all households, with 63% of these households living below the poverty line (Palanca-Tan & Bongat-Bayog, 2021)

The daily wages of fisherfolk vary depending on the type of fishing gear, the quantity of catch, and market demand. In some regions, fishers earn between PHP 200 to PHP 500 per day, which is barely enough to sustain their families (Enema & Quezon, 2024; Fabinyi, 2018). These low wages are exacerbated by the lack of alternative livelihoods and the seasonal nature of fishing, which leaves many fisherfolk without a steady income during certain times of the year (Ungkakay-Bagsit, Monteclaro, & Griffith, 2023).

In addition, fisherfolk in the Philippines are predominantly often family-based, relying on traditional methods passed down through generations. These practices differ across regions, with variations in gear, techniques, and target species. For example, fisherfolk in the Bicol Region commonly use gill nets, hook and lines, and traps (Atillo, 2024), while in Palawan, 16 types of fishing gear have been identified, including nets, lines, traps, and hand tools (Balisco, Tahajudjin, & Vigonte, 2019).

Moreover, ownership of fishing gear significantly impacts their productivity, yet many fisherfolk do not own their boats or gear. In Cawayan, Masbate, 32% of fishermen use boats they do not own, though 93% prefer motorboats for efficiency (Ibañez, Velza, Ompoc, Oporto, & Mobo, 2023). Similarly, in Barangay Bonawon, Siaton, Negros Oriental, traditional and cost-effective fishing methods such as “paanod” and “ali” are commonly used (Atillo, 2024). While some areas like Antique show higher levels of gear ownership and the use of legal, regulated methods (Cabigunda-Gordon,

2025), the overall percentage of gear-owning fisherfolk varies and highlights persistent economic challenges in the sector.

To address these issues, the Department of Agriculture—Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources launched the F/B Pagbabago Program, an initiative that aims to uplift the lives of small-scale fisherfolk by providing them with modernized fiberglass boats equipped with engines, as well as capacity-building programs (BFAR, 2023). This initiative seeks to promote sustainable fishing practices, improve fishing efficiency, and reduce post-harvest losses. It also strives to empower fisherfolk by fostering self-reliance and resilience in the face of socio-economic and environmental challenges (BFAR, 2023). The distribution of modernized fiberglass boats under the F/B Pagbabago Program has been a significant step towards improving the livelihoods of small-scale fishers. These boats are designed to be more durable and fuel-efficient, reducing the operational costs of fishing operations. The use of modernized boats also increases the safety of fishers, as they are better equipped to withstand rough seas and other environmental challenges (Labayo & Preña, 2024) (Enema & Quezon, 2024). The introduction of modernized fiberglass boats has also had a positive impact on the environment. By reducing the number of traditional wooden boats, which often require the use of non-renewable resources, the program contributes to the conservation of the country's forest resources. Additionally, the use of more efficient fishing gear reduces the bycatch and discarding of non-target species, promoting more sustainable fishing practices (Labayo & Preña, 2024) (Enema & Quezon, 2024).

The lack of representation and awareness of the fisherfolk's struggles poses a challenge. In an era where digital media shapes public perception, narrative videos serve as powerful tools in spreading information and engaging audiences. Visual storytelling, especially through animation, offers a creative and compelling way to promote government initiatives. It can simplify complex messages, highlight emotional narratives, and spark interest across a wide demographic (Wells, 2002; Mayer, 2009).

Animation, traditionally used in entertainment, has evolved into a versatile tool in education, advocacy, and marketing. It captures attention, evokes emotion, and communicates key messages in a format that is both memorable and shareable (Noor, 2015). In the case of fisherfolk communities, whose struggles are often overlooked despite their vital role in food security, animation offers a platform to highlight their lived experiences and daily challenges. By humanizing their stories and making them visible to wider audiences, animation can help foster empathy, understanding, and social support. It can also highlight government support and programs such as the F/B Pagbabago program, where an animated media can help bring attention to this cast to a wider audience, and help reach the people who might need such assistance.

The study centers on the creation of a 2D animated short film that showcases the everyday realities and long-standing struggles of Filipino fisherfolk. It aims to shed light on the challenges faced by these communities, including unsafe working conditions, economic instability, and limited access to government support. Through storytelling and animation, the film seeks to humanize these experiences and inspire empathy and awareness among

viewers. It also aims to highlight the transformation brought about by the F/B Pagbabago Program in the lives of Filipino fisherfolk. The project presents the role of government support in addressing long-standing issues in the fishing sector and aims to raise awareness about the importance of such initiatives. Through storytelling and animation, it seeks to promote the program to the general public, policymakers, and potential stakeholders.

In summary, the main objective of this study is to develop a 2D animated awareness short film that uses compelling visuals and narratives to raise awareness about the fisherfolk's struggles. It also aims to present the F/B Pagbabago Program as an example of how responsive initiatives can contribute to the empowerment and well-being of coastal communities.

Project Purpose

This project aims to produce a 2D animated short film that sheds light to the often overlooked but vital lives of Filipino fisherfolk. More than just a depiction of their work, the film seeks to portray the everyday struggles, resilience, and quiet strength of the fishing sector. Through visual storytelling, the animation highlighted the challenges faced by these communities, including harsh working conditions, economic vulnerability, and environmental risks.

Also, the F/B Pagbabago Program launched by the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR), was introduced as part of the narrative. While it is not the central theme, the program provided an example of how government initiatives could help improve safety and promote sustainable practices through the provision of fiberglass boats and training. Its inclusion helps ground the story in real efforts that support the fishing sector.

And using animation as a creative medium allows the project to communicate these stories in a way that is emotionally engaging and accessible to a broad audience. The goal is to raise awareness, encourage empathy, and inspire greater appreciation for the fisherfolk community and the support systems that can help uplift them.

Furthermore, this initiative contributes to the achievement of several United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). It strongly aligns with SDG 14 - Life Below Water by advocating for the protection and sustainable use of marine resources, a central theme in the film as it follows the lives of fisherfolk who depend on healthy oceans for survival. Closely tied to this is SDG 13 - Climate Action, as the story portrays the vulnerability of coastal communities to climate change, including extreme weather events and declining fish populations, while emphasizing the importance of adaptive solutions like modern fishing technology and capacity building. The film also addresses SDG 1 - No Poverty by promoting efforts that help uplift marginalized fisherfolk through government support and livelihood improvements. Similarly, SDG 2 - Zero Hunger is supported through the focus on the fishing sector’s vital role in ensuring national and local food security. By showcasing improved working conditions and access to better equipment, the project supports SDG 8 - Decent Work and Economic Growth, while SDG 9 - Industry, Innovation, and Infrastructure is reflected in the introduction of fiberglass boats and modernization of coastal livelihoods. In giving voice to the struggles and successes of often-overlooked fishing communities, the initiative supports SDG 10 - Reduced Inequalities and fosters inclusion. Through its depiction of organized, empowered, and disaster-resilient

communities, the project also contributes to SDG 11 - Sustainable Cities and Communities. Lastly, by promoting transparency, trust in government support systems, and inclusive storytelling, the film contributes to SDG 16 - Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions, showing how governance and public service can create real impact in the lives of citizens.

Through visual storytelling, the animated short film seeks not only to inform but also to empower those directly and indirectly affected by the F/B Pagbabago Program. The following are the key beneficiaries of the project:

Small-scale Fisherfolk

The film seeks to empower the fisherfolk community by showing them as hardworking, resilient individuals who deserve recognition and support.

Coastal Communities

By highlighting the program's impact, the film also benefits coastal communities by encouraging participation in sustainable practices and informing them of government initiatives that can improve their livelihood.

General Public and Stakeholders

The animation will educate a wide audience, especially youth and policymakers, about the importance of supporting local industries and programs that promote social equity and environmental responsibility.

Government Agencies and NGOs

The project can serve as a supplementary promotional and advocacy tool for BFAR and similar agencies, helping to visually document and promote the effectiveness of development programs.

Community-Based Organizations and Educators

Educators and local leaders can use the animated film as a resource for campaigns, training, or awareness-building efforts in schools and barangays, especially in coastal areas.

Future Researchers

The project may inspire future studies on the impact of animated media in public information campaigns and its role in social advocacy, particularly in promoting government-led initiatives.

Objectives

The main objective of this study is to develop a 2D animated short film that raises awareness of the lived experiences of small-scale Filipino fisherfolk, while also highlighting the role and impact of government initiatives in addressing the sector's challenges. The film seeks to offer an honest and empathetic portrayal of the fisherfolk community while showing how institutional efforts affect their lives in hopes of inspiring future initiatives from both government and non-government institutions. More specifically, the study aims to achieve the following objectives:

1. To gather data on the life and difficulties encountered by small-scale fisherfolk and positive changes brought by programs and initiatives by government and non-government organizations, such as, but not limited to the F/B Pagbabago Program.
2. To develop a story and a 2D animated short film based on the collected data that effectively communicate the program's goals and impact.

3. To evaluate the acceptability of the 2D animated film using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) framework through a structured questionnaire.

Scope and Limitations of the Study

The research conducted is centered on lived experiences of Filipino fisherfolk and the impact of government responses through programs such as but not limited to the F/B Pagbabago Program of the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR).

This carefully produced 2D animated short film serves as a creative and meaningful medium to raise awareness and foster understanding of the day-to-day challenges faced by coastal communities, such as poverty, lack of resources, and unsafe fishing conditions, and how government and non-government initiatives and programs provide hope through modernized fishing boats and livelihood support.

Through compelling visuals, storytelling, and character-driven narratives, the animation aims to humanize the fisherfolk's plight while showcasing the positive impact of the program. The film integrates authentic scenarios inspired by true scenarios, intending to spark empathy and promote appreciation for the role of fisherfolk in society.

With a planned runtime suitable for short film format, Anak Dagat includes a 3-act story structure showcasing the main narrative and a credit sequence acknowledging all the proponents and contributors involved in developing the film. This structure ensures the delivery of an engaging yet informative message that reflects both the hardships and resilience of the fishing communities.

This project covers the stages of conceptualization, research, scripting, storyboarding, animation development, sound design, and post-production. The final output underwent acceptability testing with a target audience composed of students and educators to evaluate the film's effectiveness in delivering its message. It was also assessed by professionals to evaluate the technical quality, artistic integrity, and accuracy of the information presented in the film.

In summary, the scope and limitations of the study define its specific focus on the fisherfolks' struggles and the F/B Pagbabago Program. While the animation presents a powerful visual narrative, it is limited by its runtime, scope of representation, and the scale of evaluation. The film does not attempt to portray every fisherfolk's experience in the country but rather provides a general and accessible representation meant to inform, inspire, and create awareness about the importance of government support in the fisheries sector.

CHAPTER 2

THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK OF THE STUDY

Review of Related Literature and Studies

The livelihood of the fisherfolk community in the Philippines is shaped by various economic, environmental, and social factors, making government actions and interventions crucial in ensuring its sustainability and resilience. This section reviews relevant literature, studies, and discussions from local and international sources, such as hardbound thesis books, online articles, and other published materials. Additionally, information from the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR) website is considered to ensure accuracy and relevance. This review dives into the landscape of fisherfolk livelihoods, the socioeconomic impact of livelihood programs, the socioeconomic impact of livelihood programs and the role of animation in raising awareness.

By synthesizing existing studies and published program evaluations, this review highlights the significance of sustainable fisheries initiatives in improving stability and community development. It also emphasizes the power of storytelling through a short film to bring the fisherfolk’s experiences and the program's impact to a wider audience in a compelling and accessible way.

Fisherfolk Communities

Fisherfolk communities play a crucial role in the Philippine fisheries sector, contributing significantly to food security, economic stability, and marine biodiversity conservation. However, they often face socioeconomic challenges such as poverty, resource depletion, and environmental degradation due to factors like overfishing, climate change, and weak policy

enforcement (Malayang et al., 2020). Many small-scale fisherfolk rely heavily on coastal and marine resources but struggle with low incomes, limited market access, and inadequate government support (Fabinyi, 2024).

Belardo and Candelaria (2023) explored the hopes and struggles of fisherfolk parents in securing a better future for their children through education. Interviews conducted in fishing communities in the Bicol Region revealed that most parents discourage their children from pursuing fishing due to its risks and hardships, instead prioritizing education for better career opportunities.

Cultural factors such as collectivism and strong family ties also influence their perspectives. The study suggests that these challenges contribute to the declining number of fisherfolk and underscores the need for policies and support systems that align with their aspirations. Watts et al. (2021) examined the role of participatory education in promoting sustainable fisheries and poverty reduction among Philippine fisherfolk. Using a Cultural Consensus Model, their study emphasized integrating local knowledge into Coastal Resource Management and governance. It highlighted the importance of recognizing fisherfolk epistemologies in fostering food security and sustainability through collaborative efforts between the government and non-governmental organizations (Watts et al., 2021).

Recent research highlights that fisherfolk communities are also highly vulnerable to climate-related hazards. A study on small-scale fishers in Davao Gulf found that they experience two to three climate-related hazards annually, such as the northeast monsoon (Amihan), southwest monsoon (Habagat), and typhoons. These events lead to flooding, health issues, and disrupted

fishing activities, making them one of the most climate-affected sectors in the Philippines (Macusi et al., 2023).

In addition to climate threats, fisherfolk are also highly susceptible to environmental disasters. The 2023 Mindoro oil spill, for example, led to significant economic losses for fisherfolk in Naujan, where many reported losing up to USD 1,300 per week due to fishing bans. The study found that the lack of alternative income sources further exacerbated their financial struggles, emphasizing the need for stronger disaster response policies and sustainable livelihood programs to protect affected communities (Agaton et al., 2023).

Economic restructuring has also significantly impacted fishermen, fishmongers, and gender roles in Philippine fishing communities, leading to shifts in livelihoods, resource management, and social dynamics. Traditionally, men have dominated offshore fishing, while women have been responsible for fish processing, marketing, and trade. However, economic changes have introduced new roles and challenges for both genders.

Research from Ateneo de Manila University (2023) highlights how policies and market forces have shaped small-scale fisheries, stressing the importance of inclusive development strategies that recognize gender contributions and promote sustainable resource management. By examining the relationship between economic policies and traditional fishing practices, the study provides insights into coastal community resilience and the need to balance economic progress with socio-environmental sustainability.

The study provides an in-depth analysis of the socio-economic conditions of fisherfolk in Bangladesh and their implications for fisheries

management. It highlights challenges such as poverty, lack of education, and limited access to resources among fishing communities. The authors emphasize the need for inclusive policies, community participation, and capacity-building initiatives to improve the livelihoods of fisherfolk and promote sustainable fisheries management (Barua et al., 2020).

F/B Pagbabago Livelihood Program

Fishing has long been a way of life for many Filipinos, providing food, income, and a connection to the sea. However, traditional wooden boats, which have been used for generations, are prone to rot, structural failure, and high maintenance costs. To address these challenges, the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR) introduced the F/B Pag-babago Livelihood Program, an initiative that provides fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) boats to local fisherfolk. These modern boats are designed to be more durable, safe, and environmentally friendly, offering a sustainable alternative to wooden vessels (Hetharia et al., 2021).

The FB Pagbabago Program by BFAR provides fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) boats to fisherfolk, replacing old wooden boats with more durable, disaster-resilient, and eco-friendly alternatives. These boats enhance safety at sea while reducing deforestation caused by traditional boat-making. To further support fisherfolk, the program includes livelihood training and capacity-building through the “Banca ko, gawa ko” cash-for-work scheme, teaching beneficiaries FRP boat construction and maintenance. This initiative not only provides stable income opportunities but also equips fisherfolk with skills for long-term sustainability (BFAR, 2023). This program plays a vital role

in revitalizing the fisheries sector, which is crucial for food security, non-oil exports, and foreign exchange earnings (Pratiwi et al., 2021).

One of the key aspects of its success lies in how fishers adapt to new technology and adjust their fishing strategies in response to economic and environmental changes (Macusi et al., 2017). The shift from wooden to FRP boats represents more than just an upgrade and it is a step towards safer and more efficient fishing practices. FRP boats are highly resistant to seawater corrosion and damage from marine organisms, making them a long-term investment compared to their wooden counterparts (Mustafa et al., 2020). Additionally, their sturdier design improves safety at sea, reducing the risks associated with boat deterioration and unpredictable waters (Aliffrananda et al., 2021).

While the transition to FRP boats presents clear economic and environmental benefits, research suggests that fisherfolk face challenges in adopting these new technologies. A study on fishing communities in the Philippines emphasizes that financial constraints and resistance to change may hinder the program's effectiveness. Many fisherfolk, particularly those in lower-income groups, struggle with the costs associated with maintaining FRP boats, despite their long-term benefits (Macusi et al., 2023).

The F/B Pagbabago Program was launched by the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR) to support fisherfolk affected by Typhoon Yolanda in 2013. The typhoon severely damaged boats and fishing gear in Regions 5, 6, 7, and 8, prompting BFAR to assess the damage and provide livelihood assistance. Due to the scarcity of wooden materials, the agency

introduced fiberglass boat construction as a sustainable alternative (BFAR - CALABARZON, 2023).

In collaboration with the National Marine Fisheries Development Center (NMFDC), BFAR implemented a training program to equip personnel with the skills necessary to design, construct, and maintain Fiberglass Reinforced Plastic (FRP) fishing boats. This initiative led to the development of prototype boats and laid the foundation for nationwide adoption (BFAR - CALABARZON, 2023).

Beyond improving the daily lives of fisherfolk, this initiative encourages sustainable fishing practices, ensuring that the next generations can continue to rely on the sea for their livelihood. By modernizing equipment and promoting ecological responsibility, the F/B Pag-babago Livelihood Program is not just about boats, it is about securing a better future for coastal communities (Pratiwi et al., 2021). The Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources in the Philippines has long been involved in promoting livelihood programs to support coastal communities. One such initiative is the F/B Pagbabago Livelihood Program, which aims to provide alternative income sources for fisherfolk.

The transition to fiberglass boats aligns with BFAR's mission to enhance fisheries productivity, ensure stakeholder empowerment, and promote climate change adaptation. Fiberglass boats offer several advantages over traditional wooden boats, including increased durability, disaster resilience, and reduced reliance on scarce natural resources (BFAR - CALABARZON, 2023).

To maintain the quality of FRP boats, DA-BFAR, through NMFDC, developed the FRP F/B Pagbabago Construction, Repair, and Maintenance Training Manual. This manual provides guidelines on efficient and cost-effective fabrication techniques, ensuring standardized production and consistent quality of FRP boats (BFAR - CALABARZON, 2023).

Boat designs and materials, including fiberglass mats and lay-up, are customized based on fisheries activities, fishing grounds, and sea conditions. Standardizing FRP boat construction improves safety, longevity, and efficiency in harsh marine environments (BFAR - CALABARZON, 2023).

The socio-economic conditions of fisherfolk in the Philippines have been the subject of considerable research. Fishing remains a crucial livelihood for many coastal households, despite the challenges they face such as irregular income and the impact of illegal fishing practices. Alternative income sources, such as ecotourism, have shown promise in reducing the reliance of communities on fishing. (Talbot et al., 2024) The Coastal Environmental Profiling of Barangay Mana, Malita, Davao Occidental provides a relevant case study. The study found that estuaries in the area were abundant with marine resources, supporting livelihood activities like seaweed and mollusk harvesting. Additionally, efforts were made to supplement fishing livelihoods with alternative programs from local and national government agencies (Pacyao, 2024).

The Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources has long played a role in disseminating fisheries information and technologies to end-users. However, the implementation of such programs has faced its challenges. As the Philippines' coastal communities continue to navigate the complexities of

sustainable resource management, programs like the F/B Pagbabago Livelihood initiative can provide important alternatives to traditional fishing livelihoods. (Quiñones et al., 2020)

Program Impact

The Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources in the Philippines implemented the F/B Pag-babago Livelihood Program that aims to support fisherfolk through the replacement of old, dilapidated wooden boats with more durable and climate-resilient fiberglass-reinforced plastic boats (Pomeroy et al., 2017). This program not only promotes environmental sustainability by reducing the use of wood but also enhances the safety and productivity of fisherfolk at sea.

To understand the impact of this program, this research paper examines the relevant literature on livelihood programs and the adoption of alternative fishing technologies, such as FRP boats.

An analysis of various livelihood projects and programs for fishing communities in the Philippines indicates that successful and sustainable interventions must consider critical factors such as community engagement, capacity building, and the appropriateness of the technology to the local context (Pomeroy et al., 2017). Similarly, studies on the adoption of new fishing technologies in Eastern Indonesian waters highlight the importance of addressing technical problems and ensuring the continuity of fishing activities. (Hetharia et al., 2021)

Specifically, the influence of economic factors on the willingness of anchored FAD fishers in the Philippines to adapt or change their fishing strategies suggests that the perceived value and profitability of the FRP boats

may play a significant role in their adoption. In conclusion, the existing literature provides valuable insights into the factors that can contribute to the success and sustainability of the BFAR's F/B Pag-babago Livelihood Program, which aims to improve the livelihoods of fisherfolk through the distribution of FRP boats. Its key components include partnerships with local government units (LGUs), skills training in fiberglass boat fabrication and repair, replacement of dilapidated wooden boats, deployment in alternative fishing grounds, and integration of production and marketing value chains through EAFM.

In FY 2023, the program facilitated the nationwide distribution of 875 motorized bancas and 67 non-motorized bancas, benefiting 1,044 individuals and 23 fisherfolk groups (BFAR - Region 5, 2023).

Adopting fiberglass technology has significantly enhanced BFAR’s capacity to provide durable, environment-friendly fishing boats. Under the Ahon Program, affected fisherfolk received new boats, marine engines, and fishing gear, allowing them to recover their livelihoods more effectively. Beyond immediate recovery, the initiative promotes long-term sustainability by reducing reliance on traditional wooden materials and improving fishery resilience (BFAR - CALABARZON, 2023).

The F/B Pagbabago Program has transformed the devastation caused by Typhoon Yolanda into an opportunity for technological innovation, economic recovery, and enhanced disaster preparedness, paving the way for a more sustainable future for the Philippine fishing industry (BFAR - CALABARZON, 2023).

Animation as a Medium of Change

From its initial conception, animation has not only been a long-time staple of entertainment, but it has also become a powerful tool for advocacy, education, and policy messaging. Blending compelling visuals with engaging narratives, animation makes light of complex topics and makes them more accessible and visible to a diverse set of audiences while evoking emotional connections that drive engagement (Yellowbrick, 2024). Thus making it an effective medium for promoting government initiatives and highlighting marginalized communities' struggles. This technique has been successfully applied in various social campaigns, as demonstrated in projects that visualize migration struggles through animated storytelling (The Guardian, 2025).

In the Philippines, animation and visual storytelling have been historically used to communicate political and social issues. During the era of Martial Law under the regime of former President and dictator Marcos Sr., Filipino animator, cartoonist, and filmmaker Severino “Nonoy” Marcelo utilized animation as a form of social commentary and criticism, blending cultural narratives with political messaging in works such as Tadhana (1978) (Wikipedia, 2024).

This demonstrates how animation has long been a tool for advocacy, fostering discussions on national concerns. Similarly, in more recent years, Filipino animated works continue to play a big role in awareness. Ang Lihim ni Lea (2020), a Filipino animated short addressing child abuse, garnered international recognition, displaying animation’s ability to tackle sensitive topics and drive awareness (Good News Pilipinas, 2020).

Furthermore, animated storytelling has played a significant role in spreading consciousness about pressing global issues. The Stories of Migration exhibition, organized by PositiveNegative and hosted at the SOAS University of London, featured animations depicting personal migration struggles from different countries, including the Philippines. This initiative highlights animation's power in influencing public perception and generating empathy for marginalized communities (The Guardian, 2025).

More recently, the success of animated films such as Flow (2024), which won an Academy Award for its wordless yet deeply evocative portrayal of climate change through the journey of a cat navigating a post-apocalyptic flooded world (AP News, 2025), proves that animation can transcend language barriers and create meaningful discourse on global issues. These successes highlight animation's unique power to make complex social and environmental issues relatable and compelling.

In the context of fisherfolk and livelihood programs, animation can be a transformative medium for raising awareness and bringing visibility to their hardships, such as economic instability and environmental challenges, while also illustrating how government interventions, like the F/B Pagbabago Livelihood Program, provide support. Studies suggest that animated narratives can effectively translate real-life advocacy into compelling visual content, making policy discussions more relatable and impactful (RMCAD, 2024). Additionally, animation fosters emotional connections that lead to greater empathy and social action, a crucial factor in engaging communities and policymakers (Toxigon, 2025).

Animation can serve as a transformative tool to promote the F/B Pagbabago Program, enhancing its accessibility and appeal to fisherfolk communities. By creating culturally relevant animated content, the government can effectively highlight the program's benefits and address common concerns about adopting fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) boats. For example, similar efforts like the "Fisher's Tales" animated series have successfully used engaging narratives to advocate for sustainable fishing practices, demonstrating the potential of animation to resonate with local audiences (Pacific-European Union Marine Partnership Programme, 2022).

Collaborating with organizations such as the Animation Council of the Philippines, Inc. (ACPI) can ensure high-quality productions tailored to the target demographic, while leveraging social media and local broadcasting channels can amplify the reach and impact of these initiatives (Animation Council of the Philippines, 2024). Animated storytelling can showcase real-life testimonials from fisherfolk who have benefited from the program, addressing financial or technological apprehensions while fostering empathy and understanding. As seen in international campaigns like those produced by Tuldok Animation Studios, these approaches effectively bridge communication gaps and encourage active participation in government programs (Tuldok Animation Studios, 2023).

Given the effectiveness of animated films in conveying urgent societal messages, with studies indicating that animated storytelling can shape public opinion and inspire collective action (Yellowbrick, 2024), creating an animated short film about the lives of Filipino Fisherfolk is a timely and necessary endeavor. Like Flow, which visualizes the struggles of survival in a changing

climate, a film about fisherfolk can highlight the real-life consequences of economic instability, environmental challenges, and governmental interventions in coastal communities. The hardships and resilience of fisherfolk often go unnoticed, yet they play a crucial role in the country's food security and economy. By translating their struggles into an engaging and emotionally impactful animation, this project can amplify their voices, raise awareness, and encourage greater public and policy support, proving once again that storytelling through animation is not just art but a tool for meaningful change.

By utilizing animation in this capstone project, the film aims to amplify the voices of fisherfolk, fostering awareness and understanding of the socio-economic realities they face while promoting the significance of government assistance programs. Visual storytelling ensures that fisherfolk communities' challenges, struggles, and resilience are effectively communicated, helping bridge the gap between policy efforts and public engagement.

Tools to be used in Development

Adobe Photoshop

Adobe Photoshop is a powerful image editing software widely utilized in the animation and graphic design industries. It allows users to create and manipulate raster graphics, making it essential for developing character designs, backgrounds, and textures for animated projects. The software's extensive range of features, including layers, filters, and brushes, enables artists to produce high-quality visuals that enhance storytelling (Adobe, 2023).

By employing Photoshop, animators can create detailed artwork that serves as the foundation for animated sequences, ensuring a polished and professional final product.

Adobe After Effects

Adobe After Effects is a professional software for motion graphics, visual effects, and compositing used in film, video, and web content. It allows users to animate text and graphics, create special effects, and is used extensively in video post-production for creating everything from simple credit rolls to complex title sequences and cinematic visuals. (Adobe, 2023). By utilizing the software, the project can leverage its capabilities to produce engaging animations that resonate with audiences, effectively conveying the stories of fisherfolk and their experiences.

Audacity

Audacity is an open-source audio editing software that provides a wide range of features for recording and editing sound. It allows users to manipulate audio tracks, apply effects, and enhance sound quality, making it an essential tool for producing soundscapes and voiceovers in animation projects. The software’s user-friendly interface and robust functionality enable creators to achieve professional-grade audio production (Audacity Team, 2023). By incorporating Audacity, the project can ensure that the auditory elements of the animation, such as dialogue and background music, are of high quality, enhancing the overall viewing experience.

Da Vinci Resolve

Da Vinci Resolve is a professional video editing software known for its powerful color correction and grading capabilities. It offers a comprehensive suite of tools for editing, visual effects, and audio post-production, making it ideal for finalizing animated projects. The software's advanced features allow for precise adjustments to color and lighting, ensuring that the visuals are vibrant and impactful (Blackmagic Design, 2023). Using Da Vinci Resolve enabled the project to deliver a polished final product that effectively communicates the narrative and emotional depth of the fisherfolk's stories.

2D Animation

2D animation is a traditional form of animation that involves creating movement in a two-dimensional space. This technique utilizes flat images, which can be hand-drawn or created digitally, to convey stories and emotions through sequential frames. The process typically involves keyframing, where key poses are established, and in-betweening, where the frames between these key poses are filled in to create smooth motion. This style of animation is widely used in various media, including television shows, films, and online content, due to its versatility and ability to convey complex narratives in an engaging manner (Wells, 2018). The accessibility of software like Adobe After Effects has further democratized 2D animation, allowing artists to produce high-quality animations with relative ease, making it an ideal medium for projects aimed at raising awareness about social issues, such as the livelihoods of fisherfolk in the Philippines.

Related Literature Matrix

Table 1. Matrix of Review of Related Literature

Year & Author	Title	Findings
AP News (2025)	Best animated film win for “Flow” gives Latvia its first Oscar	*Flow*, an animated film without dialogue, powerfully addressed climate change and won global recognition. Showing how powerful storytelling can be.
The Guardian (2025)	Moving pictures: comics and animation exhibition showcases stories of migration	Animated exhibits like *Stories of Migration* humanize migration struggles and generate public empathy. And how connecting on an emotional level can be a great strategy in sharing stories and promoting awareness of an issue.
Toxigon (2025)	How animation influences real-life perspectives in 2025	Found that animated storytelling can influence viewers’ real-life perspectives and behaviors.
Wikipedia Contributors (2025)	Nonoy Marcelo	Highlights the role of animation for political and social commentary during Martial Law in the Philippines.
Animation Council of the Philippines (2024)	Animation as advocacy and industry growth	Promotes high-quality, culturally resonant animated content for education, advocacy,

		and awareness.
Fabinyi (2024)	Small-scale fisheries, large-scale fisheries, and fisheries governance in the Philippines	Emphasizes how small-scale fisherfolk face poverty, poor governance, and weak institutional support in the Philippines.
FAO (2024)	Creating an Enabling Environment for Securing Sustainable Small-scale Fisheries	Urges governments to create enabling environments that support the sustainability of small-scale fisheries.
Pacyao (2024)	The Coastal Environmental Profiling (CEP) of Barangay Mana, Malita, Davao Occidental, Philippines	The case study shows how coastal communities in Davao diversify their livelihood through seaweed farming and local government support.
RMCAD (2024)	Animating for Social Change: How Cartoons Can Drive Awareness	Animated visuals help simplify complex issues and make them emotionally impactful for audiences.
Talbot et al. (2024)	Incorporating climate-readiness into fisheries management strategies	Recommends integrating climate-readiness into fisheries management to strengthen resilience.
Yellowbrick (2024)	How animation drives political messaging & advocacy	Animation can powerfully convey political messages and

		inspire empathy-driven action.
Wikipedia Contributors (2024)	Mila (2021 film)	An international animated film showing the trauma of war through a child's lens, produced through global collaboration.
Adobe (2023)	Adobe Photoshop & Adobe After Effects	A powerful tool for creating and manipulating raster graphics; essential in producing polished visuals such as characters, textures, and backgrounds for animation. Versatile software for designing vector-based animations and interactive content.
Agaton et al. (2023)	Immediate socioeconomic impacts of Mindoro oil spill on fisherfolk of Naujan, Philippines	The Mindoro oil spill caused severe income loss among fisherfolk, exposing the need for disaster-resilient livelihood programs.
Ateneo de Manila University (2023)	Fishermen, fishmongers, and the sea: Economic restructuring and gender dynamics in a Philippine fishing community	Showed that economic restructuring in fishing communities affects traditional gender roles and highlights inclusive policy needs.
Audacity Team (2023)	Audacity	Free, open-source software for recording

		and editing audio; useful for producing clean voiceovers and enhancing sound elements in animation.
Belardo & Candelaria (2023)	Aspirations of fisherfolk communities on their children's education in Albay, Asid, and Ragay Gulfs of Bicol, Philippines	Found that fisherfolk parents prefer their children to pursue education overfishing due to economic hardship and social aspirations.
BFAR (2023)	FB Pagbabago	The F/B Pagbabago Program aims to replace traditional wooden boats with safer, more sustainable fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) boats. It includes the development of manuals and standardized practices to ensure quality and safety in FRP boat production.
Blackmagic Design (2023)	Da Vinci Resolve	Professional video editing suite with high-end color grading and post-production tools; used to finalize and polish animated films.
Macusi et al. (2023)	Understanding vulnerability and building resilience in small-scale fisheries:	Small-scale fishers in Davao Gulf are highly vulnerable to climate-related hazards

	the case of Davao Gulf, Philippines	that disrupt their livelihoods.
Toon Boom (2023)	Toon Boom Harmony	Advanced 2D animation software with tools for drawing, rigging, and animating; ideal for creating fluid, professional-grade animated sequences.
Tuldok Animation Studios (2023)	Filipino Animation Studio revisits Philippines Folklore	Uses animation to retell Filipino folklore while addressing real-life social and environmental issues.
Pacific-EU Marine Partnership Programme (2022)	Fisher's Tales animated series	The *Fisher's Tales* series used animation to promote sustainable fishing practices in the Pacific. This could also be applied in promoting the F/B pagbabago project
Aliffrananda et al. (2021)	Design of laminated bamboo fishing boat with local cultural heritage using electric motor to support fishing tourism in Pasuruan, East Java.	Advocated for culturally designed bamboo boats with modern features to promote fishing tourism and safety.
Hetharia et al. (2021)	Problems and technical solutions of capture fisheries in Eastern Indonesian waters	Identified technical barriers in fishing technology adoption and stressed the importance of continued training.

Pratiwi et al. (2021)	Peatland Economic Revitalization Program based on community participation in Jarenang Village, Kuripan District, Barito Kuala Regency, South Kalimantan.	Emphasized community participation as key to successful livelihood and revitalization programs.
Watts et al. (2021)	Philippine fisherfolk: Sustainable community development action research and reflexive education	Advocates for participatory education that integrates local knowledge into sustainable fisheries governance.
Good News Pilipinas (2020)	Pinoy animated film 'Ang Lihim ni Lea' bags 9 prestigious international awards	*Ang Lihim ni Lea* earned international praise for tackling child abuse through Filipino animation. And is an example of how local animated films can reach far and wide.
Mustafa et al. (2020)	An improvement for the design of the small fiberglass seaweed farmers boat to minimize the sinkable risk	Designed improved FRP boats for seaweed farmers that reduce the risk of capsizing.
Wells, P. (2018)	Understanding Animation	Discusses 2D animation's storytelling power, structure, and emotional impact; highlights its accessibility through modern software for meaningful narrative work.

Synthesis

The literature reveals that the Filipino fisherfolk community faces persistent socioeconomic hardships, environmental threats, and policy gaps, highlighting the need for sustainable, inclusive, and disaster-resilient interventions. Programs like BFAR's F/B Pagbabago Program offer crucial support by replacing traditional boats with safer, eco-friendly fiberglass alternatives and providing livelihood training, though challenges like financial barriers and resistance to change persist. Studies underscore that successful implementation depends on community participation, appropriate technology, and responsive governance. To enhance awareness and drive support, animation emerges as a powerful advocacy tool, as it can humanize fisherfolk's struggles, promote livelihood programs, and emotionally engage diverse audiences. Animated films like *Flow, Ang Lihim ni Lea, and Fisher's Tales* demonstrate the medium's potential to translate complex issues into compelling narratives, fostering empathy and encouraging public and policy action.

However, while extensive research exists on the conditions of fisherfolk and the impact of livelihood programs, there remains a gap in translating these findings into creative, accessible, and culturally resonant storytelling formats. Few studies explore the use of 2D animation to portray the lived experiences of fisherfolk and to highlight institutional responses to their struggles. This study addresses that gap by producing a 2D animated short film that both raises awareness of fisherfolk realities and showcases how institutional efforts can contribute to their empowerment and sustainable development.

Conceptual Framework

The conceptual framework of this study, as illustrated in Figure 1, outlines the structured phases of the 2D animation production process, emphasizing the integration of various tools and techniques to achieve a high-quality final output. This framework incorporates key methods such as data collection, scripting, storyboarding, illustration, animation, voice acting, sound design, editing, and rendering to ensure a systematic and efficient workflow.

The framework is divided into three primary phases: Pre-production, Production, and Post-production, each encompassing essential tasks that contribute to the development of a polished animation.

The development of AnakDagat closely follows academic models that inform both creative and technical decisions across the animation pipeline, which includes Pre-production, Production, and post-production phases, each encompassing essential tasks that contribute to the development of a polished animation.

Pre-production focuses on planning and concept development. It involves data collection, idea generation, scripting, storyboarding, character and environment design, and animatic creation. At this stage, *Mayer's Cognitive Theory of Multimedia Learning* (Mayer, 2009) was applied to ensure the combination of narration and visual elements would enhance learning and message retention among viewers.

Production is dedicated to the creation of visual and audio assets. It includes illustration, animation, voice acting, sound design, and scene composition. Drawing from Paul Wells (Wells, 2002), Yellowbrick (2024), and RMCAD (2024), this stage emphasizes emotional tone, advocacy messaging, and culturally resonant design to foster empathy for fisherfolk communities.

Post-production involves refinement and finalization. This includes editing, color grading, rendering, quality assurance, and distribution. During this phase, the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) was used to evaluate the animation's reception through surveys measuring perceived usefulness and ease of understanding, key TAM variables for assessing audience impact.

By integrating theoretical frameworks directly into each production stage, AnakDagat becomes not just a storytelling tool but a purposeful medium for advocacy, education, and public awareness.

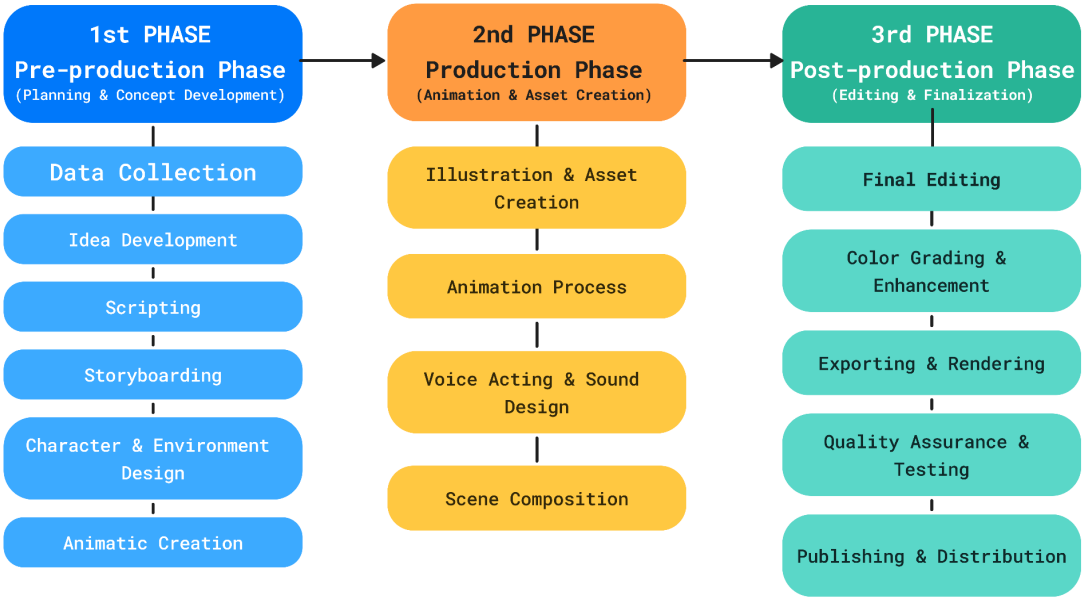


Figure 1. Conceptual Framework of the Study

CHAPTER 3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter presents all the methods and processes used in the development of this animated short film. It covers the data, software, hardware, animation development model, study population, sampling design, data collection, and project design.

Data Gathering

To create a 2d short animated film about the life and struggles of fisherfolk and coastal communities and the impact of programs such as but not limited to the F/B Pagbabago Program, the researchers incorporated animation development, sampling strategies, study population, data collection tools, and statistical analysis.

Animation Development Model

2D animation is the art of creating movement in a two-dimensional space. Raster drawings are used to develop characters, storyboards, and backgrounds.

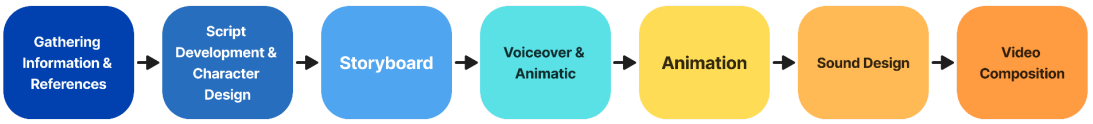


Figure 2. The Animation Process

This figure shows the animation production process in seven steps: Gathering information, script and character design, storyboard, voiceover and animatic, animation, sound design, and final video composition.

Gathering Information and Development

Gathering information is a crucial part of both the research and creative brief process, as it ensures that the animated film presents accurate, grounded, and meaningful content. The researchers consulted official references such as government reports and surveys to understand the realities faced by fisherfolk communities and the impact of the F/B Pagbabago Program. This program, spearheaded by the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR), aims to replace traditional wooden boats with safer, more sustainable fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) boats. It includes the development of standardized manuals and practices to ensure quality in boat production. In 2023 alone, the program reported over 1,000 beneficiaries, highlighting its role in supporting fisherfolk recovery and modernization.

Beyond written sources, the researchers also watched documentaries about the lives of fisherfolk to gain deeper insights into their daily experiences, struggles, and hopes. These visual narratives helped humanize the data, offering emotional and cultural nuances that raw numbers cannot fully capture. To further strengthen the authenticity of the film, the team also plans to conduct interviews with local fisherfolk, gathering first-hand accounts that can inform and enrich the storytelling process.

In addition to that, the researchers participated in the program “Makipamuhay, Makipag-aralan,” organized by the Concerned Artists of the Philippines (CAP) in partnership with PAMALAKAYA, Anakdagat, and the UP Diliman College of Social Work and Community Development, with support from the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research and Development. The program provided an immersive experience in fishing communities across

Binangonan, Navotas, and Cavite, where the researchers engaged in Basic Mass Integrations. These activities included situationer discussions and community art workshops with fisherfolk youth, allowing the researchers to gain firsthand insight into the lived experiences, challenges, and cultural nuances of the communities. This immersion was instrumental in informing the development of the 2D animated film and ensuring that the narrative reflects authentic perspectives.

This multi-source approach combining reports, visual media, and personal narratives ensures that the script is not only factually accurate but also emotionally resonant. The insights gathered shaped character development, dialogue, and scenes in a way that honors the lived realities of the community. Ultimately, this careful and empathetic research process supports the film’s message and objectives, allowing it to become a sincere and compelling reflection of fisherfolk life.

This documentary focuses on the lives of female fisherfolk in the town of General Nakar, Quezon. Sandra Aguinaldo profiles women like Ceniza Abayon, a 40-year-old mother of four, who ventures into the sea before dawn to provide for her family, especially as her husband tends to their hospitalized child. The film also features Esther Necesario, 68, and her niece Clarissa Complitado, 19, who use long fishing lines with hundreds of hooks to catch fish, working tirelessly amidst strong waves and darkness. "Ahon" (which means "to rise") captures the resilience and determination of these women as they navigate the challenges of their profession, highlighting their crucial role in sustaining their communities.

Set in the coastal village of San Ramon in Rapu-Rapu, Albay, this documentary follows the lives of young and adult fishermen who rely on the sea for their daily sustenance. Kara David highlights the story of 13-year-old Biboy dela Cruz, who, despite his youth, dives and fishes to contribute to his family's needs. The film delves into the traditional fishing method known as "taksay," where fishermen venture into the Pacific Ocean at night, braving the cold and darkness with hopes of a bountiful catch. However, the documentary underscores the diminishing returns of their labor, raising concerns about overfishing and environmental degradation. Through poignant storytelling, it sheds light on the challenges faced by these communities and the pressing need for sustainable fishing practices.

Figure 3. Community visit in Binangonan, Rizal

Script Writing

Script writing is the foundational stage in creating a 2D animated film, serving as the blueprint that guides all aspects of production, including visual and auditory elements. It involves crafting the narrative, defining the plot structure, character arcs, dialogue, and thematic focus. For animated short films, the process begins with identifying a compelling idea or central theme and building a storyline that supports it. The film uses a three-act structure,

including the setup, confrontation, and resolution. It also incorporates story beats such as the inciting incident, turning points, and climax to shape a cohesive story. Characters are developed with clear motivations and personalities that align with the narrative's progression. The script also includes detailed scene directions, dialogue, and mood descriptions to support visualization. Through ideation, drafting, and revision, the script evolves into a polished foundation that balances emotional engagement, thematic depth, and visual storytelling, paving the way for a captivating animated film.

For this film the researchers developed a Screenplay script, a written document that outlines the story, dialogue, and action for the film. Below is an excerpt from the screenplay, the full screenplay script is available for viewing in appendix B.

Screenplay Script

ACT I

INT. ANDREI'S HOME – DAY
ANDREI, 22, sits at a small desk. A blank page glares back at him. He twirls a pen, frustrated.

ANDREI
(softly, muttering)
Pwede siguro yung… wait baka kasi. Sige yun na lang… ughh teka nga.

He taps his pen and sighs

Magkape nga muna ako.

He leans back, his eyes drifting to a dusty **paper boat** by a family photo. Something stirs in him, memories flood him; the sound of the waves crashing, and his and his brother’s faint laughter.

CUT TO: **FLASHBACK**

EXT. COASTLINE – LATE AFTERNOON
KIKO and **ANDREI** sit by the water's edge to watch the waves cradle the paper boats they have set afloat.

KIKO
'Doy, tignan mo yung bangka mo ang tibay. Hindi pa rin lumulubog.

ANDREI
Parang yung bangka natin. Pano yun, eh papel lang yung bangka

KIKO
Kahit ang papel kayang suungin ang mga alon, basta naniniwala sya sa sarili nya. Dapat ikaw rin, kaya mo ba yun?

He smiles, and Andrei gets giddy. On the boat, Marina beckons to signal their last catch of the day.

MARINA (O.S.)
Kiko! Andoy! Halina't mauubusan tayo ng liwanag.

Kiko and Andrei turn to her direction and look at each other.

KIKO
Tara na, naghihintay ang mga alon. At si Ima. Ang mahuli amoy bilasang tilapia!

Kiko said playfully, teasing as he jogs toward the boat, and Andrei sprints to catch his brother.

EXT. AT SEA - AFTERNOON
We see their boat cut through the water, finding the makeshift buoy of a soda bottle. Kiko is in front, reeling in nets and unhooking the fish caught.

EXT. SHORELINE – DUSK
The boat docks on the sand. The family gets off happy. However, their happiness is cut short when a community member frantically approaches them.

FISHERFOLK 1
Kiko! Si Ka. Ely nahuli nanaman daw.

KIKO
Nanaman? O sya halika na.

INT. HOUSE – NIGHT
Marina watches the news while Andrei is lying on the floor with his crayons out, drawing in his notebook. News about an upcoming typhoon can be heard.

MARINA
Kamusta si Ka. Ely?

KIKO
Ayun po, nagbayad ng dyis-mil, pangalawang beses na daw ho kasi.

MARINA
Bakit naman kasi ganoon, may mga barkong banyaga ngang nanghihimasok dine.

KIKO
Pasalamat na lamang ho at hindi nila sinaktan, hindi katulad ni Ama-.

Marina cuts him off sharply

MARINA
Pst! Uy uy uy, Kiko! Sinabi nang…

Raindrops pound on their metal roof.

KIKO
Ayan na pala ang bagyo, naku lalaot muna kami Ima, 'doy gusto mo ng bangus na ulam? Ihuhuli ka ni kuya.

MARINA
Oh sige, mag-iingat kayo ha! 'Doy pasara naman ng bintana dali

CUT TO: CHILDLIKE DRAWINGS
We see a world drawn in Andrei's perspective as he narrates the tragedies in his life: A boat fighting furious waves during a storm. A gun shooting. And a monster

ANDREI (V.O.)
Maraming natatakot sa mga alon, pero hindi si Kuya. Sabi nya babalik sya…

May mga nagsasabing di na daw babalik si kuya dahil nadala sya ng malakas na alon. Parang si Amang, kasi nabaril daw ng mga guwardyang bantay sa mga fishpen.

Pero ang sabi ni Ima, ay meron daw nilalabanang halimaw si kuya sa dagat, na kumuha kay Amang dati. Siguro hanggang ngayon nilalabanan nya yun. alam kong mananalo si kuya, siya ang pinakamalakas.

We see a vision of a paper boat sinking. The drawings crumple into blackness. We hear Marina's Anguish as we see Kiko's destroyed boat on the shore. Andoy is back

alone, at the shore where he and Kiko used to sit.
Waiting for his kuya to come back.

Hanggang ngayon hinihintay ko pa rin
siyang bumalik…

EXT. SHORELINE – AFTERNOON
A few days later, Marina and Andoy are back at the shore, beside Kiko's boat, which they patched up.

ANDREI
Ima, sasama ako.

MARINA
Hindi pwede 'Doy, hayaan mo na lang na
si Ima muna.

ANDREI
Pero Ima wala ka pong katulong…

MARINA
SINABI NANG… Ang ibig kong sabihin…
Kaya to ni Ima. Wag ka na mag-alala ha,
umuwi ka na muna sa bahay at may
assignment ka pang gagawin diba?

Marina kissed Andrei's forehead as a silent seal of promise between them. Andrei watches anxiously as she pushes off and revs the boat's repurposed engine to go to the dark waters.
Andrei sits down on the sand and pleads.

ANDREI
Dagat… ibabalik mo sakin si Ima.

End of Act 1

Character Design

Character development is the process of creating the visual and emotional identity of each character within the story. This includes determining their physical appearance, clothing, posture, facial expressions, and symbolic attributes that reflect their personality, background, and role in the narrative. Character development is guided by the script to align emotional tone with visual design to understand the emotional range and relationships. Visual elements such as color palettes, line styles, and proportions are used to convey psychological depth and audience relatability. Character turnaround

sheets and expression charts are typically developed at this stage to serve as references for animators later on.

In the following section, we detail the character designs for Andrei "Andoy" Dalampasigan, Marina "Rina" Dalampasigan, and Francisco "Kiko" Dalampasigan. Each design has been thoughtfully developed to visually embody the characters' personalities, emotional journeys, and narrative significance.

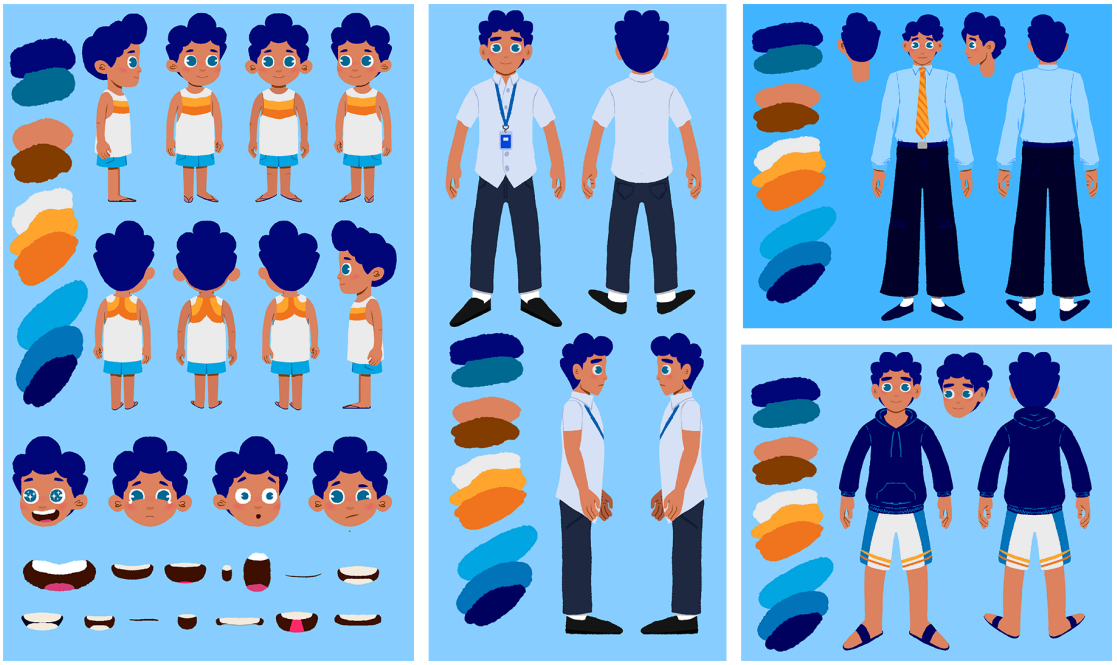


Figure 4. Andrei Character Sheets

Andrei "Andoy" Dalampasigan is a young man shaped by both the tenderness of his childhood memories and the heavy weight of early responsibility. At 22, with flashbacks showing him from ages 10 to 19, Andoy carries the sun-kissed skin and slender frame of someone raised by the sea. His color palette is inspired by the various blue hues of the seas and the sunny sky, with accents of orange and yellows that compliments his warm personality. His thoughtful eyes reveal a soul both wounded and hopeful.

Practical in appearance, he often wears simple shirts, worn jeans, or a school uniform, reflecting his modest upbringing. Initially a quiet dreamer, Andoy's journey is defined by his struggle between honoring the past and stepping toward a new future. Driven by a deep loyalty to his mother and the memory of his father, he grows from a hesitant boy into a grounded leader who bridges tradition and progress. He is often symbolized through the paper boat, a quiet but powerful metaphor for his enduring spirit and aspirations.

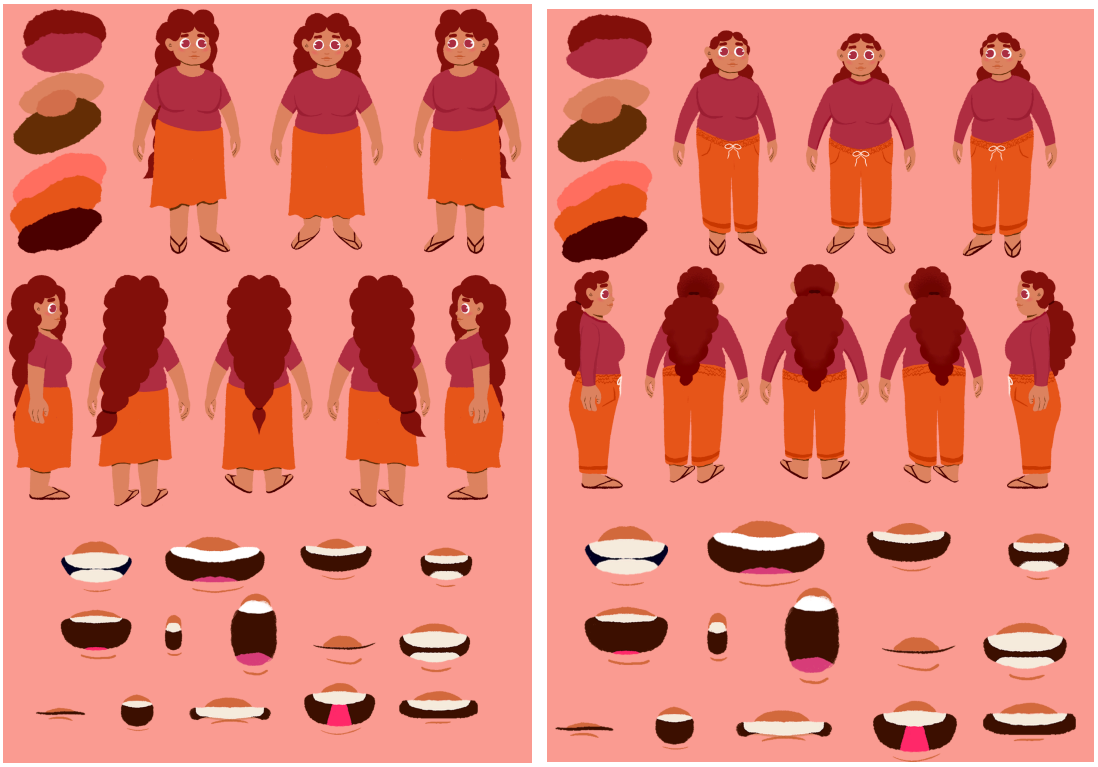


Figure 5. Marina Character Sheets

Marina "Rina" Dalampasigan embodies resilience forged by love and necessity. Introduced in her late 20s during flashbacks, Marina is a pillar of quiet strength in the fishing village. Her color palette is inspired by the coral of the sea floor, grounded but still fiery with warmth and nurture. Her appearance evolves, from flowy skirt and loose hair in Act I where she only stayed inland and sold fish at the market, to practical clothing suited for life at sea and tightly tied hair when she took up the mantle of being the main breadwinner of

the family. Yet there is a grace in her movements, a quiet dignity that commands respect. Fiercely independent and deeply protective, Marina hides her vulnerability behind stubborn pride, believing that shielding Andoy from hardship is the ultimate act of love.

Figure 6. Kiko Character Sheet

Francisco "Kiko" Dalampasigan is the older brother of Andrei and the first born son of Marina. His steady, comforting presence that lingers in memory even after his untimely death. A fisherman in his early 20s, Kiko's rugged appearance, sun-worn skin, calloused hands, and a ready smile, speaks of a life spent working with nature's rhythms despite being just a young adult. His color palette is a mix of greens and yellows inspired by sea algae sea weeds and seaplants, and he also shares the warm yellow tones with his brother. In lore, the yellow comes from their late father who is mentioned in the story, which they adapted as a remembrance of him. Warm, wise, and deeply compassionate, he imparts quiet life lessons to his younger

brother. Kiko's brief but poignant presence in the narrative anchors Andoy's values and dreams, serving as a spiritual guide long after he is physically gone.

Storyboard

Storyboarding was the visual representation of the script, consisting of sequential drawings that outlined the film's key scenes. This stage served as the bridge between the written narrative and the animation phase, offering a visual framework of camera angles, character movement, scene transitions, and timing. Each panel in the storyboard acted as a visual cue for how a particular scene would unfold. It also included annotations on lighting and dialogue timing. Storyboards were often reviewed and revised multiple times to optimize visual flow and narrative clarity before animation began.

The following are selected storyboard frames that guided the animators on the ratio, composition, camera angles, and lighting. See Appendix C for the full storyboard.

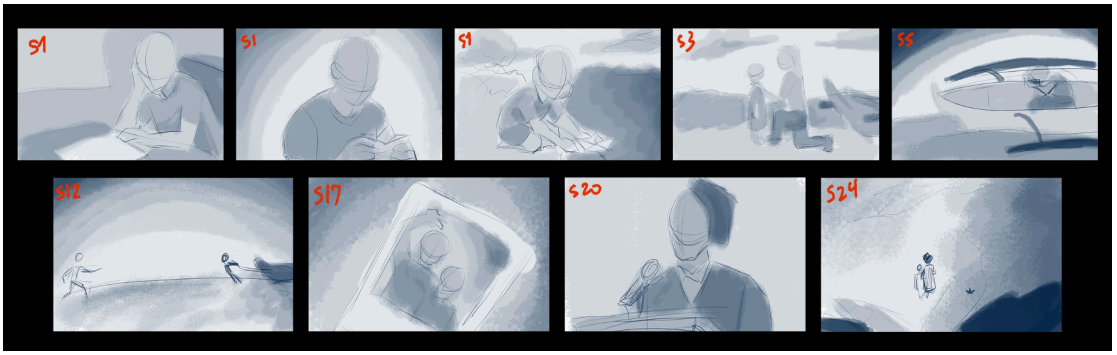


Figure 7. Narrative Outline in Storyboard

The figure 7 presents the outline of the film in storyboard form, showing the flow of key moments and the progression of the narrative. Key scenes are picked to represent the sequences.

Voiceover & Animatic

Voiceover and animatic development serve as the foundation for aligning the narrative with the visual elements of the animation. This stage begins with the recording of character dialogues and narration. Voice actors bring personality and emotion to the script. Special attention is given to vocal tone, pacing, and clarity to ensure that each line resonates with the intended mood and meaning. Once the voice recordings are finalized, they are synchronized with a rough sequence of storyboard images to create an animatic, a simplified, animated version of the film that acts as a blueprint for the final animation. The animatic allows the researchers to visualize the story's timing, rhythm, and scene transitions. It helps identify areas for improvement early in the process, such as pacing issues, unclear sequences, or mismatched audio and visuals, allowing for refinement before proceeding to full animation production.

Animation

Animation is the final stage where illustrations, sound effects, and storyboards are brought to life through movement. This stage involves creating frame-by-frame sequences or using digital tools to simulate motion, giving characters the ability to act, react, and express emotions. The animation process is highly technical and requires careful attention to detail. Elements such as timing, spacing, anticipation, and exaggeration are applied to enhance realism and emotional impact. Depending on the software, the production may involve 2D rigging, tweening, or traditional hand-drawn techniques.

Sound Design

Sound design involved the creation and integration of background sounds and environmental effects to support the mood and setting of each scene, including elements such as footsteps, weather, environmental noises, and other ambient effects that brought the animated world to life. It also included crafting or selecting sound effects that enhanced specific actions or events, such as rustling leaves, clinking glasses, or the swoosh of movement. Dialogue recording and editing were essential, ensuring that character voices were clear, expressive, and synchronized with the animation. Music played a pivotal role in establishing the emotional tone and pacing of the story, and in this project, the researchers composed an original score tailored to the film's themes and visuals. This original music, combined with precise timing and layering of all auditory elements, created a rich, immersive soundscape that enhanced the narrative and viewing experience.

Video Composition

Video composition is the final phase where all visual and auditory elements are integrated to produce a cohesive, polished animation. This includes assembling the fully animated scenes, synchronizing voiceovers, layering sound effects and music, and applying visual effects such as lighting, motion blur, and color correction. Transitions between scenes are refined for smoothness and narrative flow, while visual continuity is ensured through consistent color grading and framing. Titles, credits, and any necessary on-screen text are added during this stage. Rendering the animation into its final format involves adjusting resolution and compression settings to ensure the highest possible quality for viewing and distribution. The goal of this stage

is to create a seamless and engaging final product that effectively conveys the story and message of the research project.

To enhance the cinematic quality of the animated short film, all animated sequences and sound elements were imported into DaVinci Resolve for final composition. This stage involved refining the overall look and feel of the film through the application of lighting effects, visual filters, and simulated camera movements to create a more immersive and polished viewing experience. The composition process served as the final step in visual post-production, ensuring that the film was cohesive, visually appealing, and ready for public presentation.

Software Specifications

The following programs were utilized by the researchers in making the animated film:

Adobe Photoshop

Adobe Photoshop is a raster-based image editing and digital painting software that offers tools for drawing, coloring, texturing, and compositing. It supports custom brushes, layering systems, and advanced selection techniques, making it ideal for asset creation. In the film, Adobe Photoshop was used during the pre-production phase to illustrate and refine character designs, props, and backgrounds, ensuring that each visual element aligns with the overall tone and aesthetic of the animation.

Adobe After Effects

Adobe After Effects is a professional motion graphics and visual effects software that enables the creation of complex animations, scene transitions,

and compositing. It supports keyframing, particle effects, and integration with other Adobe tools. This software was utilized in the post-production phase of the film to enhance visual storytelling through special effects, animated text overlays, and scene transitions, contributing to a more polished and immersive final output.

Audacity

Audacity is a powerful, free, open-source audio editor that has been available for quite some time. The software facilitates the import, combination, mixing, and rendering of output. It also offers flexible editing down to the sample level, spectral views, and spectrograms for assessing frequency response. The researchers worked to increase the audio quality of the animated films. Audacity was used particularly for adding, editing, and combining sound effects, dialogue recordings, and music.

Da Vinci Resolve

DaVinci Resolve is a professional-grade video editing and color correction software known for its advanced grading capabilities, timeline editing, and audio sync tools. It integrates editing, color, visual effects, and audio post-production in one application. This software was used in the post-production phase to assemble scenes, enhance color balance, and render the final cut of the animated film.

Hardware Specifications

The creation of engaging and impactful animated films is made possible through the use of reliable and capable hardware that supports the technical demands of animation production. In this study, various devices

were used to develop the 2D animated short film, from drawing the initial frames to final rendering and editing. These tools allowed the researchers to work efficiently while ensuring high-quality visual and audio output. The primary hardware includes a laptop for animation and editing, an iPad for mobility and additional drawing tasks, and a pen tablet for the bulk of the frame by frame animation. The specifications for each device are detailed in the tables below.

Table 2. Laptop Specifications

LAPTOP SPECIFICATIONS	
Processor:	Intel(R) Core(TM) i7-7700HQ CPU @ 2.80GHz 2.81 GHz
GPU:	NVIDIA GeForce GTX 1050
Installed RAM:	16.00 GB
System type:	64-bit operating system, x64-based processor
Windows edition:	Windows 10

The primary device used in the animation production was a laptop with an Intel(R) Core(TM) i7-7700HQ processor, 16GB RAM, and an NVIDIA GeForce GTX 1050 graphics card. These specifications ensured that the researchers could handle graphic-intensive tasks such as 2D animation rendering, video editing, and layering multiple visual and audio assets.

Table 3. IPad Specifications

IPAD SPECIFICATIONS	
Processor:	6-core CPU wit\ 4-core GPU, 16-core Neural Engine.
Installed RAM:	16.00 GB
System type:	A14 Bionic chip

The iPad with an A14 Bionic chip and 16GB RAM supported sketching, storyboarding, and digital drawing. Its fast processor and GPU allowed efficient use of drawing apps for concept art and keyframes.

Table 4. Pen Tablet Specifications

PEN TABLET SPECIFICATIONS	
Model:	XPPen Deco 01 v2
Interface Resolution:	10" x 6.25", 5080 LPI, wired USB-C with 200RPS(max)
Stylus:	Battery-free, 60° Tilt with ±0.01 inch Accuracy & 8192 Pressure Sensitivity Levels

The XPPen Deco 01 v2 pen tablet, with high resolution and 8192 pressure sensitivity, enabled precise and natural strokes. Its battery-free stylus enhances workflow, making it suitable for character design and animation frames.

Population of the Study

The population of this study includes fifty (50) total respondents, consisting of two (2) animation experts to critique the technical proficiency of the animation and the structure of the story, one (1) Community Consultant from the fisherfolk community to verify the factual accuracy of the information presented in the film.

The remaining forty-seven (47) respondents are selected participants from relevant communities and academic backgrounds. Twenty (20) selected respondents. These respondents include ten (10) fisherfolk and coastal community members who represent the primary target audience, five (5) College of Fisheries students who bring academic insight into fisheries-related issues, and five (5) Communication and Media students who offer perspectives on visual storytelling and message delivery. The combination of these groups ensures a comprehensive evaluation of the animated film from technical, content, and audience relevance standpoints.

To complete the population, twenty-seven (27) general audience members were also included to provide broader viewer perspectives. These consisted of senior high or college students, young professionals, or residents from coastal areas. The inclusion of a general audience group ensured that the film’s clarity, emotional impact, and accessibility were evaluated from a non-specialist point of view.

Sampling Design

The main objective of this research is to produce a 2D animated film titled AnakDagat, which focuses on the struggles of small-scale fisherfolk and the positive impact of the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR)'s F/B Pagbabago Program. The film aims to amplify the voices of underrepresented communities and raise awareness about poverty alleviation and sustainable fishing practices.

To gather feedback, a close-ended questionnaire was administered to selected participants. This type of questionnaire allowed respondents to choose from predetermined options, which helped standardize data collection

and simplify the analysis. The structured format ensured clarity and consistency in assessing the animation's acceptability and message delivery.

Statistical Treatment of Data

The research employed descriptive statistics as its primary statistical method. The responses from the questionnaire were summarized using the Median (M) to interpret the central tendency of the data. All collected responses were encoded into Microsoft Excel and analyzed using IBM SPSS software to generate findings related to the film's reception, particularly in terms of perceived usefulness, clarity, and emotional engagement. These results were vital in determining how well the AnakDagat film communicated its intended message.

Data Collection Instrument

A closed-ended questionnaire was used to assess the effectiveness of the AnakDagat short animated film. The questionnaire was designed using a 5-point Likert scale, where respondents rated their level of agreement with statements concerning the film's clarity, message relevance, animation quality, emotional impact, and overall effectiveness. The scale is interpreted as follows:

Each item in the questionnaire was crafted to align with the experiences and knowledge of the respondents. The estimated completion time was 10 to 20 minutes. A content expert from the field of social advocacy and a communication specialist validated the questionnaire to ensure its accuracy and relevance to the target audience and goals of the film.

Table 5. Likert Scale

RATING	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
5	Strongly Agree
4	Agree
3	Neutral
2	Disagree
1	Strongly Disagree

Table 6. Reliability Test Result for Technology Acceptance Model

CATEGORIES	CRONBACH'S ALPHA	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
Perceived Usefulness	.839	Good
Perceived Ease of Use	.857	Good
Aesthetic Quality	.814	Good
Perceived Enjoyment	.789	Acceptable
Attitude Towards Use	.883	Good
Behavioral Intention to Use	.872	Good
Composite Score	**0.845**	**Good**

Legend: above .90 = Excellent, 0.80-0.89 = Good, 0.70-0.79 = Acceptable, 0.60-0.69 = Questionable, 0.50-0.59 = Poor, below 0.50 = Unacceptable

Table 6 shows the reliability test results for the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) constructs. All constructs, including Perceived Usefulness, Perceived Ease of Use, Attitude toward Using, and Behavioral Intention to Use demonstrated acceptable internal consistency with Cronbach's alpha values above the recommended threshold of 0.70.

Research Design

This study employs a descriptive research design to evaluate the acceptability of the developed project titled "AnakDagat", a 2D short animated film that promotes the F/B Pagbabago Program of the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR). The film is intended to serve as an alternative medium for raising awareness about the struggles of small-scale fisherfolk and the impact of government interventions in coastal communities.

A structured questionnaire was prepared and validated by an animation expert and a communication specialist to ensure its appropriateness and relevance. Their expertise was valuable in assessing the film's clarity, emotional appeal, message delivery, and overall effectiveness. After the validation process, the film was shown to the target respondents, followed by the administration of the questionnaire to gather feedback on the film's content and quality.

To guide the evaluation of the film's effectiveness, the study adopted the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM).

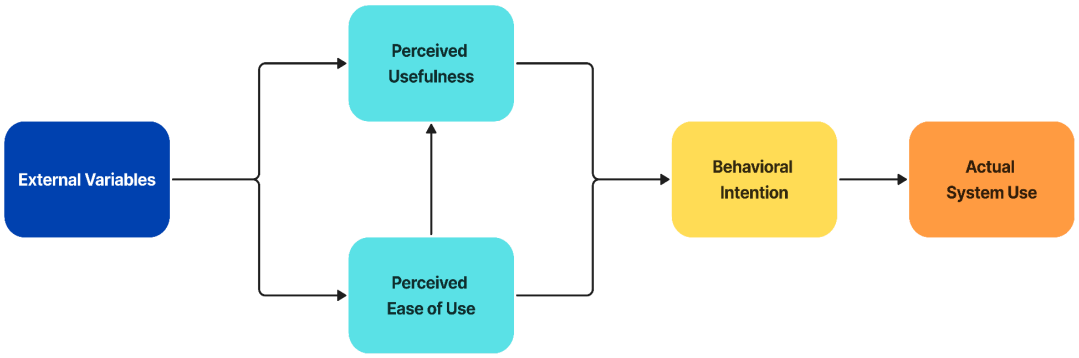


Figure 8. Technology Acceptance Model

Figure 8 illustrates the TAM framework, which is often used by developers and researchers to understand how users accept and adapt to new technologies or innovations. In this context, TAM is applied to understand

the acceptance of AnakDagat as an innovative form of public information and advocacy.

The model involved identifying key influencing factors, most notably perceived usefulness and perceived ease of understanding, that shaped audience reception. Data were collected through survey responses from selected participants representing the intended audience. These included fisherfolk and coastal community members, College of Fisheries students, Communication and Media students, and experts in animation and advocacy.

The responses served as the foundation for analyzing how well the film aligned with its goals of raising awareness, educating communities, and promoting government efforts. Based on the analysis, conclusions were drawn and recommendations were made for further development and wider implementation.

The use of TAM in this project provided a structured and theoretical basis for evaluating the film's reception. It also offered valuable insights that could inform future improvements or guide the development of similar educational or advocacy-based animation projects.

Ethical Considerations

This study upheld ethical standards by ensuring that no harm was done to any individuals, cultural values, or the environment during the development and production of the *AnakDagat* animated film. No AI tools were used in creating any part of the film; all visual assets, writing, and animation were produced manually by the researchers and artists involved. This decision was made to preserve the authenticity of the creative process and to ensure that

the final output reflected the genuine skills, intentions, and cultural sensitivity of its human creators. Additionally, all information gathered from participants remained confidential and was used strictly for research and academic purposes only.

CHAPTER 4

RESULTS AND CONCLUSION

In this chapter, the findings of the study are presented and examined in relation to the overarching aim of the project. The results are organized according to the stated research objectives and interpreted using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) as the primary evaluative framework. This chapter integrates the data gathered during the community immersion, the processes involved in the development of the 2D animated film, and the evaluation responses collected from field experts and non-technical viewers. Through this synthesis, the discussion demonstrates how each component of the research contributed to meeting the project's goals. Furthermore, the chapter provides a comprehensive interpretation of the film's acceptability and effectiveness based on user perceptions, thereby establishing the extent to which the study fulfilled its intended purpose.

Results by Objectives

Main Objective

The main objective of this study is to develop a 2D animated short film that raises awareness of the lived experiences of small-scale Filipino fisherfolk, while also highlighting the role and impact of government initiatives in addressing the sector's challenges. The film seeks to offer an honest and empathetic portrayal of the fisherfolk community while showing how institutional efforts affect their lives in hopes of inspiring future initiatives from both government and non-government institutions. This objective was achieved through extensive data gathering, careful story development, and the intentional use of appropriate animation tools and techniques.

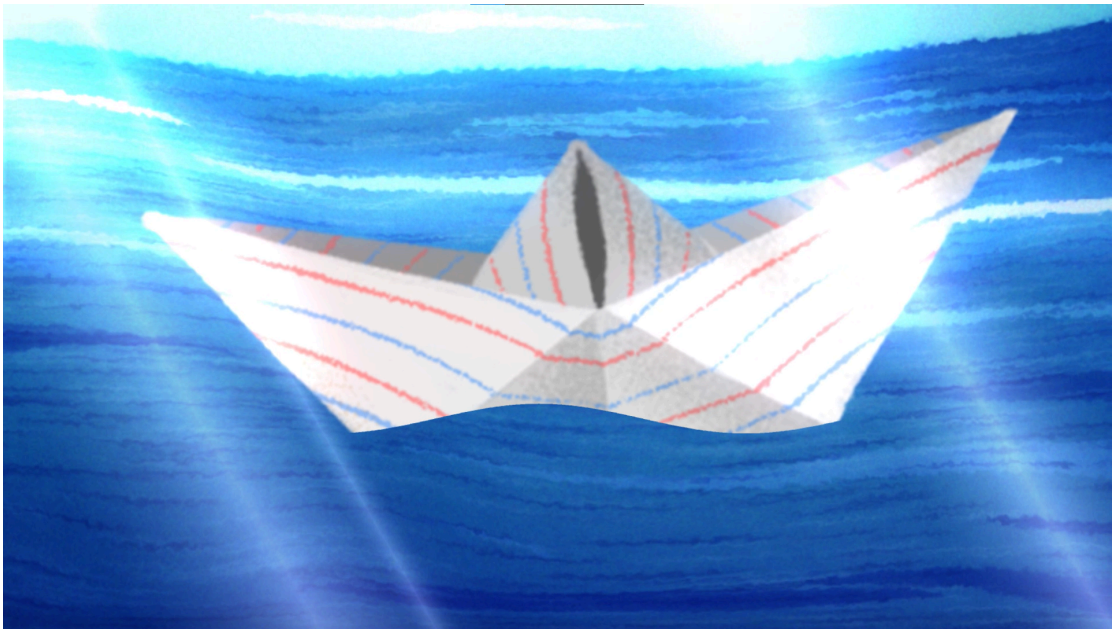


Figure 9. Introduction of the film

Figure 9 is a screen capture of the first shot of the film that was made.

To gather data on the life and difficulties encountered by small-scale fisherfolk and positive changes brought by programs and initiatives by government and non-government organizations, such as, but not limited to the F/B Pagbabago Program.

The researchers collaborated with several government and non-government organizations working closely with small-scale fisherfolk communities across the CALABARZON region. *(a)* Through these partnerships, they were introduced to the program “Makipamuhay, Makipag-aralan,” led by the Concerned Artists of the Philippines (CAP) in collaboration with PAMALAKAYA, Anakdagat, and the UP Diliman College of Social Work and Community Development, with support from the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research and Development. This program provides volunteers with immersive exposure to fishing communities in Binangonan,

Navotas, and Cavite, facilitating situationer discussions, participatory community art workshops, and other activities aimed at understanding local challenges, cultural practices, and the perspectives of fisherfolk youth.

As part of the immersion, the researchers stayed in the community of Brgy. Gupiing, Binangonan, Rizal for a total of five days, spending the first three days building relationships and getting to know the residents, and the remaining two days conducting Basic Mass Integration (BMI) Art Workshops with fisherfolk youth *(b)*. During this stay, the researchers heard firsthand accounts and personal stories that are not available online, providing exclusive insights that enriched the development of the animated film. In collaboration with the fisherfolk, a song was written, composed, and performed during the BMI workshops, which was later incorporated into the film's ending, courtesy of the organization *(c)*. This extended engagement allowed the researchers to observe and participate in the daily life of small-scale fisherfolk, gaining a deeper understanding of their socio-economic struggles, cultural practices, and the impact of environmental and policy changes on their livelihoods. Beyond the immersion, the researchers engaged in continuous learning through situationers, seminars, and discussions both before and after the visit, further strengthening their understanding of the community's realities. The stories, observations, and lived experiences documented during this process became the foundation for developing the 2D animated film's storyline and script, ensuring that the narrative authentically reflects the perspectives and experiences of the fisherfolk community.

(a)

(b)

(c)

Figure 10. Basic Mass Integration Art Workshop

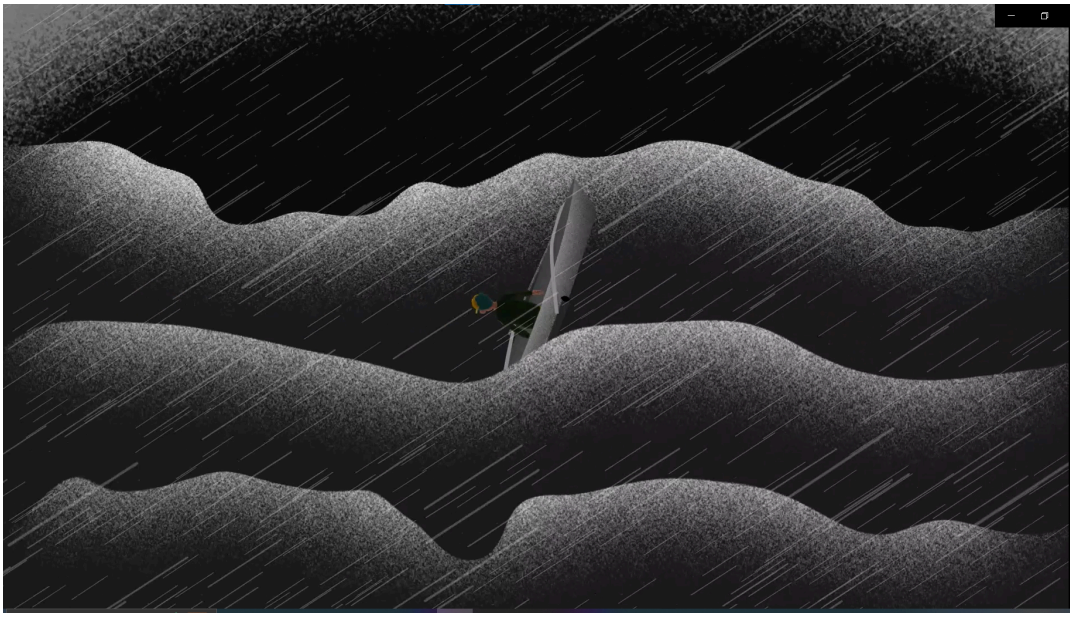
To develop a story and a 2D animated short film based on the collected data that effectively communicate the program's goals and impact.

Using data gathered from academic literature and firsthand immersion, the researchers developed a narrative inspired by the lived struggles of small-scale fisherfolk. Insights from direct observations, personal accounts. The narrative was designed to reflect both the external pressures experienced by the community and the internal responses of resilience, uncertainty, and aspiration that emerged from the immersion.

Starting with Act I, here is where central characters and their family dynamics are introduced, establishing the socio-economic conditions that form the core conflict of the story *(a)*. This opening act contextualizes the daily realities of small-scale fisherfolk and presents the immediate challenges posed by environmental shifts, limited livelihood opportunities, and policy constraints. The act functions as the narrative foundation, grounding the audience in the lived realities documented during the immersion.

This act also establishes the root of their internal turmoil through Kiko's death during an accident out at sea. Andrei and Marina's grief are shown in very different ways. Andrei's process is shown as crayon drawings with fantastical elements with monsters and metaphors, it is shown as if an adult explains death to a child. While Marina's recollection is shown bluntly, dark, and depressive *(b)*. It is here where her fear of losing her last remaining loved one starts to seed. Causing her to be overprotective with Andrei, not bringing him along out to sea and teaching him the ropes. Little does she know, this sets Andrei up to fail somewhere along the line.

(a)



(b)

Figure 11. Act 1 Opening & Main Conflict

Figure 11. Shows scenes where all the characters of the story are revealed, and a scene that introduces the start of the main conflict.

The Interlude serves as a brief narrative pause between Act I and Act II. It provides space for reflection, allowing viewers to absorb the weight of the initial conflict before transitioning into the heightened tension of the succeeding act. This structural element emphasizes the shift from exposition

toward escalation, guiding the audience deeper into the emotional experiences portrayed. Here the story also hints at other deeper external problems through context clues in their conversation on their way back home.

(a)

(b)

Figure 12. Interlude and set up.

Figure 12. Shows scenes from the interlude that sets up Act II. Andrei and Marina have a conversation about the BFAR in their barangay *(a)*, which is followed by snapshots of the program and their process *(b)*.

After the set up in the interlude, we proceed to Act II. Which contains the rising action and climax. This act explores the inner turmoil caused by Kiko's accident; Marina's hesitation on bringing and letting Andrei come with her during sailing out to sea, especially with their boat's condition. And Andrei's anxiety with the situation of their boat but more importantly his mother's safety. This Anxiety caused him to have a nightmare about the monster that Marina told him about, that led to his anxiety attack *(a)*. Making him spiral and tunnel vision on finding Marina, and take their old unstable boat out of desperation. The act reflects findings from the immersion regarding the complex and often compounding struggles of small-scale fishers that are not often talked about, their mental well-being.

(a)

(b)

(c)

Figure 13. Climax.

Figure 13. Shows Andrei's anxiety induced nightmare that set up the Climax of him capsizing and almost drowning *(b)*. This act also shows the pay-off or impact of the program that they went to earlier, where Marina saves him with the help of their new boat *(c)*.

And finally, Act III. is the resolution and situates the narrative within a broader call to action. It concludes the character arc while emphasizing the need for sustained, context-sensitive, and community-informed support for fisherfolk. The act reinforces the study's findings that government and community-led programs, although beneficial, are not singular or universal solutions but rather components of a broader and ongoing effort toward community empowerment. This act was also inspired by a quote by Alfea Dalisolyones (GlobalWitness.Org, 2023) where she speaks about her hopes for the future generation and that dream is fulfilled in Andrei's story *(b)*. The quote goes, "My dream is for my children to finish their studies and for everything in our community to improve, to be clean and free from disasters", it has been slightly edited for clarity and brevity, but the message is still kept intact *(c)*.

(a)

(b)

(c)

Figure 14. Resolution and Call to action.

Figure 14. Shows Andrei receiving an acceptance letter then a time skip to his graduation *(a)*. And finally a final quote as a call to action.

In addition, a key thematic element across all acts is the use of the paper boat as an overarching symbol. While the wooden fishing boat

represents material livelihood and the tangible burdens carried by fisherfolk, the paper boat serves as a metaphor for fragility, hope, imagination, and generational aspiration. Its presence in the narrative reflects the vulnerability of small-scale fishing communities in the face of environmental and socio-economic threats, while also symbolizing the creativity, resilience, and enduring spirit observed during the immersion. The paper boat connects the documentary aspects of the film with its interpretive elements, grounding the narrative in lived experience while allowing space for contemplation and symbolic meaning.

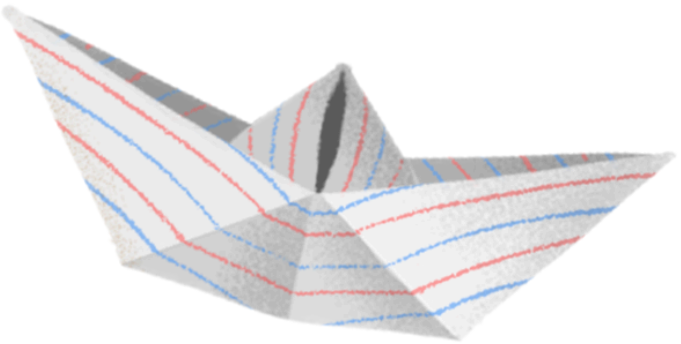


Figure 15. Paper Boat PNG.

Together, these narrative elements, combined with empirical data, community insights, and structured storytelling, result in a film that communicates the complexities of fisherfolk life while encouraging sustained attention, action, and support for small-scale fishing communities.

To evaluate the acceptability of the 2D animated film using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) framework through a structured questionnaire.

IT Expert's Response

Table 7. Technology Acceptance Model based on the IT Expert's Response

CATEGORY	MEAN	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
Perceived Usefulness	3.60	Agree
Perceived Ease of Use	4.27	Agree
Aesthetic Quality	4.13	Agree
Perceived Enjoyment	4.53	Strongly Agree
Attitude Towards Use	4.20	Agree
Behavioral Intention to Use	4.27	Agree
Overall TAM Mean	**4.17**	**Agree**

Legend: 1.00-1.49 = Strongly Disagree, 1.50-2.49 = Disagree, 2.50-3.49 = Neutral, 3.50-4.49 = Agree, 4.50-5.00 = Strongly Agree

Table 7 presents the summarized Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) results based on the responses of the IT experts. Overall, the animated film obtained an overall TAM mean of 4.17, which corresponds to a verbal interpretation of "Agree." This indicates that the IT experts generally accepted the film in terms of usefulness, usability, visual quality, enjoyment, and intention to use.

Among the six TAM categories, Perceived Enjoyment recorded the highest mean score (M = 4.53, Strongly Agree), suggesting that the experts found the film highly engaging and emotionally resonant. This implies that the film's storytelling, animation, and sound design effectively contributed to a positive viewing experience, which is essential in maintaining audience attention and enhancing message retention.

Perceived Ease of Use and Behavioral Intention to Use both obtained a mean score of 4.27 (Agree), indicating that the experts considered the film accessible, technically smooth, and suitable for viewing across different platforms. Moreover, the favorable behavioral intention suggests that IT experts are willing to recommend the film and consider its use as a reference or material for educational and promotional purposes.

Meanwhile, Aesthetic Quality received a mean score of 4.13 (Agree), reflecting positive evaluations of the film's animation quality, visual style, and overall presentation. Although some aspects, such as character representation, received neutral responses in the detailed analysis, the visuals were still regarded as effective in supporting the narrative and sustaining viewer engagement.

Attitude Towards Use and Perceived Usefulness obtained mean scores of 4.20 (Agree) and 3.60 (Agree), respectively. These results indicate that the film was perceived as informative and meaningful, contributing to the experts' understanding of fisherfolk issues while fostering a positive attitude toward supporting the community. However, the slightly lower score for perceived usefulness suggests that there is still room to further strengthen the depth of informational content and contextual emphasis.

Overall, the results demonstrate that the animated film was positively received by IT experts, not only as an engaging creative work but also as an effective tool for awareness, education, and advocacy. The favorable TAM results confirm the film's effectiveness in combining technical quality, visual storytelling, and meaningful content.

Respondent's Response

Table 8. Perceived Usefulness based on the Respondent's Response

STATEMENTS	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
Watching the film enhanced my understanding of the lives and struggles of Filipino fisherfolk.	4.7	0.46	Strongly Agree
The film presented accurate and relevant information about the fisherfolk community.	4.6	0.50	Strongly Agree
The film has a strong visual and emotional appeal that makes it interesting to watch.	4.55	0.62	Strongly Agree
The film "AnakDagat" effectively emphasized the importance of programs (government/non-government) in supporting fisherfolk communities.	4.6	0.56	Strongly Agree
The film influenced my understanding and opinions about the fisherfolk's situation.	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
Composite Mean	**4.59**		**Strongly Agree**

Legend: 1.00-1.49 = Strongly Disagree, 1.50-2.49 = Disagree, 2.50-3.49 = Neutral, 3.50-4.49 = Agree, 4.50-5.00 = Strongly Agree

Respondents indicated that the film enhanced their understanding of the lives and struggles of Filipino fisherfolk, and they agreed that it presented accurate and relevant information about the fishing community. They also found the film visually and emotionally engaging, making it interesting to watch. The importance of government and non-government programs supporting fisherfolk was clearly emphasized, contributing to the film's overall effectiveness. As a result, the film also influenced the respondents' perceptions and understanding of the fisherfolk's situation.

Respondent's Response

Table 9. Perceived Ease of Use based on the Respondent's Response

STATEMENTS	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
The film played smoothly and was accessible on different devices (e.g., laptop, phone).	4.4	0.76	Agree
The transitions, pacing, and timing of the animation make it easy to follow the story.	4.3	0.77	Agree
There were no technical issues while viewing the film.	4.4	0.63	Agree
The use of text, voice-over, and sound in animation supports easy interpretation of the message.	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
The film can be accessed without complex registration or setup requirements.	4.55	0.62	Strongly Agree
Composite Mean	**4.45**		**Agree**

Legend: 1.00-1.49 = Strongly Disagree, 1.50-2.49 = Disagree, 2.50-3.49 = Neutral, 3.50-4.49 = Agree, 4.50-5.00 = Strongly Agree

Respondents agreed that the film played smoothly across devices and that the timing, pacing, and transitions helped them follow the story easily. They reported minimal technical issues while viewing and recognized that the film's use of text, narration, and audio supported clear message interpretation. They also appreciated its accessibility without complicated setup requirements. Overall, respondents found the film convenient to use and easy to navigate.

Respondent's Response

Table 10. Aesthetic Quality based on the IT Respondent's Response

STATEMENTS	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
The art style and color palette suit the theme and emotional tone of the story.	4.55	0.62	Strongly Agree
The animation is smooth, well executed, and visually appealing.	4.4	0.62	Agree
The characters accurately represent Filipino fisherfolk and their cultural identity.	4.5	0.62	Strongly Agree
Backgrounds, lighting, and visual effects enhance the storytelling.	4.4	0.95	Agree
The film's visuals successfully capture and sustain viewer engagement	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
Composite Mean	**4.45**		**Agree**

Legend: 1.00-1.49 = Strongly Disagree, 1.50-2.49 = Disagree, 2.50-3.49 = Neutral, 3.50-4.49 = Agree, 4.50-5.00 = Strongly Agree

Respondents affirmed that the film's art style and color palette effectively suited its theme and emotional tone. They agreed that the animation was smooth and visually appealing and that the characters accurately represented Filipino fisherfolk and their cultural identity. Backgrounds, lighting, and visual effects contributed to better storytelling, while the visuals successfully sustained viewer engagement. These elements collectively reflect the film's strong aesthetic execution.

Respondent's Response

Table 11. Perceived Enjoyment based on the Respondent's Response

STATEMENTS	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
The film provides an enjoyable and pleasant viewing experience.	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
The film maintains the viewer's interest and attention throughout.	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
The film evokes an emotional connection with the characters and story.	4.5	0.62	Strongly Agree
The background music and sound design enhance the emotional tone of the film.	4.3	0.73	Agree
The film leaves a positive and lasting impression on the viewer.	4.6	0.50	Strongly Agree
Composite Mean	**4.47**		**Agree**

Legend: 1.00-1.49 = Strongly Disagree, 1.50-2.49 = Disagree, 2.50-3.49 = Neutral, 3.50-4.49 = Agree, 4.50-5.00 = Strongly Agree

Respondents strongly agreed that the film offered an enjoyable and pleasant viewing experience and was successful in maintaining their interest from beginning to end. They also agreed that the film fostered an emotional connection with its characters and narrative, with background music and sound design effectively supporting the emotional tone. Overall, respondents confirmed that the film left a positive and lasting impression on them, reflecting its strong impact on viewers.

Respondent's Response

Table 12. Attitude Towards Use based on the Respondent's Response

STATEMENTS	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
Watching the film was a pleasant and engaging learning experience.	4.4	0.72	Agree
Watching the film made learning about fisherfolk and their challenges more meaningful	4.55	0.68	Strongly Agree
The film successfully captures and maintains the viewer's interest.	4.5	0.68	Strongly Agree
The film's message promotes a positive attitude toward supporting fisherfolk communities.	4.6	0.62	Strongly Agree
Overall, I feel satisfied and appreciative of the film's creative and educational value.	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
Composite Mean	**4.50**		**Agree**

Legend: 1.00-1.49 = Strongly Disagree, 1.50-2.49 = Disagree, 2.50-3.49 = Neutral, 3.50-4.49 = Agree, 4.50-5.00 = Strongly Agree

Respondents shared that the film was not only pleasant to watch but also made learning about the struggles of fisherfolk more meaningful. They felt that the film was engaging enough to keep their attention from start to finish. Many also expressed that the message of the film helped them develop a more positive outlook toward supporting fisherfolk communities. Overall, viewers were satisfied with the experience and appreciated the film for both its creativity and its educational value.

Respondent's Response

Table 13. Behavioral Intention to Use based on the Respondent's Response

STATEMENTS	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
I learned a lot about the lives of fisherfolk, and I became more aware of the importance of supporting them.	4.65	0.55	Strongly Agree
The film contributed to my understanding and evaluation of community-centered storytelling.	4.65	0.55	Strongly Agree
I would support future projects similar to this film.	4.7	0.46	Strongly Agree
I would recommend this film to others.	4.5	0.68	Strongly Agree
I was inspired to take action or participate in advocacies that help fisherfolk communities.	4.7	0.54	Strongly Agree
Composite Mean	**4.63**		**Strongly Agree**

Legend: 1.00-1.49 = Strongly Disagree, 1.50-2.49 = Disagree, 2.50-3.49 = Neutral, 3.50-4.49 = Agree, 4.50-5.00 = Strongly Agree

Respondents strongly agreed that the film helped them learn more about the lives of fisherfolk and made them more aware of why supporting these communities matters. They also shared that the film improved their appreciation of community-centered storytelling. Many viewers expressed that they would support similar projects in the future and would recommend the film to others. Most importantly, the film inspired them to consider taking action or participating in advocacies that help uplift fisherfolk communities.

Table 14. Summary Mean Table of TAM

	MEAN	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
Perceived Usefulness	4.59	Strongly Agree
Perceived Ease of Use	4.45	Agree
Aesthetic Quality	4.45	Agree
Perceived Enjoyment	4.47	Agree
Attitude Towards Use	4.50	Strongly Agree
Behavioral Intention to Use	4.63	Strongly Agree
Overall TAM Result:	**4.52**	**Strongly Agree**

Legend: 1.00-1.49 = Strongly Disagree, 1.50-2.49 = Disagree, 2.50-3.49 = Neutral, 3.50-4.49 = Agree, 4.50-5.00 = Strongly Agree

The table above shows the TAM results, indicating that respondents generally had a positive perception of the film. The overall TAM score of 4.52 reflects a strong level of acceptance among respondents. In summary, the results suggest that the film was both engaging and effective, leaving viewers with a positive impression and a willingness to use or recommend it.

Animation Pipeline

Following the conceptual framework of the study, the researchers implemented an animation pipeline consisting of three main stages: pre-production, production, and post-production. This pipeline structured the development of the 2D animated short film AnakDagat, ensuring a systematic progression from narrative planning and visual design to animation execution and final refinement. The following section discusses how each stage of the pipeline was applied in practice and the corresponding outputs produced during the development of the film.

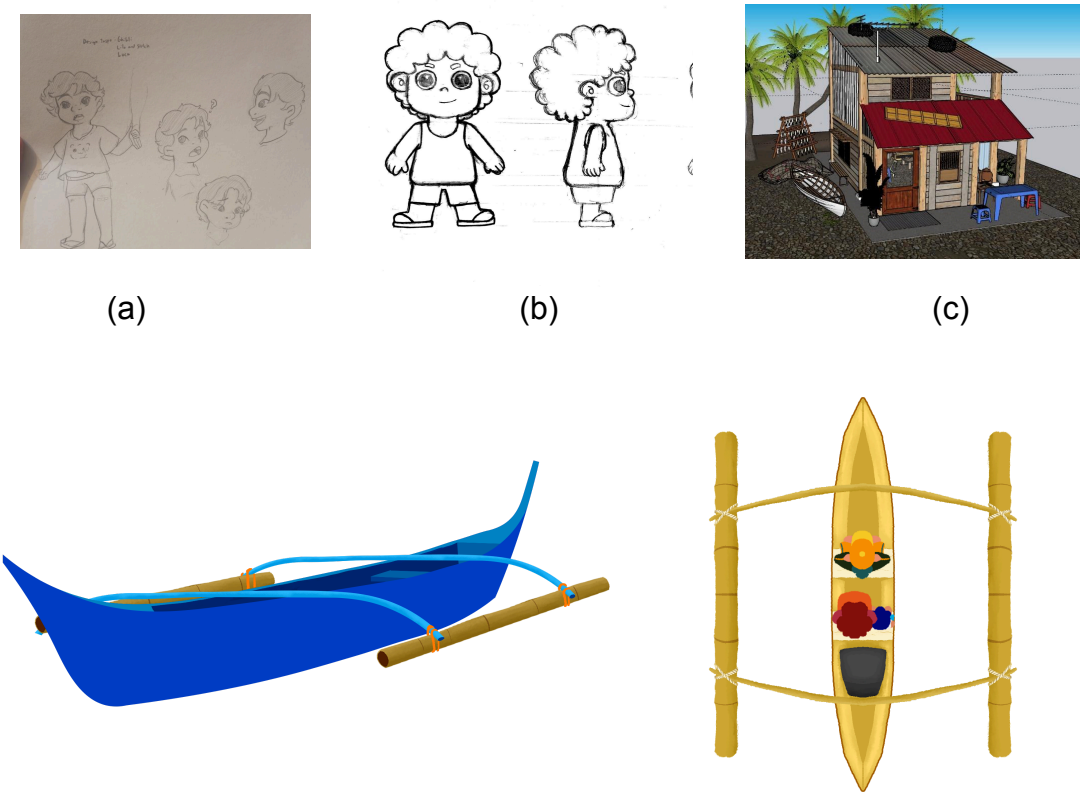
Figure 16. Film Development Timeline Checklists.

Figure 16. Shows the Film Development Timeline Checklist of AnakDagat showing the distribution tasks of pre-production, production, and post-production activities across the development period culminating in the film's premier during the researchers' final presentation.

1. **Pre-Production**

During the pre-production stage, the researchers successfully interpreted the gathered data and first hand experiences from the community immersion into a finalized screenplay and visual plan *(c)*. Character designs were developed to reflect realistic fisherfolk identities

(a)(b), while the storyboard and animatics established pacing, emotional beats, and scene continuity. These outputs ensured that the narrative remained grounded in lived experiences while remaining visually coherent for animation.



(a) (b) (c)

(d) (e)

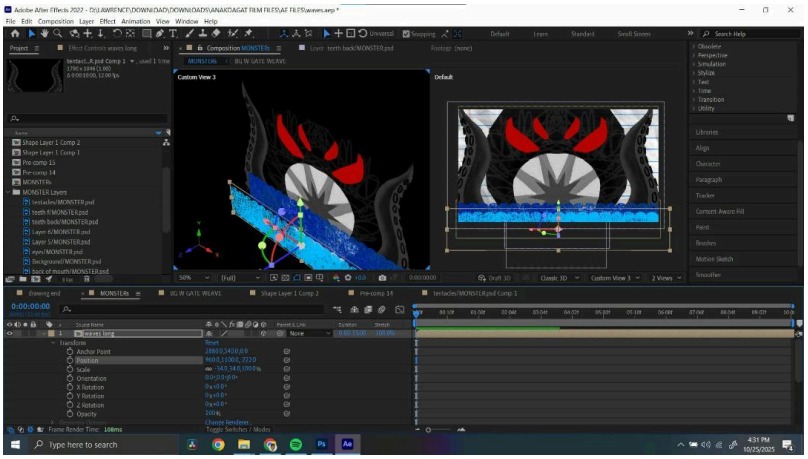
Figure 17. Early Character Concepts and Visual Assets.

Early character concepts and visual assets presenting the preliminary character designs and visual style used to guide the animation process *(d)(e)*.

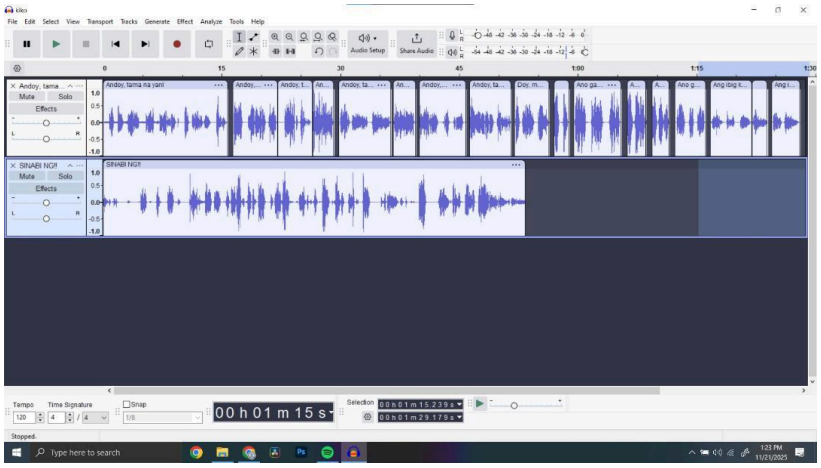
2. Production

Then the researchers moved to the production phase, resulting in fully animated sequences that visually conveyed the film's three-act structure. Character movements, environmental elements, and transitions were animated using 2D techniques that emphasized a more stylized and

emotional expression rather than hyper-realistic motion *(a)*. Final line readings and dialogue recordings were also finished during this phase. Voice recordings were synchronized with animated scenes to enhance narrative clarity and audience engagement *(b)*.



(a)



(b)

Figure 18. Animation Process & Audio Cleaning.

Figure 18 shows the editing softwares used in the production phase.

3. Post-Production

Finally, the post-production focused on bringing the film together and refining the animated film through video editing, sound balancing, and visual enhancement. A screen test and beta test screening was also done with the

industry experts where the film underwent a session of critiquing and evaluation to ensure the quality and accuracy of the animation, art, and story. From this part of the film was revised under the guidance of the experts' assessments and suggestions. A final version of *AnakDagat* was then rendered and prepared for evaluation using the Technology Acceptance Model. This ensured that the output assessed by respondents accurately represented the intended narrative, visual quality, and message.

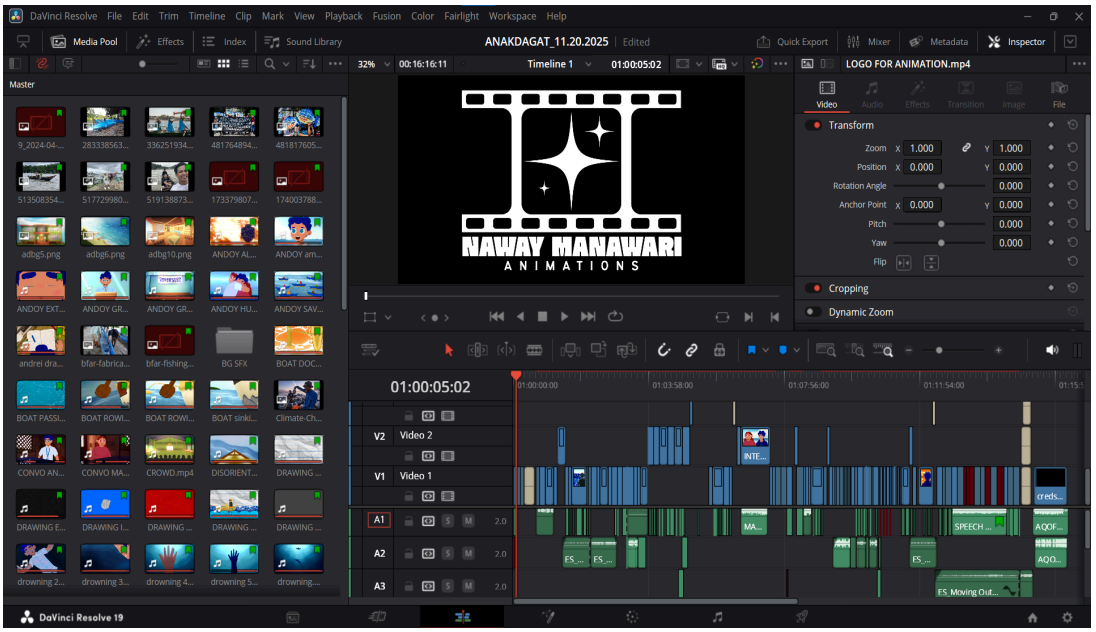


Figure 19. Sequencing and Sound Design.

Figure 19 shows the Sequencing and sound design showing the alignment of visual sequences with sound elements during post-production done in DaVinci Resolve.

CHAPTER 5

SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This study includes the summary of plans and methodologies, development, testing, implementation, and interpretation of the findings. Moreover, this includes the discussion of conclusions found during the study and the recommendation that will make the project more successful.

Summary of Findings

In the preliminary analysis, specialists are seeking the idea of a 2D animated film that depicts the lived experience of local small-scale fisherfolks. We have observed that we need to champion the importance of programs and initiatives by government and non-government organizations, so that the positive changes it brings to the community can continue to develop and diversify. To complete the analysis and research project, the researchers used various softwares, specifically Adobe Photoshop and after effects, to create the 2D Animated Film. This approach covers research project study preparation, project design, animation quality assessment. The development of the project consists of (1) Gathering data on the life and difficulties encountered by small-scale fisherfolk and positive changes brought by programs and initiatives by government and non-government organizations, such as, but not limited to the F/B Pagbabago Program. (2) Develop a story and a 2D animated short film based on the collected data that effectively communicate the program’s goals and impact. (3) To evaluate the acceptability of the 2D animated film using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) framework through a structured questionnaire.

Conclusions

From the completed research project, including its testing and assessments, the researchers deduced the following points. As part of the developmental procedure, the researchers evaluated the modules to determine if they met the intended objectives. They then assessed the developed 2D animated film with the help of three technical respondents who were field experts: a Visual Director, a Storyline/Script Specialist, and a Community Consultant. They also gathered feedback from 30 non-technical respondents. The study then formed its conclusions based on the following objectives.

1. **To gather data on the life and difficulties encountered by small-scale fisherfolk and positive changes brought by programs and initiatives by government and non-government organizations, such as, but not limited to the F/B Pagbabago Program.**

   The researchers collaborated with several government and non-government organizations engaged with small-scale fisherfolk communities across CALABARZON. Through this process, the researchers were introduced to the program “Makipamuhay, Makipag-aralan,” led by the Concerned Artists of the Philippines (CAP) in partnership with PAMALAKAYA, Anakdagat, and the UP Diliman College of Social Work and Community Development, with support from the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research and Development. The program immerses volunteers in fishing communities in Binangonan, Navotas, and Cavite to conduct situationer discussions and community art workshops with fisherfolk youth.

The researchers participated in the immersion and lived with the community of Brgy. Gupiing, Binangonan, Rizal, where they gathered firsthand data on the daily life, struggles, and experiences of small-scale fisherfolk. Insights were also drawn from conversations about the impact of programs and initiatives, including those led by government and people's organizations. The storyline and script of the animated film were developed based on the stories, observations, and lived realities documented during this immersion.

2. **To develop a story and a 2D animated short film based on the collected data that effectively communicate the program's goals and impact.**

Using the data gathered from academic research and firsthand community immersion, the researchers developed a narrative that communicates the lived struggles of small-scale fisherfolk. The story focuses on the significance of their boats, not only in logistical and environmental terms, but also as symbols of the psychological and emotional weight carried by fisherfolk. This allowed the film to portray both the external challenges and the inner turmoil experienced by fishing communities.

The narrative also highlights how programs and initiatives can support fisherfolk while remaining grounded in the reality that these interventions are not absolute or one-size-fits-all solutions. To make the film relatable to a wider audience, the researchers framed the story

through a family dynamic, creating an emotional connection and shared point of understanding. Finally, the story serves as a call to action, encouraging continued efforts from organizations and institutions to develop and sustain programs that uplift and empower fishing communities.

3. **To evaluate the acceptability of the 2D animated film using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) framework through a structured questionnaire.**

    The survey questionnaire used for the evaluation was carefully developed in consultation with a professional statistician to ensure clarity, validity, and alignment with the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM). The final instrument was administered to three field experts and thirty non-technical respondents, including members of the fisherfolk community and students. Their assessments of the completed 2D animated film resulted in a strong overall acceptability rating of 4.5, along with constructive comments and recommendations that affirm the film's effectiveness and provide insights for further improvement.

With these results and continued film development, the project can strengthen community visibility and inspire future generations of fisherfolk. Partnerships with Concerned Artists of the Philippines and PAMALAKAYA will support further refinement of the film and its use in future programs and project proposals. Both groups have also expressed interest in premiering the film at UP Diliman this December, as part of an exhibition at the UP College of Fine Arts featuring works created during the Basic Mass Integrations, including those by the facilitators.

Recommendations

Based on the results of the study and the evaluation of the 2D animated film, the following recommendations are provided to further enhance the film's effectiveness in conveying the experiences and challenges of the Filipino fisherfolk community, as well as to strengthen its impact in raising awareness of their struggles.

1. **Community Collaboration:** In writing and developing a story, ensure that you are creating with the community, or a community consultant to ensure accuracy in the narrative, events, and context of your film to ensure accurate and authentic representation and portrayal of their life struggles. The researcher's time is limited in living with the community to fully grasp the entirety of their lives, nuances and subtext may be lost lost if we continue to storytell from an outsider's perspective.
2. **Sound Design Enhancement:** Sound is an integral part of the immersion in films. The researchers were limited in the right equipment and skills in voice acting. It is suggested to give more focus on acquiring the right equipment and voice actors to improve the effectiveness of the film.
3. **Focused Narrative Development:** Have a strong case study on the situation that you are trying to tell, and stick to it. It is easy to fall into the trap of wanting to put everything in the film. But with the time frame of the development and the film duration, you cannot cram everything into your film. Sometimes killing your darlings is essential, certain scenes might seem important to you personally but always look at the

bigger picture and evaluate its importance to the whole narrative. In short, keep what’s most important, and trim the fluff.

4. **Ethical and Respectful Storytelling:** Researchers and filmmakers should practice sensitivity toward subjects and communities represented in the film. Consultation with the community is essential to avoid romanticizing, misrepresenting, or exploiting their lived experiences. The researchers only got to connect with one community. But always be mindful and sensitive to the subjects and people involved in your film if you are to branch out to multiple other communities. You cannot tell a story that you don't know, so amplify the stories that you can borrow respectfully. Always consult your community so you don't end up romanticizing their resilience.
5. **Efficient Animation Practices:** Animation demands time to be developed. Allocate ample time but also be realistic in your methods. Frame by frame animation is not possible in any time frame within less than a year so find faster solutions. Puppets, key framing, and photo manipulations are more efficient. Utilizing software like Adobe After Effects in conjunction with illustration programs (e.g., Photoshop) can optimize workflow while maintaining quality within practical production timelines.

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APPENDIX A

APPROVAL FORM

Republic of the Philippines
Laguna State Polytechnic University
Province of Laguna

CERTIFICATE OF APPROVAL

This is to certify that after having satisfactorily completed all the requirements of the capstone project entitled:

" AHON: A 2D ANIMATED SHORT FILM ON THE LIFE OF THE FILIPINO FISHERFOLK COMMUNITY"

GRABRIELLE BANZON, TRACEY ASHLYN DELA CRUZ, JOSHUA ZECHARIAH HERRERA, and JOHN LAWRENCE NICOLAS have been granted permission to proceed with their proposal presentation.

As their Research Adviser, I confirm that the proponents have met the academic standards and requirements set forth by the department, and therefore, I approve their request to conduct the proposal presentation.

GENE MARCK B. CATEDRILLA
Capstone Project Adviser

APPENDIX B

SCRIPT AND STORYLINE

ACT I

INT. ANDREI'S HOME – DAY
ANDREI, 22, sits at a small desk. A blank page glares back at him. He twirls a pen, frustrated.

ANDREI
(softly, muttering)
Pwede siguro yung… wait baka kasi. Sige yun na lang… ughh teka nga.

He taps his pen and sighs

Magkape nga muna ako.

He leans back, his eyes drifting to a dusty **paper boat** by a family photo. Something stirs in him, memories flood him; the sound of the waves crashing, and his and his brother's faint laughter.

CUT TO: **FLASHBACK**

EXT. COASTLINE – LATE AFTERNOON
KIKO and **ANDREI** sit by the water's edge to watch the waves cradle the paper boats they have set afloat.

KIKO
'Doy, tignan mo yung bangka mo ang tibay. Hindi pa rin lumulubog.

ANDREI
Parang yung bangka natin. Pano yun, eh papel lang yung bangka

KIKO
Kahit ang papel kayang suungin ang mga alon, basta naniniwala sya sa sarili nya. Dapat ikaw rin, kaya mo ba yun?

He smiles, and Andrei gets giddy. On the boat, Marina beckons to signal their last catch of the day.

MARINA (O.S.)
Kiko! Andoy! Halina't mauubusan tayo ng liwanag.

Kiko and Andrei turn to her direction and look at each other.

KIKO
Tara na, naghihintay ang mga alon. At si Ima. Ang mahuli amoy bilasang tilapia!

Kiko said playfully, teasing as he jogs toward the boat, and Andrei sprints to catch his brother.

EXT. AT SEA - AFTERNOON
We see their boat cut through the water, finding the makeshift buoy of a soda bottle. Kiko is in front, reeling in nets and unhooking the fish caught.

EXT. SHORELINE – DUSK
The boat docks on the sand. The family gets off happy. However, their happiness is cut short when a community member frantically approaches them.

FISHERFOLK 1
Kiko! Si Ka. Ely nahuli nanaman daw.

KIKO
Nanaman? O sya halika na.

INT. HOUSE – NIGHT
Marina watches the news while Andrei is lying on the floor with his crayons out, drawing in his notebook. News about an upcoming typhoon can be heard.

MARINA
Kamusta si Ka. Ely?

KIKO
Ayun po, nagbayad ng dyis-mil, pangalawang beses na daw ho kasi.

MARINA
Bakit naman kasi ganoon, may mga barkong banyaga ngang nanghihimasok dine.

KIKO
Pasalamat na lamang ho at hindi nila sinaktan, hindi katulad ni Ama-.

Marina cuts him off sharply

MARINA
Pst! Uy uy uy, Kiko! Sinabi nang…

Raindrops pound on their metal roof.

KIKO
Ayan na pala ang bagyo, naku lalaot muna kami Ima, 'doy gusto mo ng bangus na ulam? Ihuhuli ka ni kuya.

MARINA
Oh sige, mag-iingat kayo ha! 'Doy pasara naman ng bintana dali

CUT TO: CHILDLIKE DRAWINGS
We see a world drawn in Andrei's perspective as he narrates the tragedies in his life: A boat fighting

furious waves during a storm. A gun shooting. And a monster

ANDREI (V.O.)
Maraming natatakot sa mga alon, pero hindi si Kuya. Sabi nya babalik sya…

May mga nagsasabing di na daw babalik si kuya dahil sya ay nadala ng malakas na alon. Parang si Amang, kasi nabaril daw ng mga guwardyang bantay sa mga fishpen.

Pero ang sabi ni Ima, ay meron daw nilalabanang halimaw si kuya sa dagat, na kumuha kay Amang dati. Siguro hanggang ngayon nilalabanan nya yun. alam kong mananalo si kuya, siya ang pinakamalakas.

We see a vision of a paper boat sinking. The drawings crumple into blackness. We hear Marina's Anguish as we see Kiko's destroyed boat on the shore. Andoy is back alone, at the shore where he and Kiko used to sit. Waiting for his kuya to come back.

Hanggang ngayon hinihintay ko pa rin siyang bumalik…

EXT. SHORELINE – AFTERNOON
A few days later, Marina and Andoy are back at the shore, beside Kiko's boat, which they patched up.

ANDREI
Ima, sasama ako.

MARINA
Hindi pwede 'Doy, hayaan mo na lang na si Ima muna.

ANDREI
Pero Ima wala ka pong katulong…

MARINA
SINABI NANG… Ang ibig kong sabihin… Kaya to ni Ima. Wag ka na mag-alala ha, umuwi ka na muna sa bahay at may assignment ka pang gagawin diba?

Marina kissed Andrei's forehead as a silent seal of promise between them. Andrei watches anxiously as she pushes off and revs the boat's repurposed engine to go to the dark waters.
Andrei sits down on the sand and pleads.

ANDREI

Dagat… ibabalik mo sakin si Ima.

End of Act 1

INTERLUDE

EXT. OCEAN – LATE AFTERNOON
A lone boat cuts across the glowing water. In the boat's stead, Marina.

From the shore, we can see a taller, sturdier figure waving back at her. A 17-year-old Andrei walks beside his mother, carrying a small bucket of fish.

ANDREI
(Teasing)
Natagalan ka Ima, May halimaw ba sa laot?

MARINA
Meron. Mga barkong hindi sa atin pero saatin kumukuha ng isda.

ANDREI
Ay kainaman, eh mas mabuti nang ligtas kayo Ima.

MARINA
Ligtas nga, kumakalam naman ang sikmura. Simula noong dumating iyang mga yan wala na tayong mahuli.

ANDREI
Ima may pumunta pala satin kaninang taga-BFAR. May programa daw bukas, workshop. Satin na daw yung fiberglass boat na magagawa natin.

MARINA
Oh? Kasali tayo dun?

ANDREI
Opo, nag-sign up na po ako kanina para satin. Pupunta na lang tayo bukas.

MARINA
O sya sige, puntahan natin bukas, wala ka namang pasok ano?

End of Interlude.

ACT II

- The two are listening to a BFAR seminar and workshop.
- Andrei is sanding a boat's surface.
- Marina painting resin, steady hands.
- Laughter between them as paint splatters.
- A Polaroid camera flashes, their proud smiles beside the bright new boat.

EXT. ANDREI'S HOME – PRE-DAWN
As Andrei prepares to go to school, we see him working against the dim light, stitching the torn parts of the fishing nets.

MARINA
Andoy, tama na ’yan. Maduduling ka na kaka-tahi.

ANDREI
Kaunti na lang Ima. Sayang tong lambat, mapipigtal na.

ANDREI
Ima, nagsusulat na ho ako ng essay para sa mga scholarship. Gusto ko ho sana isulat yung kwento natin, ni kuya at ni Amang. Saka sana makasama na ko sa paglaot para ang isusulat ko ay authentic ba.

MARINA
...

ANDREI
Ima?

MARINA
‘Doy malelate ka na sa klase mo, ubusin mo na yang almusal

ANDREI
Marunong naman na ho ako lumangoy Ima, baka pwede na rin kita samahan-.

MARINA
Andrei tama na ha.

EXT. SEA – DAY (18+ layouts)
The sun blisters down. Marina struggles with heavy nets; they snap. Her hands bleed. Tears escape before she can stop them.

A sharp CRACK can be heard. A leak bursts wide. Water rushes in. We cut back to Marina; only her head remains above water. She is abruptly pulled down.

ANDREI
Ima!!!

Andrei’s eyes open, frantic and welling up with tears.

The bell rings, and Andrei runs home as fast as he can. Marina is nowhere to be found. In a fit of desperation, Andrei hops onto their old boat and paddles aimlessly. He

reached an unfamiliar part of the sea. Andrei's franticness made his boat capsize.

Andrei struggles to swim, trying to hang on to his boat. The boat sinks further, and Andrei passes out, slowly sinking with it. Everything seems lost, everything is dark, but a hand pulls on Andrei's hand at the last moment.

Andoy slowly regains consciousness, and he sees Marina. They're on their new boat, and as he stood up, he saw multiple boats surrounding theirs. The community helped save him, using their new boats.

Marina immediately scolded him.

MARINA

Anong bang ginagawa mo!? Bakit mo naman ginawa yun ha!? Gusto mo bang sundan ang kuya mo!?

Andrei, just happy to see Marina safe, smiled and hugged her.

ANDREI

Ima, hindi pa pala ko marunong lumangoy.

MARINA

Luko ka talaga! Oh, sige tuturuan kita.

EXT. BEACH – MORNING (5 layouts)
Marina readies their new sleek fiberglass boat. She glances back at Andrei, and she extends her hand. A montage of Marina teaching Andrei the ropes plays

MARINA

Tara na!

Mahirap labanan ang agos ng tubig at hampas ng mga alon. Kailangan mo itong sabayan, kundi ay madadala ka nito ka nito. Matagal kitang prinotektahan dahil natatakot ako na baka kunin ka rin ng dagat. Pero hindi ko naisip na kailangan rin kitang hayaan na matutong lumutang at sumabay sa agos.

After a few hours, their lesson finished, and they took a breather in Kiko and Andoy's old spot. Andrei hands Marina a piece of paper.

MARINA

Oh, ano to?

Andrei doesn’t spoil the moment; he wants his mom to find out for herself. Marina dries her hand, then holds the paper and reads.

MARINA
(excited)
Nakapasa ka! Oh diyos ko salamat ho!
Makakapagkolehiyo na ang Andoy ko!

Marina continues to yelp in celebration, and they hug. We pan to the setting sun, and a golden beam of sunlight fills the frame. Scene Fades out. Time passes.

End of Act 2.

ACT III

INT. ANDREI'S ROOM – DAY
Andrei is muttering to himself while fixing his tie in the mirror.

ANDREI
(to himself, finishing his speech)
Ang dagat ang pinagmulan…

He trails off, exhales.

A picture on his dresser grabbed his attention. He and Marina, side by side. His eyes start to well up, but he smiles. This scene lingers for a while, until it is cut short by an off-screen yell.

MARINA (O.S.)
Andooy! Pagka-kupad, sa isang taon na tayo makakarating nyan sa tagal mo.

ANDREI
Andyan na Ima!

He straightens his necktie and smiles.

INT. SCHOOL AUDITORIUM – DAY
The graduation hall buzzes. Andrei stands at the podium to give his graduation speech as the summa-cum laude of his batch. Cheers explode. Marina claps the loudest, misty-eyed. Andoy starts, and we see cuts between Andrei at the podium and visuals of his past, and future hopes

ANDREI (V.O.)
Magandang araw po sa inyong lahat. Ako po si Andrei Dalampasigan. Isang batang lumaki sa tabing-dagat. Ang dagat ang ating pinagmulan, pero hindi dapat dito magtapos ang ating mga pangarap.

Gusto ko pong ikuwento, kung paano ang isang bangkang papel ay kayang humarap sa mga alon.

Kung iisipin, tila imposible na lumutang ang papel sa tubig. Ngunit hindi sa kung anong uri ng papel ang dahilan ng kanyang paglutang. Kundi sa paano ito binuo. Kung paano ang bawat tupi ay marahang nilapat upang mabuo ang porma ng isang bangka. Ngayon kaya na nitong sumabay sa sayaw ng mga agos, at hampas ng mga alon.

Hindi lamang ito sa papel, tayo rin ay pormang binubuo ng mga tupi ng mga aral at leksyon na ating natututunan, na syang marahan o minsang marahas na inilalapat ng buhay.

Naalala ko po noon, ang mga kuwento nina Ima, may halimaw daw sa dagat. Marahil mayroon ngang halimaw, ngunit ito ay nasa anyo ng ganid, kahirapan, kasakiman, at kurapsyon.

Kaya’t patuloy ang ating paglaban sa mga halimaw na ito. Hindi man sigurado kung kailan matatapos, ngunit ang sigurado ay hindi mapapaos ang ating mga panawagan at ang ating paglaban hanggang sa mawaksi ang mga halimaw.

At sa laban nating ito, mayroon tayong mga kasangga na nais kong pasalamatan. Mga grupo at mga organisasyong tumutulong sa ating kumunidad upang tayo’y manatiling nakalutang at nakatindig. Sa mga programa at tulong tulad ng fiberglass boats at bagong mga kagamitan, pati na rin ang mga pakikipamuhay at workshops na nagpapalawak ng ating kaalaman at pagkamalikhain. Ang mga ito ay nagiging piyesa natin upang makabuo ang isang matibay na katig. At akin ngayong hinihimok na ating ipag-patuloy ang mga ito, hanggang sa

susunod na pagbuo ng ating munting mga bangkang papel.

Sa bawat agos, hangad ko’y makaraos. Sa bawat alon, natutunan kong bumangon. Para sa aking Ima, para kay Kuya, at para sa lahat ng mga anak-dagat. Ako ay anak ng dagat, at anak ng isang matatag at malayang mangingisda. Mabuhay mga mamamalakaya! Maraming salamat po.

EXT. AUDITORIUM – POST-CEREMONY
After the ceremony, the noise fades. Andrei finds Marina outside.

ANDREI
Para sa’yo, Ima.

He puts the medal around her neck.

Marina laughs, teary. She reaches into her pocket and pulls out the old paper boat, now a little worn.

MARINA
Baka sakaling gusto mo pang lumayag.

Andrei smiles and holds it up to the light. The folds glow softly. The camera follows it as he sets it on the calm sea.

We see the silhouette of adult Andrei morph into his teenage self, then into his kid self.

We see the paper boat floating mightily.

FADE OUT.

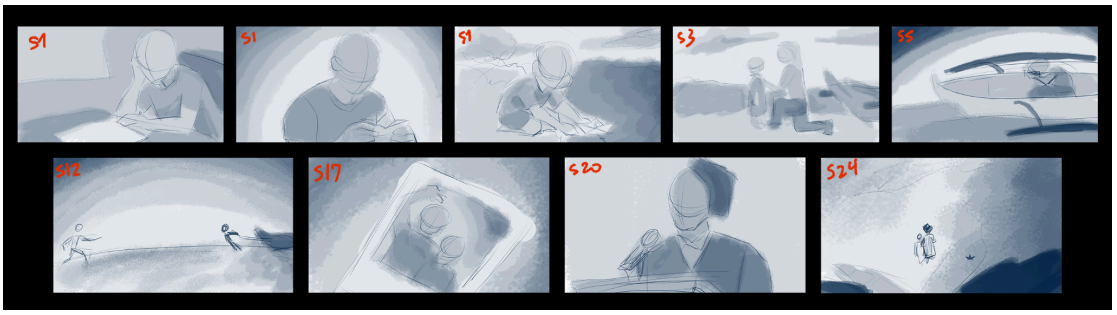
TITLE CARD

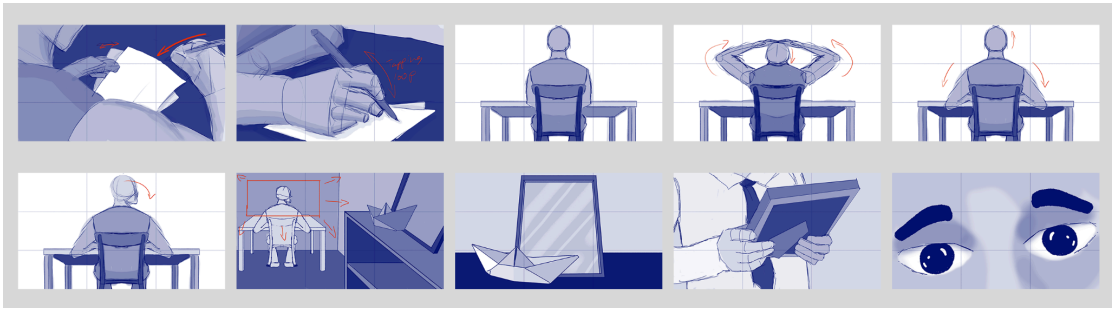
ROLL CREDITS.

THE END

APPENDIX C

STORYBOARD



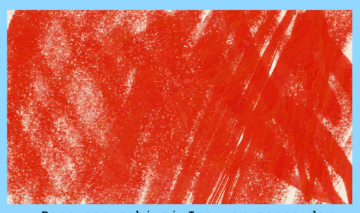


"Maraming natatakot sa mga alon, pero hindi si Kuya. Sabi nya babalik sya…"

"May mga nagsasabing di na daw babalik si kuya dahil sya ay nadala ng malakas na alon."

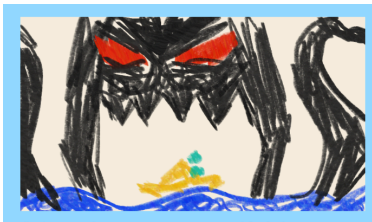
"Parang si Amang kasi nabaril daw ng mga guwardyang bantay sa mga fishpen."

"Parang si Amang kasi nabaril daw ng mga guwardyang bantay sa mga fishpen."

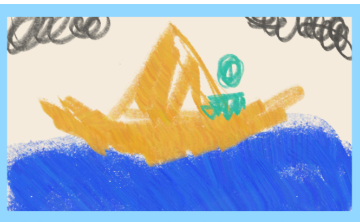


Pero ang sabi ni Ima, ay meron daw nilalabanang halimaw si kuya sa dagat, na kumuha kay Amang dati.

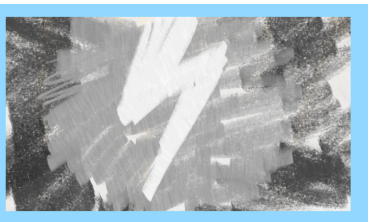
"Siguro hanggang ngayon nilalabanan nya yun."

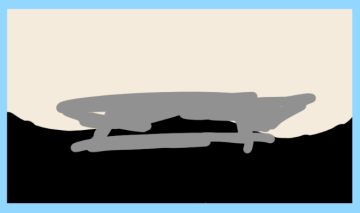


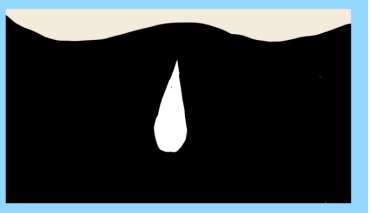
"Siguro hanggang ngayon nilalabanan nya yun."



"alam kong mananalo si kuya, siya ang pinakamalakas."



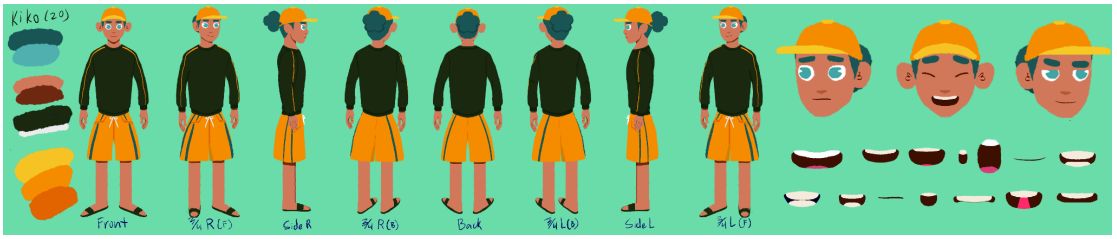


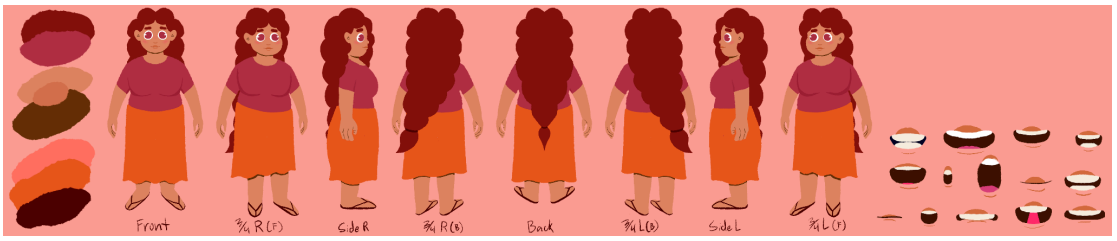


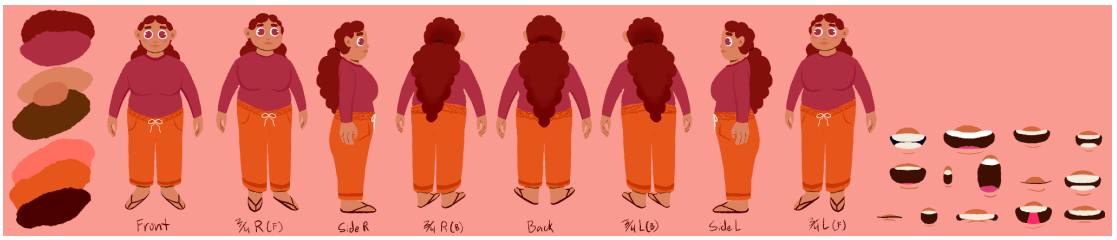
APPENDIX D

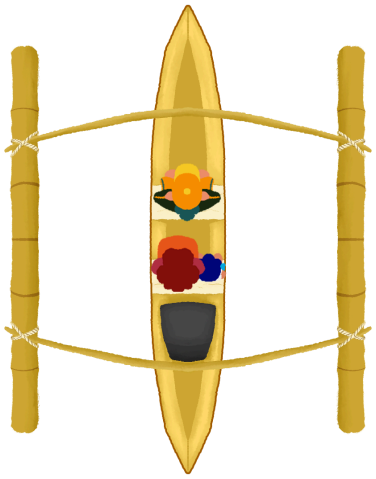
CHARACTER AND PROPS

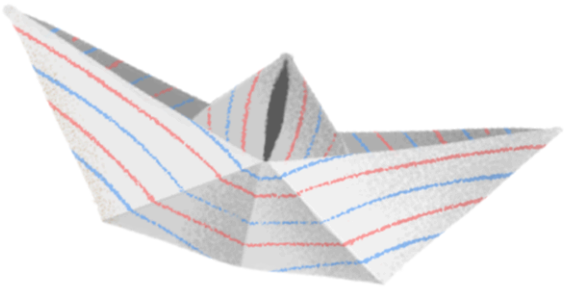
Andrei (10)
Front
¾ R (F)
Side R
¾ R (B)
Back
¾ L (B)
Side L
¾ L (F)

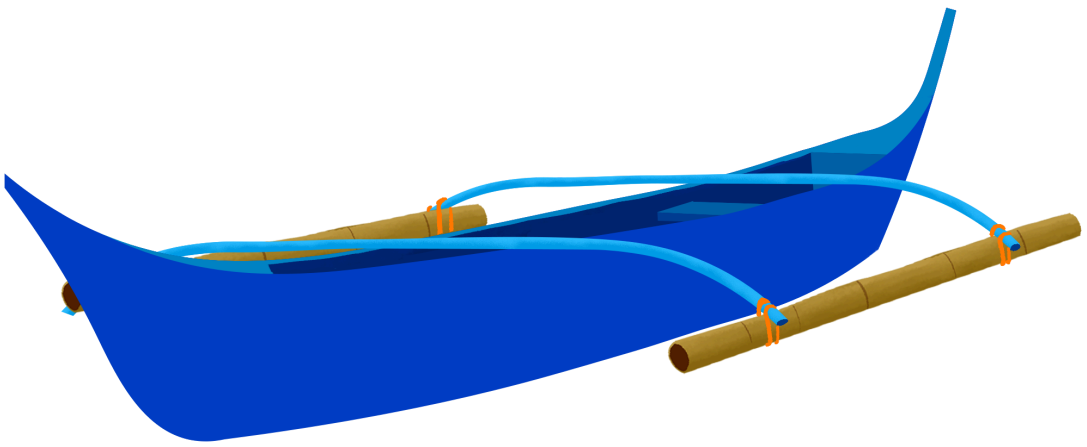

Kiko (20)
Front
¾ R (F)
Side R
¾ R (B)
Back
¾ L (B)
Side L
¾ L (F)


Front
¾ R (F)
Side R
¾ R (B)
Back
¾ L (B)
Side L
¾ L (F)


Front
¾ R (F)
Side R
¾ R (B)
Back
¾ L (B)
Side L
¾ L (F)

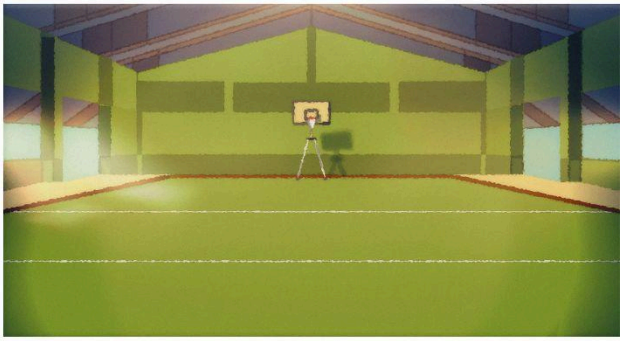


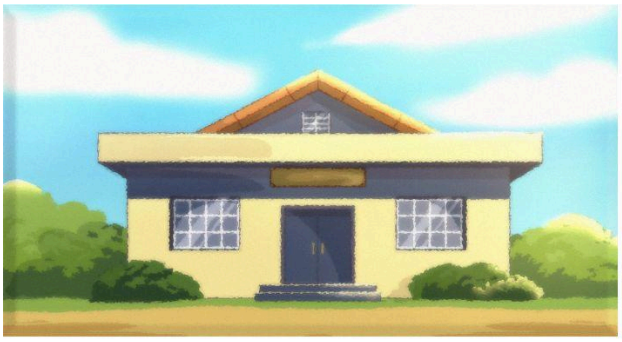


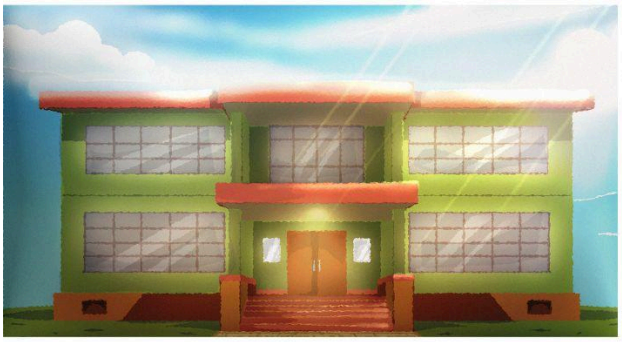


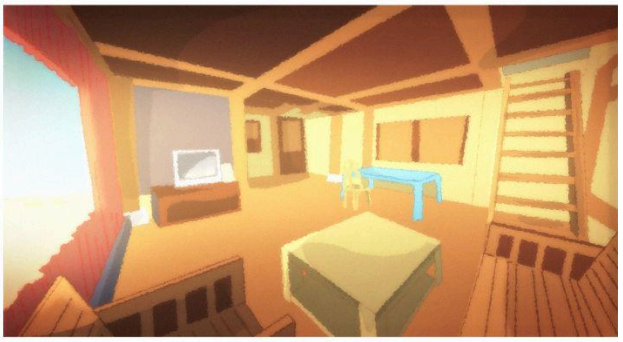
APPENDIX E

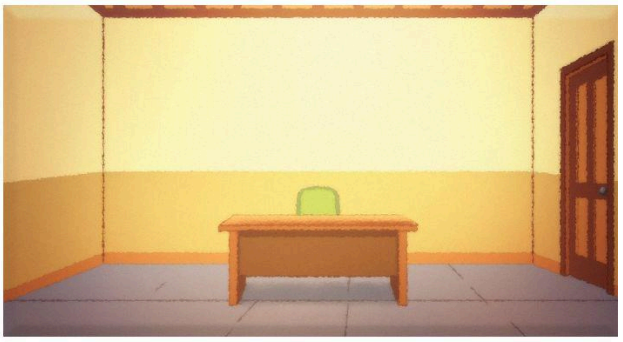
BACKGROUNDS

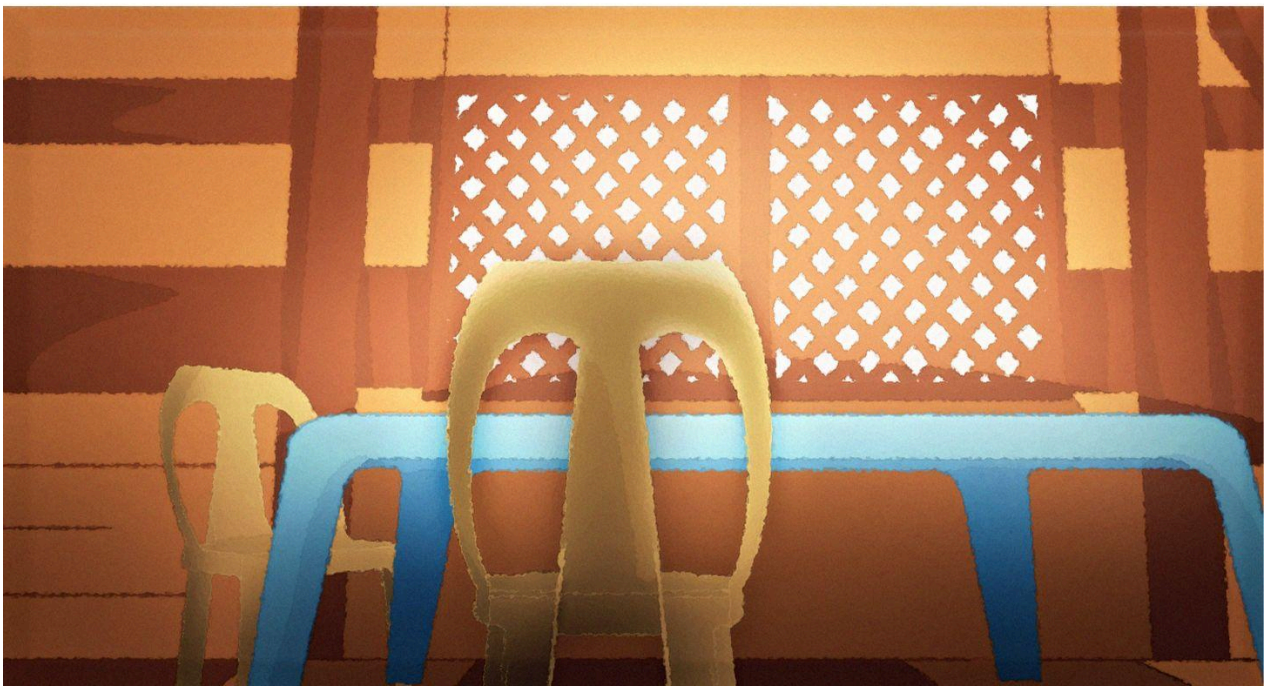






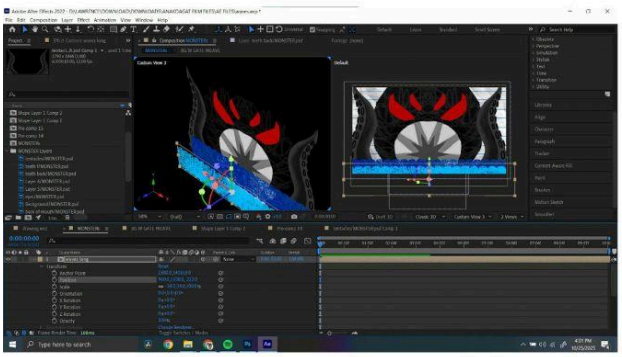


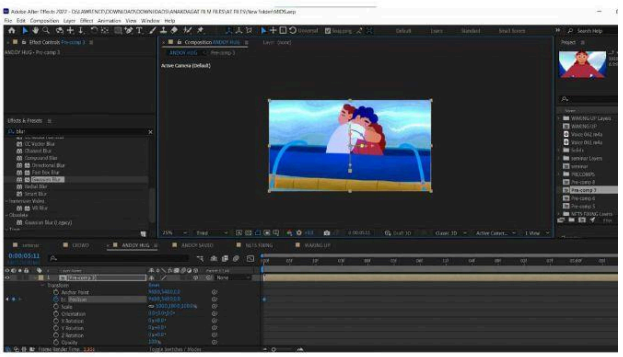


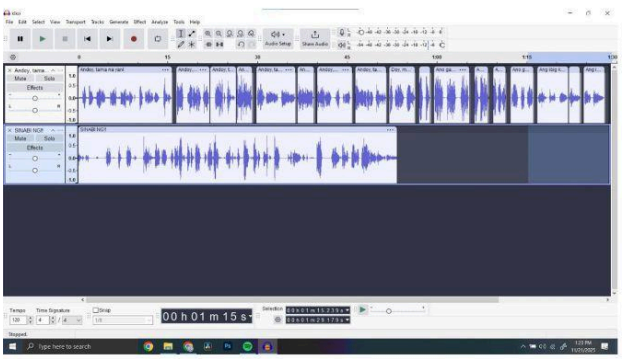


APPENDIX F

ANIMATION DESIGN



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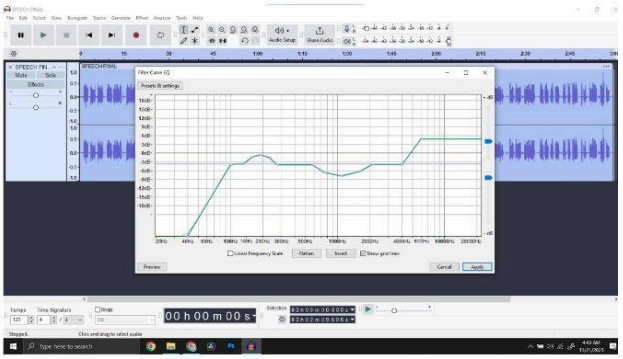
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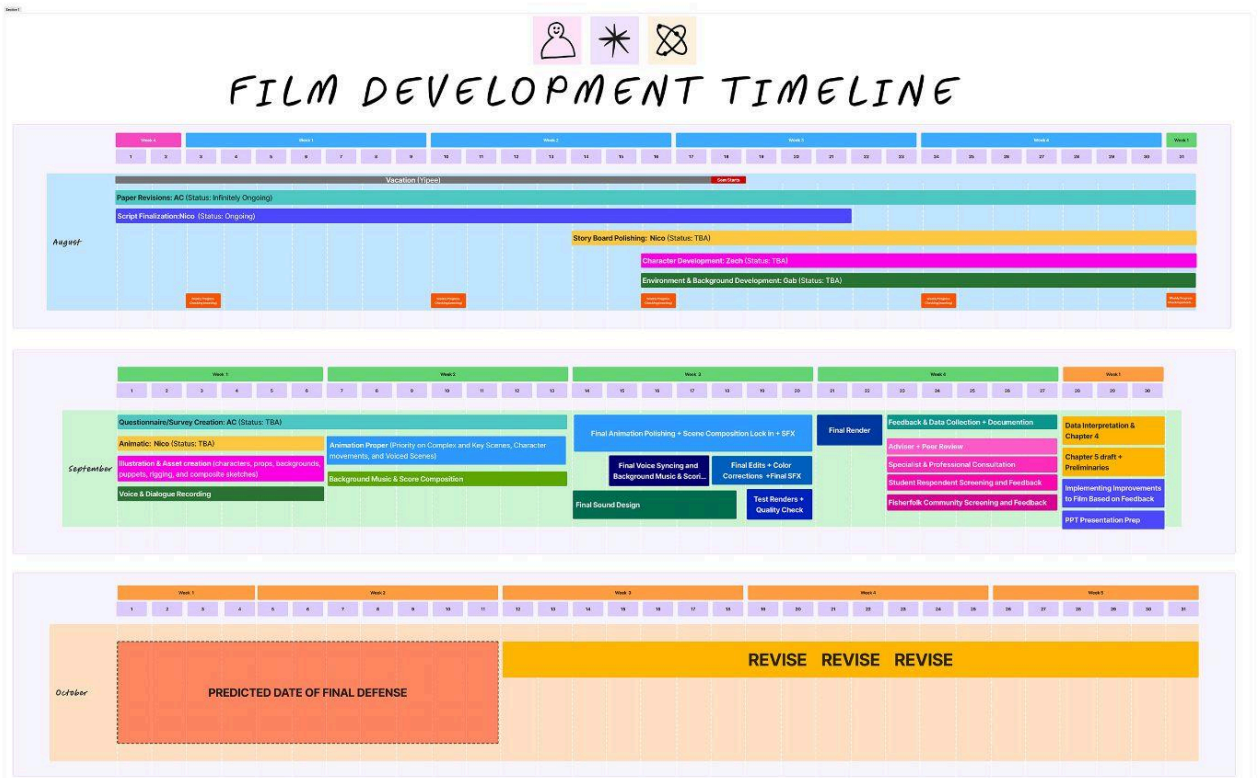
FILM DEVELOPMENT TIMELINE
August
Vacation (Yipee)
Paper Revisions: AC (Status: Infinitely Ongoing)
Script Finalization:Nico (Status: Ongoing)
Story Board Polishing: Nico (Status: TBA)
Character Development: Zech (Status: TBA)
Environment & Background Development: Gab (Status: TBA)
September
Questionnaire/Survey Creation: AC (Status: TBA)
Animatic: Nico (Status: TBA)
Animation Proper (Priority on Complex and Key Scenes, Character movements, and Voiced Scenes)
Illustration & Asset creation (characters, props, backgrounds, puppets, rigging, and composite sketches)
Background Music & Score Composition
Voice & Dialogue Recording
Final Animation Polishing + Scene Composition Lock in + SFX
Final Voice Syncing and Background Music & Scori...
Final Edits + Color Corrections +Final SFX
Final Sound Design
Test Renders + Quality Check
Final Render
Feedback & Data Collection + Documention
Adviser + Peer Review
Specialist & Professional Consultation
Student Respondent Screening and Feedback
Fisherfolk Community Screening and Feedback
Data Interpretation & Chapter 4
Chapter 5 draft + Preliminaries
Implementing Improvements to Film Based on Feedback
PPT Presentation Prep
October
PREDICTED DATE OF FINAL DEFENSE
REVISE REVISE REVISE

APPENDIX G

QUESTIONNAIRE

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Province of Laguna

Survey Questionnaire for Respondents

Pangalan (Opsyonal): _____

ANAKDAGAT: A 2D ANIMATED SHORT FILM ON THE LIFE OF THE FILIPINO FISHERFOLK COMMUNITY

Layunin ng survey na ito na alamin kung gaano kataanggap at nakakasiya ang pelikulang *"AnakDagat: A 2D Animated Short Film on the Life of the Filipino Fisherfolk Community."* Ang mga sagot na makukuha ay gagamitin upang mapabuti ang pelikula sa pagpapalaganap ng kaalaman at kamalayan tungkol sa mga mangingisda. Lahat ng impormasyon ay mananatiling kompidensyal at gagamitin lamang para sa pananaliksik at pag-aaral.

Panuto: Lagyan ng check (✓) ang kahon na tumutugma sa iyong opinyon.

Perceived Usefulness (PU)

Sinusukat kung gaano kapaki-pakinabang at kaalamanan ang pelikula sa pagpapalaganap ng kamalayan at pag-unawa sa buhay ng mga mangingisdang Pilipino.

Pamantayan/ Deskripsyon	1- Lubos na Hindi Sumasang-ayon	2 – Hindi Sumasang-ayon	3 - Patas	4 – Sumasang-ayon	5 – Lubos na Sumasang-ayon
Pag-unawa sa Nilalaman *Ang film ay nakatulong para mas maunawaan ko ang buhay at hirap ng mga mangingisdang Pilipino.*	Walang nadagdag na kaalaman.	Kaunting pag-unawa lamang	Katamtamang pag-unawa.	Malinaw na pag-unawa sa paksa..	Malalim na pag-unawa at kamalayan.
Katumpakan at kahalagahan ng Impormasyon *Ang film ay nagpakita ng tama at mahalagang impormasyon tungkol sa mga mangingisda.*	Hindi tama o hindi mahalaga ang impormasyon.	Bahagyang tama at may kabuluhan.	Katamtamang tama at kapaki-pakinabang.	Tamang-tama at kapaki-pakinabang ang nilalaman..	Lubos na tama, mahalaga, at kapani-paniwala.
Kagandahan at Interes *Ang film ay maganda at kapana-panabik panoorin.*	Walang kaaya-ayang aspeto.	Kaunting interes lamang.	Katamtamang kaaya-aya.	Maganda at kawili-wiling panoorin.	Napakaganda at lubos na kapana-panabik.63

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Kahalagahan ng Programa *Ipinakita ng film "AnakDagat" ang kahalagahan ng mga programa na tumutulong sa mga mangingisda*	Hindi naipakita ang kahalagahan.	Bahagyang naipakita ang mensahe.	Katamtamang naipahayag ang mensahe.	Malinaw na ipinakita ang kahalagahan ng programa.	Lubos na naipakita at binigyang-diin ang kahalagahan ng mga programa.
Epekto sa Pag-unawa at Pananaw *Ang film ay nakaapekto sa aking pag-unawa at pananaw tungkol sa kalagayan ng mga mangingisda.*	Walang naging epekto.	Bahagyang nakaapekto.	Katamtamang nakaapekto.	Malinaw na nakaapekto sa pananaw.	Lubos na nakaapekto at nagbigo ng pagtingin.

	Questions:	1	2	3	4	5
1	Ang film ay nakatulong para mas maunawaan ko ang buhay at hirap ng mga mangingisdang Pilipino.					
2.	Ang film ay nagpakita ng tama at mahalagang impormasyon tungkol sa mga mangingisda.					
3.	Ang film ay maganda at kapana-panabik panoorin.					
4.	Ipinakita ng film "AnakDagat" ang kahalagahan ng mga programa na tumutulong sa mga mangingisda.					
5.	Ang film ay nakaapekto sa aking pag-unawa at pananaw tungkol sa kalagayan ng mga mangingisda.					

Perceived Ease of Use (PEOU)

Sinusukat kung gaano kadaling ma-access, mapanood, at maunawaan ang pelikula batay sa teknikal at disenyo nito.

Pamantayan/ Deskripsyon	1- Lubos na Hindi Sumasang-ayon	2 – Hindi Sumasang-ayon	3 - Patas	4 – Sumasang-ayon	5 – Lubos na Sumasang-ayon
Kadalian ng Panonood *Madaling mapanood ang film sa iba't ibang device (hal. cellphone, laptop).*	Mahirap mapanood at madalas magka-error.	Bahagyang madaling mapanood ngunit may aberya.	Katamtamang madaling mapanood.	Madaling mapanood sa karamihan ng device.	Napakadaling mapanood at walang aberya sa anumang device.

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Pagkakasunod-sunod ng mga Eksena *Maayos ang daloy ng mga eksena kaya madaling intindihin ang kwento.*	Magulo at mahirap sundan ang kwento.	Bahagyang tama at may kabuluhan.	Katamtamang maayos ang pagkakasunod-sunod.	Malinaw at maayos ang pagkakadaloy ng kwento.	Napakalinaw, maayos, at madaling sundan ang bawat eksena.
Kondisyong Teknikal *Walang naging problema habang pinapanood ang film.*	Maraming teknikal na problema habang pinapanood.	May ilang aberya o lag.	May kaunting isyu ngunit katanggap-tanggap.	Halos walang problema sa panonood.	Ganap na maayos at walang anumang aberya.
Kalidad ng Tunog at Teksto *Ang mga teksto, boses, at tunog ay nakatulong para madaling maunawaan ang mensahe..*	Malabo at nakalilito ang tunog o teksto..	Bahagyang malinaw ngunit hindi tugma.	Katamtamang malinaw at kapaki-pakinabang.	Malinaw at nakatutulong sa pag-unawa.	Lubos na malinaw at nakapagpapalalim sa pag-unawa ng mensahe.
Kadalian ng Pag-access *Madaling ma-access ang film at hindi kailangan ng mahirap na proseso.*	Mahirap i-access at maraming hakbang.	Bahagyang madaling ma-access.	Katamtamang madaling ma-access.	Madaling ma-access at mabilis mapanood.	Napakadaling ma-access nang walang anumang abala.

	Questions:	1	2	3	4	5
1	Madaling mapanood ang film sa iba't ibang device (hal. cellphone, laptop).					
2.	Maayos ang daloy ng mga eksena kaya madaling intindihin ang kwento.					
3.	Walang naging problema habang pinapanood ang film.					
4.	Ang mga teksto, boses, at tunog ay nakatulong para madaling maunawaan ang mensahe.					
5.	Madaling ma-access ang film at hindi kailangan ng mahirap na proseso.					

Aesthetic Quality (AQ)

Sinusukat kung gaano kaganda, kaayos, at kaakit-akit ang kabuuang disenyo at biswal na presentasyon ng pelikula.

Pamantayan/ Deskripsyon	1- Lubos na Hindi Sumasang-ayon	2 – Hindi Sumasang-ayon	3 - Patas	4 – Sumasang-ayon	5 – Lubos na Sumasang-ayon

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Art Style *Ang art style at paggamit ng kulay ay akma sa tema at damdamin ng pelikula.*	Hindi akma o magulo ang kulay at estilo.	Bahagyang akma ngunit hindi pare-pareho.	Katamtamang madaling mapanood.	Maayos at akmang-akma sa tema at damdamin.	Lubos na akma, kaaya-aya, at kapani-paniwala sa mensahe.
Paggalaw at Kalinawan ng Animasyon *Maayos ang galaw ng mga karakter at elemento sa animasyon.*	Hindi maayos ang animasyon.	Bahagyang maayos at malinaw ngunit may pagkaaberya.	Katamtamang maayos ang galaw.	Maayos at malinaw ang pagkaka-animate.	Napakaayos, propesyonal, at kaaya-ayang panoorin
Disenyo ng mga Karakter *Ang mga karakter ay maayos ang pagkakagawa at nagpapakita ng katangian ng mga Pilipinong mangingisda.*	Hindi naaayon sa tema o kulturang Pilipino.	Bahagyang nagpapakita ng tema.	Katamtamang tumutugma sa pagkakakilanlan ng mangingisda.	Malinaw na sumasalamin sa kulturang Pilipino.	Lubos na nagpapakita ng tunay na pagkakakilanlan ng mga Pilipinong mangingisda.
Komposisyon ng mga Eksena *Ang background, ilaw, at mga visual effects ay nakadagdag sa ganda ng kwento.*	Nakalilito o hindi tugma sa kwento.	Bahagyang nakatutulong sa presentasyon.	Katamtamang nakapagpapaganda ng eksena.	Malinaw na nakadagdag sa kabuuang kwento.	Lubos na nagpalalim at nagpayaman sa visual storytelling.
Kabuuang Biswal *Kaaya-aya at nakakawiling panoorin ang kabuuang biswal ng pelikula.*	Hindi kaaya-aya o nakakaakit panoorin.	Bahagyang maganda ngunit may kakulangan.	Katamtamang kaakit-akit.	Maganda at nakakaengg-anyong panoorin	Lubos na kaakit-akit at kapana-panabik mula simula hanggang dulo.

	Questions:	1	2	3	4	5
1	Ang art style at paggamit ng kulay ay akma sa tema at damdamin ng pelikula.					
2.	Maayos at makinis ang galaw ng mga karakter at elemento sa animasyon.					
3.	Ang mga karakter ay maayos ang pagkakagawa at nagpapakita ng katangian ng mga Pilipinong mangingisda.					

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4.	Ang background, ilaw, at mga visual effects ay nakadagdag sa ganda ng kwento.					
5.	Kaaya-aya at nakakawiling panoorin ang kabuuang biswal ng pelikula.					

Perceived Enjoyment (PE)

Sinusukat kung gaano kaaya-aya, kawili-wili, at nakakaantig ang karanasan ng manonood habang pinapanood ang pelikula.

Pamantayan/ Deskripsyon	1- Lubos na Hindi Sumasang-ayon	2 – Hindi Sumasang-ayon	3 - Patas	4 – Sumasang-ayon	5 – Lubos na Sumasang-ayon
Kasiyahan sa Panonood *Ang film ay nagbibigay ng kaaya-aya at magandang karanasan sa panonood.*	Hindi kaaya-aya o nakakabagot panoorin.	Bahagyang kasiya-siya ngunit may kakulangan.	Katamtaman g kasiya-siya.	Kaaya-aya at nakalilibang panoorin.	Lubos na kasiya-siya at kaaya-ayang panoorin mula simula hanggang dulo.
Pagpapanatili sa Interes *Ang film ay nagpapanatili ng interes at atensyon ng manonood.*	Hindi nakakakuha ng interes.	Bahagyang nakakapanatili ng atensyon.	Katamtaman g nakakawili.	Nakakapanatili ng interes sa halos buong palabas.	Lubos na nakakabighani at nakakapanatili ng atensyon hanggang dulo.
Emosyonal na Ugnayan *Ang film ay nakabuo ng emosyonal na koneksyon sa mga karakter at sa kwento.*	Walang nadamang koneksyon o emosyon.	Bahagyang nakaramdam ng emosyon.	Katamtaman g nakakaugna y sa mga karakter.	Malinaw na nakaaantig at nakauugnay sa kwento.	Lubos na nakaaantig, malalim, at nakakakonekta sa damdamin.
Tunog at Musika *Ang background music at sound design ay nakapagpapaigting sa emosyon ng pelikula.*	Hindi akma o nakakaistorbo ang tunog.	Bahagyang nakatulong sa emosyon.	Katamtaman g nakadagdag sa damdamin.	Akmang-akma at nakapagpapaigti ng sa emosyon.	Lubos na akma, nakaaantig, at nagpapalalim sa damdamin ng manonood.
Pangmatagalan g Epekto *Ang film ay nag-iwan ng positibo at di-malilimutang impresyon sa manonood.*	Walang iniwang impresyon o epekto.	Bahagyang may naiwang epekto.	Katamtaman g nakaaantig.	May positibong impresyon matapos mapanood.	Lubos na nakaaantig, makabuluhan, at di-malilimutang kwento.

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Questions:		1	2	3	4	5
1	Ang film ay nagbibigay ng kaaya-aya at magandang karanasan sa panonood.					
2.	Ang film ay nagpapanatili ng interes at atensyon ng manonood.					
3.	Ang film ay nakabuo ng emosyonal na koneksyon sa mga karakter at sa kwento.					
4.	Ang background music at sound design ay nakapagpapaigting sa emosyon ng pelikula.					
5.	Ang film ay nag-iwan ng positibo at di-malilimutang impresyon sa manonood.					

Attitude Toward Use (ATU)

Sinusukat ang kabuuang saloobin, kasiyahan, at pagpapahalaga ng manonood sa pelikula bilang isang kapaki-pakinabang na materyal sa pagkatuto at adbokasiya

Pamantayan/ Deskripsyon	1- Lubos na Hindi Sumasang-ayon	2 – Hindi Sumasang-ayon	3 - Patas	4 – Sumasang-ayon	5 – Lubos na Sumasang-ayon
Kasiyahan at Kapakinabangan *Masaya at kapaki-pakinabang panoorin ang film na ito.*	Hindi kasiya-siya at walang pakinabang.	Bahagyang kasiya-siya ngunit limitado ang pakinabang.	Katamtamang kasiya-siya at may kaunting pakinabang.	Kaaya-aya at may malinaw na pakinabang.	Lubos na kasiya-siya at kapaki-pakinabang sa panonood.
Pagkatuto *Mas naging makabuluhan ang pagkatuto ko tungkol sa mga mangingisda dahil sa film na ito.*	Walang nadagdag na kaalaman.	Kaunting kaalaman ang nadagdag.	Katamtamang nadagdagan ang pag-unawa.	Malinaw na nadagdagan ang kaalaman.	Lubos na nadagdagan at napalalim ang pag-unawa.
Pagsuporta *Naengganyo akong suportahan o alamin pa ang tungkol sa mga mangingisda matapos panoorin ang film.*	Walang interes na suportahan.	Bahagyang naengganyo ngunit hindi sapat.	Katamtamang naengganyo.	Malinaw na naengganyo na suportahan o alamin pa.	Lubos na naengganyo at inspiradong tumulong o makiisa.
Pagpapahalaga sa Mensahe *Pinahahalagahan ko ang mensaheng ipinarating ng pelikula tungkol sa mga mangingisda.*	Hindi naunawaan o pinahalagahan ang mensahe.	Bahagyang pinapahala-gahan ang mensahe	Katamtamang pinahalagahan ang mensahe.	Malinaw na pinapahala-gahan at nauunawaan	Lubos na pinahalagahan at naantig sa mensahe ng pelikula.

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Kabuuan *Lubos akong nasiyahan at nagpapasalamat sa kabuuang nilalaman ng pelikula.*	Hindi nasiyahan o walang pagpapahalaga.	Bahagyang nasiyahan.	Katamtamang nasiyahan	Nasiyahan at pinapaha- gahan ang pelikula	Lubos na nasiyahan, naantig, at nagpapasalamat sa mensahe ng pelikula.

Questions:		1	2	3	4	5
1	Masaya at kapaki-pakinabang panoorin ang film na ito.					
2.	Mas naging makabuluhan ang pagkatuto ko tungkol sa mga mangingisda dahil sa film na ito.					
3.	Naengganyo akong suportahan o alamin pa ang tungkol sa mga mangingisda matapos panoorin ang film.					
4.	Pinahahalagahan ko ang mensaheng ipinarating ng pelikula tungkol sa mga mangingisda.					
5.	Lubos akong nasiyahan at nagpapasalamat sa kabuuang nilalaman ng pelikula.					

Behavioral Intention to Use (BIU)

Sinusukat kung gaano kalaki ang posibilidad na gamitin, irekomenda, o suportahan ng mga manonood ang pelikula bilang materyal sa pagkatuto at adbokasiya.

Pamantayan/ Deskripsyon	1- Lubos na Hindi Sumasang-ayon	2 – Hindi Sumasang-ayon	3 - Patas	4 – Sumasang-ayon	5 – Lubos na Sumasang-ayon
Pagkatuto *Marami akong natutunan tungkol sa buhay ng mga mangingisda at mas naging mulat ako sa kahalagahan ng pagsuporta sa kanila.*	Walang natutunan o kamalayang nabuo.	Kaunting natutunan lamang.	Katamtamang pagkatuto at kamalayan.	Malinaw na nadagdagan ang pag-unawa at kamalayan.	Lubos na natuto at naging mulat sa kahalagahan ng pagsuporta.
Pagunawa sa Komunidad *Nakatulong ang film na ito sa aking pag-unawa sa mga kwentong tungkol sa komunidad.*	Walang naitulong sa pag-unawa.	Bahagyang nakatulong.	Katamtamang nakatulong.	Malinaw na nakatulong sa pag-unawa.	Lubos na nakatulong at nagpalalim ng pag-unawa.
Pagsuporta *Suportado ko ang mga susunod na*	Walang interes o suporta.		Katamtamang sumusuporta.	Malinaw na sumusuporta sa	Lubos na sumusuporta at

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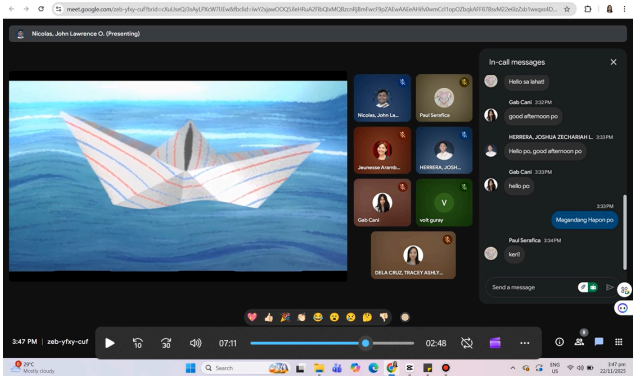
proyekto na katulad ng film na ito.		Bahagyang interesado lamang.		ganitong proyekto.	hinihikayat ang mga susunod na proyekto..
Pagrekomenda sa Iba *Ire-rekomenda ko ang film na ito sa iba..*	Hindi irerekomenda.	Bahagyang irerekomenda.	Katamtamang irerekomenda.	Malinaw na irerekomenda sa iba.	Lubos na irerekomenda at ipapamahagi sa iba.
Pagsasagawa ng Aksyon *Na-inspire akong kumilos o makilahok sa mga adbokasiyang tumutulong sa mga mangingisda.*	Walang inspirasyong kumilos..	Bahagyang na-inspire.	Katamtamang na-inspire.	Malinaw na na-inspire kumilos o makiisa.	Lubos na na-inspire at determinado sa pagsuporta o pagkilos.

Questions:		1	2	3	4	5
1	Marami akong natutunan tungkol sa buhay ng mga mangingisda at mas naging mulat ako sa kahalagahan ng pagsuporta sa kanila.					
2.	Nakatulong ang film na ito sa aking pag-unawa sa mga kwentong tungkol sa komunidad.					
3.	Suportado ko ang mga susunod na proyekto na katulad ng film na ito.					
4.	Ire-rekomenda ko ang film na ito sa iba.					
5.	Na-inspire akong kumilos o makilahok sa mga adbokasiyang tumutulong sa mga mangingisda.					

APPENDIX H

LEVEL OF ACCEPTANCE


Nicolas, John Lawrence O. (Presenting)
In-call messages
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Gab Cani 3:32 PM
good afternoon po
HERRERA, JOSHUA ZECHARIAH L. 3:33 PM
Hello po, good afternoon po
Gab Cani 3:33 PM
hello po
3:33 PM
Magandang Hapon po
Paul Serafica 3:34 PM
ker!
Send a message
3:47 PM | zeb-yfxy-cuf
07:11
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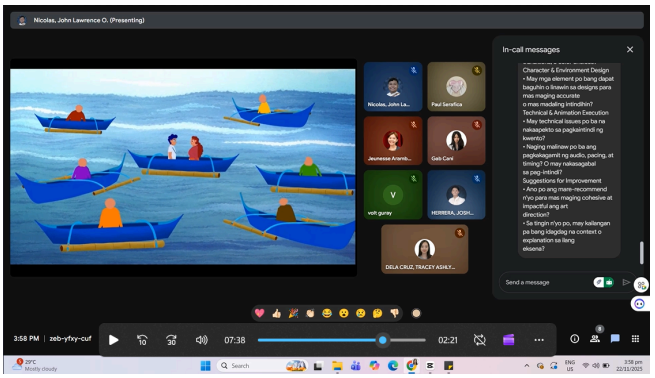
Nicolas, John Lawrence O. (Presenting)
In-call messages
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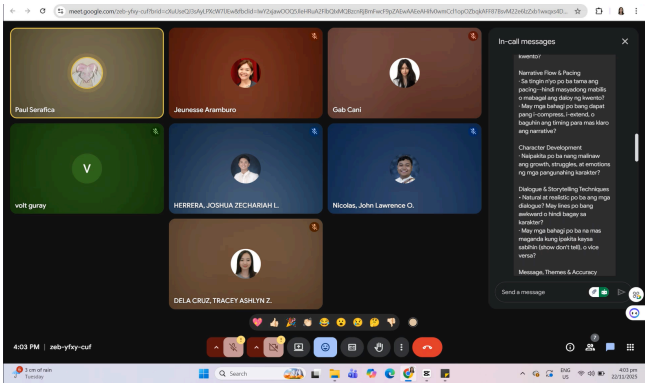
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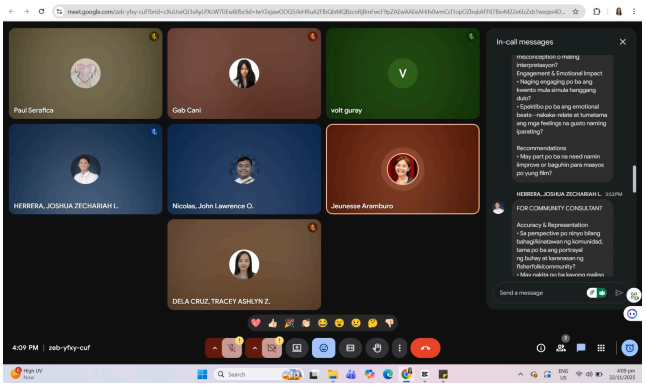
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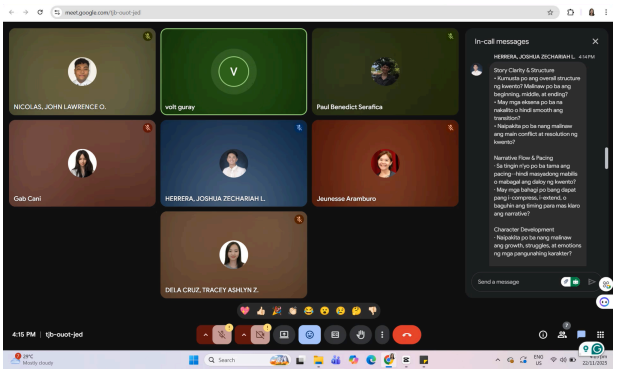
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APPENDIX I

DATA GATHERING & DOCUMENTATION

BISEXUALITEA
UMASA

APPENDIX J

PUBLISHABLE PAPER

ANAKDAGAT: A 2D ANIMATED SHORT FILM ON THE LIFE OF THE FILIPINO FISHERFOLK COMMUNITY

Tracey Ashlyn Z. Dela Cruz, John Lawrence O. Nicolas, Gabrielle C. Banzon, Joshua Zechariah L. Herrera, Gene Marck B. Catedrilla
College of Computer Studies (CCS), Laguna State Polytechnic University, Los Banos, Laguna, Philippines

ARTICLE INFORMATION

Keywords:
Small-scale Fisherfolk
F/B Pagbabago
BFAR

ABSTRACT

Filipino fisherfolk communities play a vital role in ensuring national food security and sustaining coastal economies, yet they continue to face persistent socio-economic challenges that are often overlooked. Despite their contributions to local livelihoods and the agricultural sector, issues such as poverty, environmental threats, and social marginalization receive limited attention in public awareness initiatives. Inadequate representation in mainstream media further reduces visibility, weakening public understanding of their working conditions, struggles, and cultural identity. This project addresses these gaps through AnakDagat, a 2D animated short film that portrays the lived experiences of small-scale Filipino fisherfolk in a culturally sensitive and accessible manner. The film seeks to foster awareness, empathy, and appreciation for their role in coastal livelihoods by presenting social realities through engaging visual storytelling. Its production followed a structured animation pipeline informed by field immersion, community interviews, and documentary review to ensure narrative accuracy and authenticity. The effectiveness of the film as an educational and awareness-oriented medium was evaluated using the Technology Acceptance Model, with feedback gathered from experts and general viewers. Results indicated high perceived usefulness, ease of understanding, and satisfaction, with an acceptance rating of 4.5. These findings highlight the potential of animated storytelling for communicating social issues and disseminating community-focused research.

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John Lawrence O. Nicolas
College of Computer Studies
Laguna State Polytechnic University
Email: nicolasjohnlawrenceo@gmail.com

1. INTRODUCTION

In an archipelagic country like the Philippines, where over 7,000 islands form the backbone of communities and commerce, the role of small-scale fisherfolk is crucial. Fishing is not only a source of livelihood but also an integral part of the nation's food security and local economies. Approximately 2.3 million Filipinos are employed in municipal fisheries, with 1.1 million engaged in capture fishing, while others participate in aquaculture, gleaning, vending, and processing [1]. Despite their contribution to national development, fisherfolk communities remain among the most economically vulnerable sectors, often earning below the poverty threshold due to unstable income, seasonal fishing conditions, and increasing environmental risks [2]–[4].

Government interventions, such as the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR) F/B Pagbabago Program, aim to address these challenges by providing durable fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) boats,

livelihood training, and technical support [5]–[7]. While such initiatives contribute to improved safety and productivity, public awareness of both fisherfolk struggles and government support programs remains limited. Traditional information dissemination methods often fail to engage broader audiences or convey the emotional realities of affected communities.

Animation has emerged as an effective medium for advocacy and education, capable of simplifying complex social issues while fostering emotional engagement [8]–[10]. Through visual storytelling, animation can humanize marginalized experiences and communicate policy impacts in an accessible manner. This study focuses on the development of *AnakDagat*, a 2D animated short film that portrays the lived experiences of Filipino fisherfolk and highlights the role of institutional support programs. The study further evaluates the film's acceptability using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) to determine its effectiveness as an advocacy tool.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

The specific objectives of this study are

1. To gather data on the life and difficulties encountered by small-scale fisherfolk and positive changes brought by programs and initiatives by government and non-government organizations, such as but not limited to the F/B Pagbabago Program, and use it to create a script and storyboard.
2. To develop a story and a 2D animated short film based on the collected data that effectively communicates the program's goal and impact.
3. To evaluate the acceptability of the 2D animated film using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) framework through a structured questionnaire.

2. RELATED LITERATURE

Fisherfolk Communities

Fisherfolk communities are central to the Philippine fisheries sector, supporting national food security and local economies, yet they continue to face persistent socioeconomic challenges such as poverty, declining resources, and environmental degradation [11][12]. Many small-scale fishers rely heavily on coastal resources but struggle with low incomes, limited market opportunities, and insufficient institutional support.

F/B Pagbabago Livelihood Program

The Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR) introduced the F/B Pagbabago Livelihood Program, which provides fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) boats to replace traditional wooden vessels, offering fisherfolk more durable, disaster-resilient, and environmentally sustainable equipment [5], [13]. The program includes livelihood support through the "Banca Ko, Gawa Ko" cash-for-work scheme, which trains beneficiaries in FRP boat construction and maintenance [5]. FRP boats significantly improve safety, efficiency, and resistance to seawater corrosion compared to wooden boats [14].

Animation as a Medium of Change

Animation is not only a form of entertainment but also a powerful tool for advocacy, education, and policy messaging, as it simplifies complex topics and evokes emotional engagement [15]. Animated storytelling can effectively convey the struggles of marginalized communities, including fisherfolk, illustrating challenges like economic instability and environmental threats, while showcasing government programs such as the F/B Pagbabago Livelihood Program [16], [17].

By creating culturally relevant animations and collaborating with organizations like the Animation Council of the Philippines (ACPI), storytelling can foster empathy, promote program adoption, and encourage public and policy engagement, proving animation's capacity as a tool for meaningful social change [18].

SYNTHESIS

The literature shows that Filipino fisherfolk face ongoing socioeconomic, environmental, and policy challenges, underscoring the need for sustainable and disaster-resilient interventions. BFAR's F/B

Pagbabago Program provides vital support through safer fiberglass boats and livelihood training, despite issues such as financial constraints and resistance to change. Animation is an effective advocacy tool for humanizing fisherfolk struggles and promoting livelihood programs, yet few studies examine the use of 2D animation for this purpose. This study addresses this gap by creating a 2D animated short film to raise awareness and highlight institutional support.

CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK

The conceptual framework of this study, as illustrated in Figure 1, outlines the structured phases of the 2D animation production process, emphasizing the integration of various tools and techniques to achieve a high-quality final output. It is divided into three phases—pre-production, production, and post-production—each covering essential tasks for creating a polished animation.

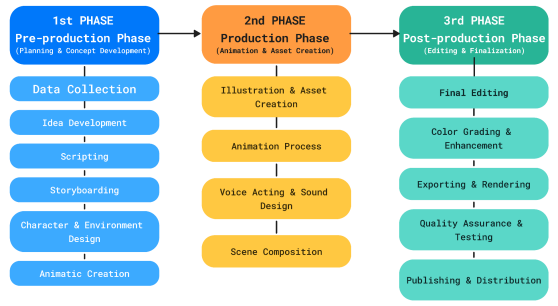

Figure 1. Conceptual Framework of the Study

3. METHODOLOGY

This chapter presents all the methods and processes used in the development of this animated short film.

3.1 Data Gathering

To create a 2D short animated film about the life and struggles of fisherfolk, coastal communities, and the F/B Pagbabago Program and its impact on their lives, the researchers incorporated animation development, sampling strategies, study population, data collection tools, and statistical analysis.

3.2 Animation Development Model

2D animation is the art of creating movement in a two-dimensional space. Raster drawings are used to develop characters, storyboards, and backgrounds. This figure shows the animation production process in seven steps: gathering information, script and character design, storyboard, voiceover and animatic, animation, sound design, and final video composition.

Figure 2. The Animation Process

3.3 Population of the Study

The population of this study includes fifty (50) respondents: two (3) animation experts to critique technical proficiency and story structure. The remaining forty-seven (47) respondents are selected participants from relevant communities and academic backgrounds who are included to evaluate clarity, emotional impact, and accessibility.

3.4 Sampling Design

The main objective of this research is to produce a 2D animated film, AnakDagat, focusing on the struggles of small-scale fisherfolk and the positive impact of BFAR's F/B Pagbabago Program. The film aims to amplify underrepresented voices and raise awareness of poverty alleviation and sustainable fishing. Feedback was gathered using a close-ended questionnaire, allowing standardized data collection and simplifying analysis, ensuring clarity and consistency in assessing the animation's acceptability and message delivery.

3.5 Statistical Treatment of Data

The research employed descriptive statistics as its primary statistical method. The responses from the questionnaire were summarized using the Median (M) to interpret the central tendency of the data. All collected responses were encoded into Microsoft Excel and analyzed using IBM SPSS software to generate findings related to the film's reception, particularly in terms of perceived usefulness, clarity, and emotional engagement. These results were vital in determining how

well the AnakDagat film communicated its intended message.

To evaluate the film, a closed-ended questionnaire was used. Each item was rated using a 5-point Likert scale.

Table 1. Likert Scale

Rating	Verbal Interpretation
5	Strongly Agree
4	Agree
3	Fair
2	Disagree
1	Strongly Disagree

Each questionnaire item was tailored to respondents' experiences, with an estimated completion time of 10–20 minutes. A social advocacy expert and a communication specialist validated it for accuracy and relevance to the film's goals.

3.6 Project Design

This study used a descriptive research design to evaluate the acceptability of AnakDagat, a 2D animated short promoting BFAR's F/B Pagbabago Program and raising awareness of small-scale fisherfolk struggles. The questionnaire, validated by an animation and a communication expert, assessed the film's clarity, emotional appeal, message delivery, and effectiveness. After validation, respondents viewed the film and completed the questionnaire, with evaluation guided by the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM).

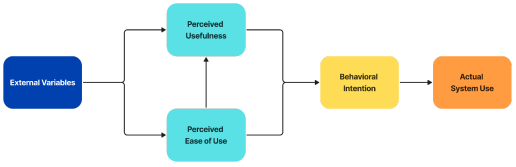

Figure 3. Technology Acceptance Model

3.7 Ethical Considerations

This study adhered to ethical standards, ensuring no harm to individuals, cultural values, or the environment during the creation of AnakDagat. All visuals, writing, and animation were manually produced by the researchers and artists to preserve authenticity and cultural sensitivity. Participant information will remain confidential and used solely for research purposes.

4. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter presents the study's findings aligned with the project's aim, organized by research objectives and interpreted using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM). It synthesizes the data, film development, and evaluation responses to provide a comprehensive assessment of the film's acceptability and effectiveness.

Results by Objectives

Main Objective

The main objective is to create a 2D animated film that gives visibility to the lives of small-scale Filipino fisherfolk while also showing the role and impact of help given to the sector. Through an empathetic interpretation of coastal communities' lives, the film hopes to inspire future and additional initiatives. And through this research and development, this objective was achieved.

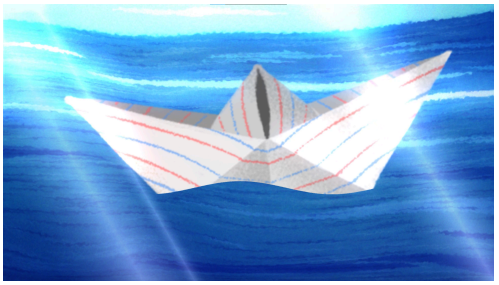

Figure 4. Introduction of the film

Figure 4 is a screen capture of the first shot of the film that was made.

1. **To gather data on the life and difficulties encountered by small-scale fisherfolk and positive changes brought by programs and initiatives by government and non-government organizations, such as, but not limited to, the F/B Pagbabago Program.**

Through collaborations with various organizations, the researchers were introduced to the program "Makipamuhay, Makipag-aralan," led by the Concerned Artists of the Philippines (CAP) with

PAMALAKAYA and Anakdagat, supported by UP Diliman CSWCD. It was a program that provided the researchers the opportunity to volunteer in the fisherfolk community of Binangonan Rizal and gain firsthand accounts and observations of the community.

2. **To develop a story and a 2D animated short film based on the collected data that effectively communicate the program's goals and impact.**

Drawing from academic literature and firsthand immersion, the researchers crafted a narrative reflecting small-scale fisherfolk's struggles, resilience, and aspirations, shaped by direct observations and personal accounts.

A key theme across all acts is the paper boat as a central symbol. Unlike the wooden fishing boat that represents material livelihood and burden, the paper boat symbolizes fragility, hope, imagination, and generational aspiration. It reflects the vulnerability of small-scale fishing communities amid environmental and socio-economic challenges, while also highlighting their resilience and enduring spirit. The paper boat bridges the film's documentary and interpretive elements, grounding the narrative in lived experience while allowing symbolic reflection.

3. **To evaluate the acceptability of the 2D animated film using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) framework through a structured questionnaire.**

IT EXPERT'S RESPONSE

Table 2. Technology Acceptance Model based on IT Expert's Response

CATEGORY	MEAN	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
Perceived Usefulness	3.60	Agree
Perceived Ease of Use	4.27	Agree
Aesthetic Quality	4.13	Agree
Perceived Enjoyment	4.53	Strongly Agree
Attitude Towards Use	4.20	Agree
Behavioral Intention to Use	4.27	Agree
Overall TAM Mean	**4.17**	**Agree**

Legend: 1.00-1.49 = Strongly Disagree, 1.50-2.49 = Disagree, 2.50-3.49 = Neutral, 3.50-4.49 = Agree, 4.50-5.00 = Strongly Agree

Table 2 summarizes the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) results based on the responses of the IT experts. The animated film obtained an overall TAM mean of 4.17, interpreted as *Agree*, indicating general acceptance in terms of usefulness, usability, visual quality, enjoyment, and intention to use.

Among the six TAM categories, *Perceived Enjoyment* recorded the highest mean (M = 4.53, *Strongly Agree*), showing that the experts found the film engaging and emotionally effective. *Perceived Ease of Use* and *Behavioral Intention to Use* both yielded a mean of 4.27 (*Agree*), suggesting that the film is accessible and suitable for educational and promotional use.

Aesthetic Quality, *Attitude Towards Use*, and *Perceived Usefulness* were also rated positively, with mean scores ranging from 3.60 to 4.20 (*Agree*). Overall, the results indicate that the film was well-received by IT experts as an effective and engaging tool for awareness, education, and advocacy.

RESPONDENT'S RESPONSE

Table 3. Summary Mean Table of TAM

	MEAN	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
Perceived Usefulness	4.59	Strongly Agree
Perceived Ease of Use	4.45	Agree
Aesthetic Quality	4.45	Agree
Perceived Enjoyment	4.47	Agree
Attitude Towards Use	4.50	Strongly Agree
Behavioral Intention to Use	4.63	Strongly Agree
Overall TAM Result:	**4.52**	**Strongly Agree**

Legend: 1.00-1.49 = Strongly Disagree, 1.50-2.49 = Disagree, 2.50-3.49 = Neutral, 3.50-4.49 = Agree, 4.50-5.00 = Strongly Agree

The table above shows the TAM results, indicating that respondents had a generally positive perception of the film. The film was perceived as useful in enhancing understanding of the lives and struggles of Filipino fisherfolk and was found to be accessible and easy to follow across devices. Its aesthetic quality and overall enjoyment were rated positively, reflecting visual appeal and engaging storytelling. Respondents reported a favorable attitude toward using the film for learning and expressed strong behavioral intention to support similar projects. The overall TAM score of 4.52 (Strongly Agree) reflects a high level of acceptance. These results suggest that the film was effective in conveying its message, engaging viewers, and promoting interest in advocacy for fisherfolk communities.

5. CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATION

Summary

Preliminary analysis showed strong specialist interest in producing a 2D animated film that highlights the daily lives, struggles, and perspectives of small-scale fisherfolk, while emphasizing the importance of promoting government and NGO initiatives for positive community change. The researchers used Adobe Photoshop and After Effects to develop the film by gathering information on fisherfolk's daily lives and the impact of programs like the F/B Pagbabago Program, creating a 2D animated short that communicates these insights, and evaluating its acceptability using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) through structured questionnaires with experts and community members.

Conclusion

Based on the completed research, development, and evaluations, the following conclusions were drawn:

Understanding Fisherfolk Experiences:

The researchers collaborated with government and NGO programs in CALABARZON, including Makipamuhay, Makipag-aralan, CAP, PAMALAKAYA, Anakdagat, and UP Diliman. Immersion in Brgy. Gupiing, Binangonan, Rizal, provided firsthand insights into the daily struggles and perspectives of fisherfolk, which informed the film's storyline and script.

Developing a Narrative for the Film:

The narrative emphasizes fishing boats as symbols of the psychological and emotional burdens of fisherfolk. Through a family-centered story, the film depicts both external and internal challenges while highlighting supportive programs, creating an emotional connection and a call to action to sustain community initiatives.

Evaluating Film Acceptability:

A structured TAM-based survey, guided by a professional statistician, assessed the film's acceptability. Responses from three experts and thirty participants, including fisherfolk and students, showed a strong rating of 4.5, confirming the film's effectiveness and offering insights for future improvements.

Recommendations

Based on the findings and evaluations, the following recommendations are proposed to enhance the effectiveness and impact of future projects:

Community Collaboration:

Engage community members or consultants during story development to ensure accurate representation of their experiences and cultural context. Immersion within the community is recommended to capture nuanced perspectives.

Sound Design Enhancement:

Allocate resources for professional recording equipment and trained voice actors to improve auditory quality and enhance audience engagement.

Focused Narrative Development:

Define a clear central theme or case study and prioritize content that supports it. Omit elements that do not contribute to narrative coherence to maintain conciseness within the film's duration.

Ethical and Respectful Storytelling:

Maintain sensitivity toward subjects and communities represented. Consultation is essential to prevent misrepresentation, romanticization, or exploitation of lived experiences.

Efficient Animation Practices:

Utilize time-saving techniques such as keyframing, puppet animation, or photo manipulation. Software like Adobe After Effects, in combination with illustration programs (e.g., Photoshop,) can optimize workflow while maintaining production quality.

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APPENDIX K

PERMISSION LETTERS

Laguna State Polytechnic University - Los Banos Campus
Brgy. Malinta, Los Baños, Laguna
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology
Specialized in Animation and Motion Graphics

To:
Jeune Aramburo
Concerned Artist of the Philippines

Subject: Invitation as Subject Specialist for Thesis Film Consultation
Date & Time: November 22, 2025 – 3:00 PM
Meeting Link: https://meet.google.com/zeb-yfxy-cuf

Dear Jeune Aramburo,

Mabuhay! We hope you're doing well. We are reaching out to warmly invite you to serve as our **Visual Direction Specialist** for our thesis film, ***AnakDagat: A 2D Animated Short Film on the Life of the Fisherfolk Community***.

We have chosen you for this role because your insight and experience are greatly valued. Your perspective will help us refine our work, ensuring that the film remains thoughtful, accurate, and grounded in the communities and stories it hopes to represent.

During our consultation, we kindly ask for your participation in the following activities:

1. **Film Viewing**
   We will begin with a full viewing of our current film edit so you may assess its flow, clarity, and treatment.

2. **Open Discussion / Q&A**
   After the viewing, we will open the floor for your comments, questions, and suggestions. This will help us understand your observations and identify areas for improvement.

3. **Post-Session Survey Questionnaire**
   Once the meeting ends, we will provide a brief survey for you to answer. This allows us to properly document your feedback for our thesis requirements.

With your permission, we will also be **documenting the session** (notes and/or recording) for research and revision purposes. This will only proceed with your consent.

We truly appreciate your time and openness in guiding us through this part of our project. Should you need any additional information or clarifications, please feel free to reach out.

Thank you very much, and we look forward to learning from you.

Respectfully yours,

The "AnakDagat" Film Production Team:
Tracey Ashlyn Z. Dela Cruz
Joshua Zechariah L. Herrera
John Lawrence O. Nicolas
Gabrielle C. Banzon

Contact Information:
Email: shortfilmahon@gmail.com
Contact No.: 09354535601

Laguna State Polytechnic University - Los Banos Campus
Brgy. Malinta, Los Baños, Laguna
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology
Specialized in Animation and Motion Graphics

6th of November, 2025

To:
Mr. Voltaire Guray
PAMALAKAYA Pilipinas

Subject: Request for Permission to Use the Name “AnakDagat” *for Academic Use*

Good day! We are a group of 4th-year Bachelor of Science in Information Technology students majoring in Animation and Motion Graphics from Laguna State Polytechnic University – Los Baños Campus. Our group is currently producing a 2D animated short film entitled “AnakDagat: A 2D Animated Short Film on the Life of the Filipino Fisherfolk Community.” The film sheds light on the struggles of coastal communities and families and highlights how empathy and support can help them rise while staying rooted in their identity. It is a reflection on loss, resilience, and the power of collective upliftment within the fisherfolk community.

We respectfully request permission to use the name “AnakDagat” as the official title of our film. We want to ensure that we represent your organization respectfully and appropriately, and we will include proper acknowledgments in the film credits.

Please be assured that this film will be used solely for academic purposes as part of our capstone project and will be presented only within our university and related academic exhibitions.

We would be truly honored to use the name in our project, as it perfectly aligns with the message and advocacy of our film. Should you require any additional information or formal documentation, please feel free to reach out through our contact details below.

Thank you very much for your time, consideration, and for empowering and championing the voices and stories of our fisherfolk communities. We look forward to your kind response.

Respectfully yours,

The “AnakDagat” Film Production Team:
Tracey Ashlyn Z. Dela Cruz
Joshua Zechariah L. Herrera
John Lawrence O. Nicolas
Gabrielle C. Banzon

Contact Information:
Email: shortfilmahon@gmail.com
Contact No.: 09354535601

Laguna State Polytechnic University - Los Banos Campus
Brgy. Malinta, Los Baños, Laguna
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology
Specialized in Animation and Motion Graphics

6th of November, 2025

To:
Mr. Edge Uyanguren
Secretary General of the Concerned Artists of the Philippines (CAP)

Subject: Request for Permission to Use the Song *"Sana" for Academic Use*

Good day! We are a group of 4th-year Bachelor of Science in Information Technology students majoring in Animation and Motion Graphics from Laguna State Polytechnic University – Los Baños Campus. Our group is currently producing a 2D animated short film entitled "AnakDagat: A 2D Animated Short Film on the Life of the Filipino Fisherfolk Community."The film sheds light on the struggles of coastal communities and families and highlights how empathy and support can help them rise while staying rooted in their identity. It is a reflection on loss, resilience, and the power of collective upliftment within the fisherfolk community.

We respectfully request permission to use your song "Sana Bukas," created during the Concerned Artists of the Philippines and PAMALAKAYA's Basic Mass Integration in Binangonan, Rizal, along with its instrumental version, as the main song and musical score for our film. It will be featured in the montage, ending, and credits sequences.

Please be assured that this film will be used solely for academic purposes as part of our capstone project and will be presented only within our university and related academic exhibitions.

We would be truly honored to include your song in our project, as it perfectly aligns with the message and advocacy of our film. Should you require any additional information or formal documentation, please feel free to reach out through our contact details below.

Thank you very much for your time, consideration, and for creating music that amplifies the voices and stories of our fisherfolk communities. We look forward to your kind response.

Respectfully yours,

The "AnakDagat" Film Production Team:
Tracey Ashlyn Z. Dela Cruz
Joshua Zechariah L. Herrera
John Lawrence O. Nicolas
Gabrielle C. Banzon

Contact Information:
Email: shortfilmahon@gmail.com
Contact No.: 09354535601

Laguna State Polytechnic University - Los Banos Campus
Brgy. Malinta, Los Baños, Laguna
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology
Specialized in Animation and Motion Graphics

To:
Voltaire Guray
PAMALAKAYA Pilipinas

Subject: Invitation as Subject Specialist for Thesis Film Consultation
Date & Time: November 22, 2025 – 3:00 PM
Meeting Link: https://meet.google.com/zeb-yfxy-cuf

Dear Voltaire Guray,

Mabuhay! We hope you're doing well. We are reaching out to warmly invite you to serve as our **Community Consultant** for our thesis film, ***AnakDagat: A 2D Animated Short Film on the Life of the Fisherfolk Community***.

We have chosen you for this role because your insight and experience are greatly valued. Your perspective will help us refine our work, ensuring that the film remains thoughtful, accurate, and grounded in the communities and stories it hopes to represent.

During our consultation, we kindly ask for your participation in the following activities:

1. **Film Viewing**
   We will begin with a full viewing of our current film edit so you may assess its flow, clarity, and treatment.

2. **Open Discussion / Q&A**
   After the viewing, we will open the floor for your comments, questions, and suggestions. This will help us understand your observations and identify areas for improvement.

3. **Post-Session Survey Questionnaire**
   Once the meeting ends, we will provide a brief survey for you to answer. This allows us to properly document your feedback for our thesis requirements.

With your permission, we will also be **documenting the session** (notes and/or recording) for research and revision purposes. This will only proceed with your consent.

We truly appreciate your time and openness in guiding us through this part of our project. Should you need any additional information or clarifications, please feel free to reach out.

Thank you very much, and we look forward to learning from you.

Respectfully yours,

The "AnakDagat" Film Production Team:
Tracey Ashlyn Z. Dela Cruz
Joshua Zechariah L. Herrera
John Lawrence O. Nicolas
Gabrielle C. Banzon

Contact Information:
Email: shortfilmahon@gmail.com
Contact No.: 09354535601

APPENDIX L

SIMILARITY INDEX

for checking ANAKDAGAT_ A 2D ANIMATED SHORT FILM ON THE LIFE OF THE FILIPINO FISHERFOLK COMMUNITY (Revised).pdf

ORIGINALITY REPORT

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APPENDIX M

GRAMMARLY & AI ASSISTANCE CHECKER

for checking ANAKDAGAT_ A 2D ANIMATED SHORT FILM ON THE LIFE OF THE FILIPINO FISHERFOLK COMMUNITY (Revised) (1)

by Ronah joy Ramirez

General metrics

78,805	10,648	688	42 min 35 sec	1 hr 21 min
characters	words	sentences	reading time	speaking time

Score

This text scores better than 96% of all texts checked by Grammarly

Writing Issues

146	35	111
Issues left	Critical	Advanced

Plagiarism

This text hasn't been checked for plagiarism

Writing Issues

46	**Correctness**	
4	Text inconsistencies	
4	Closing punctuation	
2	Improper formatting	
9	Incorrect punctuation	
3	Confused words	
7	Incorrect noun number	
1	Pronoun use	
1	Citation style options	
4	Incorrect phrasing	
2	Misuse of modifiers	
5	Ungrammatical sentence	
1	Wrong or missing prepositions	
1	Faulty subject-verb agreement	
1	Determiner use (a/an/the/this, etc.)	
1	Comma misuse within clauses	
95	**Clarity**	
85	Paragraph can be improved	
2	Wordy sentences	
5	Intricate text	
2	Hard-to-read text	
1	Passive voice misuse	
2	**Delivery**	
1	Inappropriate colloquialisms	
1	Incomplete sentences	

3 **Engagement**

3 Word choice

Unique Words

20%

Measures vocabulary diversity by calculating the percentage of words used only once in your document

unique words

Rare Words

47%

Measures depth of vocabulary by identifying words that are not among the 5,000 most common English words.

rare words

Word Length

5.5

Measures average word length

characters per word

Sentence Length

15.5

Measures average sentence length

words per sentence

Copy of for checking 2 ANAKDAGAT_ A 2D ANIMATED SHORT FILM ON THE LIFE OF THE FILIPINO FISHERFOLK COMMUNITY (Revised) (1)

by Ronah joy Ramirez

General metrics

65,862	9,211	893	36 min 50 sec	1 hr 10 min
characters	words	sentences	reading time	speaking time

Score

This text scores better than 91% of all texts checked by Grammarly

Writing Issues

209	69	140
Issues left	Critical	Advanced

Plagiarism

This text hasn't been checked for plagiarism

Writing Issues

113	**Clarity**	
101	Paragraph can be improved	
7	Intricate text	
3	Passive voice misuse	
2	Hard-to-read text	
81	**Correctness**	
9	Text inconsistencies	
3	Incorrect verb forms	
19	Ungrammatical sentence	
8	Confused words	
3	Pronoun use	
13	Incorrect punctuation	
4	Determiner use (a/an/the/this, etc.)	
2	Conjunction use	
4	Faulty subject-verb agreement	
4	Wrong or missing prepositions	
2	Incomplete sentences	
1	Incorrect phrasing	
2	Improper formatting	
2	Misspelled words	
3	Incorrect noun number	
2	Comma misuse within clauses	
12	**Engagement**	
12	Word choice	

3	**Delivery**	
2	Incomplete sentences	
1	Inappropriate colloquialisms	

Unique Words

Measures vocabulary diversity by calculating the percentage of words used only once in your document

21%

unique words

Rare Words

Measures depth of vocabulary by identifying words that are not among the 5,000 most common English words.

46%

rare words

Word Length

Measures average word length

5.4

characters per word

Sentence Length

Measures average sentence length

10.3

words per sentence

APPENDIX M

CURRICULUM VITAE

BANZON, GABRIELLE

GRAPHIC DESIGNER

I'm an IT student and freelance graphic designer with three years of experience creating social media graphics, esports visuals, and custom jersey designs. I specialize in modern, impactful layouts and enjoy collaborating with clients to bring their ideas to life.

CONTACTS

gabbanzon5@gmail.com
0995-575-1276
in/gabrielle-banzon-381925317
behance.net/gabinvisuals

EDUCATION

Laguna State Polytechnic University
2022 - 2026

BS Information Technology
Specializing in Animation & Motion Graphics

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Ps Ai Lr Ch An
Canva

SOFT SKILLS

- Detail Oriented
- Fast Project Turnaround
- Communication Skills
- Critical Thinking
- Collaboration Skills
- Active Listening

BEHANCE

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Freelance Graphic Designer - E-Sports
2022 - Present

- Luxe Esports
- Khi Esports
- Athrafsots Esports
- Azi Vitality
- 4SE Esports
- ZEP Esports
- Fate Ladies
- Prolegaz International

Freelance Graphic Designer - Businesses
2024 - 2025

- Discounted UC
- All Girls PH Organization Series
- Moro Community
- Klia

Jersey Designer
2025

- Blooms Corner Jersey
- Luxe Esports Jersey

TRAININGS & SEMINARS

- Brand Communication Training (2021)
- Let's Study in France Webinar (featuring the ESMA 3D Animation and Effects course, 2025)
- Role of Technology in Sustainable Development (2025)

DELA CRUZ, TRACEY ASHLYN

GRAPHIC DESIGNER

Aspiring Animation and Motion Graphics major eager to apply creative skills, technical expertise, and a passion for storytelling in a professional setting. Committed to contributing fresh ideas and growing within the digital arts field.

CONTACTS

johnlawrenceonicolas@gmail.com
0928-619-8880
in/ashlynnn028
behance.net/cshlynnnn

EDUCATION

Laguna State Polytechnic University
2022 - 2026

BS Information Technology
Specializing in Animation & Motion Graphics

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Ps Ai Lr Ch An

Canva

SOFT SKILLS

- Flexibility
- Creativity
- Innovativeness
- Critical Thinking
- Collaboration Skills
- Active Listening

LINKEDIN

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Yazaki Torres Manufacturing Inc. Company
2020

• On The Job Training / Internship

- Awarded Most Neat during my stint in the company. Also had Occupational Safety and Health Administration training as a standard for workers and employees.

Algorhythm Call Center Services
2021

• Chat Support Representative

-Respond to customer inquiries via live chat by providing accurate information, resolving issues efficiently, documenting interactions, and escalating concerns as needed while maintaining a professional and customer-focused tone.

Freelance AI Content Editor
2025

• AI Photo Error Fixer

-Review and refine AI-generated images by identifying and correcting visual errors, inconsistencies, and artifacts to ensure accuracy, quality, and adherence to project guidelines.

ACHIEVEMENTS

• Dean's List awardee from first to fourth year of college for sustained academic excellence.

• Awarded High Honor for the batch 2019 - 2020 of Joy in Learning School Inc.

• Consitent Academic Achiever through Junior and Senior Highschool

TRAININGS & SEMINARS

• IMPRINT 2025: Graphic Communications, Upskilling Fair

• Occupational Safety and Health Administration training (2020)

• Brand Communication Training (2021)

• Let's Study in France Webinar (featuring the ESMA 3D Animation and Effects course, 2025)

• Role of Technology in Sustainable Development (2025)

HERRERA, JOSHUA ZECHARIAH

GRAPHIC DESIGNER

A motivated Animation and Motion Graphics student from LSPU Los Baños seeking opportunities to apply creative storytelling, visual design, and motion skills in producing engaging digital content, while continuously learning and contributing to innovative creative projects.

CONTACTS

joshuazechariah24@gmail.com
0967-847-4302

EDUCATION

Laguna State Polytechnic University
2022 - 2026

BS Information Technology
Specializing in Animation & Motion Graphics

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Ps Ai Ch Canva

SOFT SKILLS

- Flexibility
- Creativity
- Innovativeness
- Critical Thinking
- Collaboration Skills
- Active Listening

ACHIEVEMENTS

- 2nd Place in Mixed Choir Category in the University Wide Culture and The Arts Festival 2025
- Got Bronze Diploma in the 8th Biñan National Choral Festival 2025

TRAININGS & SEMINARS

- Role of Technology in Sustainable Development (2025)

NICOLAS, JOHN LAWRENCE

MULTIMEDIA PROFESSIONAL

Aspiring Animation and Motion Graphics major eager to apply creative skills, technical expertise, and a passion for storytelling in a professional setting. Committed to contributing fresh ideas and growing within the digital arts field.

CONTACTS

johnlawrenceonicolas@gmail.com
0961-401-7828
in/lawrencenicolas2904
behance.net/nico_rawr

EDUCATION

Laguna State Polytechnic University
2022 - 2026

BS Information Technology
Specializing in Animation & Motion Graphics

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Ps Ai Lr Ae An Id Ch

SOFT SKILLS

Flexibility | Critical Thinking | Collaborative Skills | Innovative | Creativity | Attention to Detail

BEHANCE LINKEDIN

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Concerned Artist of the Philippines
2025 – Present

- Cultural Work
  - Facilitated the Community Immersion and Art Workshop as part of the Basic Mass Integration team in collaboration with PAMALAKAYA.
  - Co-facilitated an Effigy Creation Workshop for UP Rural High School, guiding SHS students in hands-on creative production.
  - Contributed to organizing and production design for "Ghost Projects: The Exorcism! An Anti-Corruption Halloween Party."
  - Helped develop, launch, and curate "Koraptober," a month-long media campaign focused on anti-corruption awareness and public engagement.

Freelance Graphic Designer & Layout Artist
2023 – Present

- Graphic Design
  - Designed Logos & Publication Materials for Ang Koreyo & Centerfield Publication
  - Layout Artist for Ang Koreyo Newsletter & Centerfield Publication Newsletter
- Resource Person for Graphics & Layout in Campus Journalism
  - Invited as resource speaker by San Francisco Integrated National
  - Invited as resource speaker by Calamba Integrated School for (2023, 2025)
  - Resource Consultant for Tinig Timugan of LBCES (2023)

The Bay Breeze Group of Publications
2023 – 2024

- Chief Graphics & Layout Artist
  - Led the design and layout of print and digital issues, ensuring visually engaging and cohesive content. Managed a team of artists, collaborated with editors, and upheld design standards across all publications materials.
- Creative Director for USAD - Aquamag
  - Oversaw the visual direction and branding of the Aquamag issue, co-leading concept development, layout design, and team coordination to ensure a cohesive an impactful publication.
- Social Media Manager
  - Managed content strategy and daily operations across social platforms, increasing engagement through timely posts, visual storytelling, and audience interaction.

ACHIEVEMENTS

- 4th Place in the Visual Arts Category: Charcoal Rendering in the University Wide Culture and the Arts Festival 2025
- 5th Place in the Logo Design Battle Competition in Imprint 2025
- 1st Place in the College of Computer Studies Logo Making Contest 2024
- Top 20 in the Regionals Womens' Month Photography Contest 2024
- 2nd Place Desktop Publishing in the 11th University Wide Press Conference 2023
- 6th Place Best Page Design in the Regional Higher Education Press Conference 2024 (USAD-Aquamag)
- 6th Place Best Cover Design in the Regional Higher Education Press Conference 2024 (USAD-Aquamag)

TRAININGS & SEMINARS

- Reflecting, Reimagining, and Strategizing for Impact: A Training Workshop on Advancing Communication for Social Change (UP Diliman, College of Social Work and Community Development)
- Graphika Manila 2025
- IMPRINT 2025: Graphic Communications, Upskilling Fair
- Multimedia Arts and Design Summit 2025
- Southern Tagalog Exposure's Photography Workshop 2025
- The Community Building Challenge: Growing a Thriving Tech Network (Workshop) 2025
- Let's Study in France Webinar (featuring the ESMA 3D Animation and Effects course, 2025)
- IP Live Chat on Animation (February 24, 2025)